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1000: God

- 1010: God, nature and qualities of
- 1200: God, titles and descriptions of
- 1300: God, work of
- 1400: God, knowledge of
- 1500: God, the Trinity
- 1600: Scripture as the word of God

1010: God, nature and qualities of

- 1015: God
- 1190: glory

1015: God

The Creator and Redeemer of the world, who reveals himself in Scripture and in Jesus Christ, and who is loved, worshipped and adored by believers. Scripture stresses the personal nature of God, and also his total reliability and trustworthiness. God is the Father of Jesus Christ and of all believers.

1020: God, all-knowing

The omniscience of God is that attribute by which he knows all things past, present and future. What is hidden from human sight is still known by God. Scripture stresses the wisdom of God in all his actions, and often grounds this in his all-embracing knowledge.

God's unique self-knowledge within the Trinity

MAT 11:27 See also JHN 10:15; 1CO 2:10–2:11

The nature of God's knowledge

God's knowledge originates within himself

ISA 40:13–40:14 See also JOB 21:22; ROM 11:33–11:34; 1CO 2:16

God's knowledge is complete

MAT 10:30 parallel LUK 12:7 See also PSA 147:4; ISA 40:26

God knows things that are hidden from human understanding

DEU 29:29 See also JOB 37:15–37:16; DAN 2:22; MAT 24:36 parallel MRK 13:32; ACT 1:7; 2CO 12:2–12:4

God's comprehensive knowledge of people

God's knowledge of people's actions

JOB 34:21 See also JOB 24:23; JOB 31:4; PSA 33:13–33:15; PSA 139:2–139:3; JER 23:24

God's knowledge of people's needs

MAT 6:8 See also MAT 6:31–6:32 parallel LUK 12:29–12:30

God's knowledge of people's hearts and minds

1CH 28:9 Scripture views the heart not primarily as the seat of emotion but more particularly as the seat of the will. See also PSA 44:20–44:21, PSA 139:1–139:2; JER 17:10; EZK 11:5; HEB 4:12–4:13

God's knowledge of individuals

GEN 20:1–20:7 God's knowledge of Abimelech's motives and behaviour towards Abraham's wife Sarah; ; 1SA 16:1–16:12 the LORD to Samuel regarding David's anointing as king; ; ACT 5:1–5:10 God's knowledge of the deception of Ananias and Sapphira

God's knowledge of people's sin

JER 16:17 See also JOB 10:14; PSA 69:5; JER 2:22; HOS 7:2; AMO 5:12

God's foreknowledge

ISA 46:10 See also ISA 42:9; ISA 44:7; DAN 2:28

God's foreknowledge of Jesus Christ's passion

ACT 2:23 See also ACT 3:18; ACT 4:27–4:28

God's foreknowledge of those who would become disciples

ROM 8:29 See also JER 1:5; ROM 11:2; 1PE 1:2

God's foreknowledge of people's free actions

PSA 139:4 See also EXO 3:19; DEU 31:21; 1SA 23:10–23:13

Implications of God's knowledge

God's knowledge ensures that all will be judged fairly

HEB 4:13 See also 1SA 2:3; JOB 34:22–34:23; ECC 12:14; ROM 2:16; 1CO 4:5

God's knowledge ensures that he knows those who are his

2TI 2:19 See also NUM 16:5; EXO 33:12; JOB 23:10 **JHN 10:14** See also 1CO 8:3; GAL 4:9; 1JN 3:19–3:20; REV 3:8

1025: God, anger of

The punitive and vindictory reaction, legitimate and controlled, yet awesomely emphatic, of God the righteous judge to unrighteousness in his human creatures. Up to the present, the expression of God's anger and wrath has had the purpose of drawing sinners to repentance and conversion, but this will not be the case at the final judgment.

The nature of God's anger

It is fearsome

NAM 1:6 See also JOS 7:26; EZK 38:18

It is reluctant and short-lived

EXO 34:6 See also ISA 54:7–54:8; NEH 9:16–9:18

It is constant with his righteous and merciful character

PSA 7:11 See also HAB 3:2

It fulfils God's purposes

JER 23:20 See also JER 30:24

The causes of God's anger

Idolatry and unbelief

NUM 25:3 See also EXO 32:8–32:10; DEU 8:19; JDG 2:10–2:14; 1KI 14:9, 1KI 16:32–16:33, 1KI 22:53; 2KI 23:19 Josiah removes idolatrous shrines; 2CH 28:25, 2CH 34:25; JER 8:19, JER 32:29, JER 44:3; JHN 3:36 the unbelief of rejecting the Son of God; ROM 1:18–1:23, ROM 2:8

Disobedience and disloyalty

JOS 7:1 See also DEU 9:7; 2KI 22:13; 1CH 13:10; PSA 106:29; JER 32:32; ZEC 7:13; EPH 5:6

Ungodly living

God's judgment against the ungodly is a sign of his anger against actions that contradict his righteous character and purposes: 2TI 3:1–3:9; ; JUD 1:14–1:16

Pride, arrogance and hypocrisy

MAT 23:27–23:28 See also 2CH 32:25; PRO 3:34, PRO 8:13; ISA 13:11; HOS 12:14; MAL 4:1

Complaints against, and opposition to, God's purposes

NUM 11:1 See also NUM 14:27, NUM 21:5

Injustice

ZEC 7:9–7:12 See also 2CH 19:7; JER 22:13; EZK 9:9; MAL 3:5; MAT 23:23

The rejection of God's servants

HEB 10:29–10:31 See also DEU 32:35–32:36; PSA 135:14; NEH 9:26; ZEC 7:12; MAT 21:33–21:41; ACT 7:35–7:37

God reveals his anger

In present times

ROM 1:18 See also JER 10:10

On a future "day of wrath" which is anticipated

ROM 2:5 See also ISA 13:9, ISA 13:13; EZK 7:19; ZEP 1:15, ZEP 1:18, ZEP 2:2

The consequences of God's anger

God allows those who reject righteousness to remain in their sin

ROM 1:18–1:32 See also 1KI 14:16; 2CH 12:5; NEH 9:28; ISA 54:7–54:8; JER 7:27–7:29, JER 12:7–12:8

Punishment will be experienced by rebellious people

DEU 8:19 See also ISA 59:18; JER 21:14; MAT 18:34–18:35, MAT 25:28–25:30 EXO 12:12; NUM 32:13; JOS 7:25–7:26;

ISA 13:9–13:13; DAN 5:30; ACT 5:5, ACT 5:10 1KI 14:15; JER 15:13–15:14, JER 25:7–25:11 LAM 2:1–2:9; EZK 38:19–38:21

God will be feared as his holiness and greatness are revealed

ISA 59:18–59:19 See also EZK 38:22–38:23

Ultimately God will purify and restore his people for service

MAL 3:2–3:4 See also JER 15:19–15:21

1030: God, compassion of

An aspect of God's nature which is reflected in his sympathetic understanding of human weakness and his restoration of those in trouble.

God is compassionate by nature

2CO 1:3 See also EXO 33:19, EXO 34:6; PSA 86:15, PSA 103:8, PSA 116:5, PSA 119:156; HOS 1:7; JOL 2:13

God shows compassion as a parent

PSA 103:13–103:14 See also ISA 49:15–49:16, ISA 63:15–63:16; JER 31:20

God shows compassion to all

PSA 145:8–145:9

God shows compassion to those in deep trouble

ISA 49:13 See also EXO 22:27; 2KI 13:22–13:23; PSA 40:1–40:2, PSA 40:11–40:12, PSA 69:16–69:17; ISA 30:18; LAM 3:22, LAM 3:32; ZEC 10:6; JAS 5:11

God shows compassion towards sinners

NEH 9:17 See also DEU 13:17; NEH 9:28; PSA 51:1–51:2, PSA 103:3–103:4; ISA 54:7–54:8, ISA 60:10; DAN 9:9; MIC 7:19

The return from exile shows God's compassion to sinners

EZK 39:25 See also DEU 30:2–30:3; JER 12:15, JER 30:18, JER 33:26

God's deeds show his compassion

PSA 111:3–111:4 See also PSA 102:14; ISA 14:1, ISA 63:7

God's compassion is essential to believers' well-being

PSA 119:77 See also PSA 77:8–77:9; ISA 63:15

God's compassion is reflected in acts of human compassion

COL 3:12 See also 2CH 30:9; JER 42:12; ZEC 7:9; LUK 6:36; EPH 4:32

Jesus Christ reflects God's compassion

HEB 4:15 See also LUK 1:72, LUK 15:20

1035: God, faithfulness of

God's perfect loyalty and consistency in being true to his name, his character and his word.

God's faithfulness is an integral part of his nature

NUM 23:19 God's limitless power and steadfast love imply complete faithfulness which contrasts with human nature; **LAM 3:22–3:23** See also EXO 34:6; DEU 7:8–7:9; DEU 32:4; ROM 4:21; 2TI 2:13

God is faithful to his name and character

2TI 2:13 See also NEH 9:8; PSA 106:8; 1TH 5:24; HEB 6:13–6:18

God's faithfulness is known through fulfilled promises

JOS 23:14 See also JOS 21:45; 1KI 8:56; 1CH 16:15; PSA 145:13; 2PE 3:9

Examples of God's faithfulness in fulfilled promises

Abraham's fatherhood

GEN 12:2–12:3; GEN 15:4; GEN 21:1–21:2; ; ROM 9:9; ; GAL 4:28; ; HEB 6:13–6:15; HEB 11:11

The building of the temple

2SA 7:12–7:13 parallel 1CH 17:11–17:12; ; 1KI 8:17–8:21 parallel 2CH 6:7–6:11

The exile in Babylon

JER 25:8–25:11 God's faithfulness will not always mean human prosperity. See also 2KI 25:8–25:12 parallels 2CH 36:17–36:21; JER 52:12–52:16; EZR 1:1–1:3; JER 52:27; JER 29:10; DAN 9:2–9:3; DAN 9:15–9:19

God's faithfulness is revealed to the faithful

2SA 22:26 See also GAL 3:14; HEB 10:23

God's faithfulness is constant

ROM 3:3–3:4 God's faithfulness is not negated by human unfaithfulness. See also EZK 12:25; HAB 2:3; 2TI 2:13

Jesus Christ is the ultimate evidence of God's faithfulness

ACT 13:32–13:33 See also JHN 14:9–14:11; ROM 15:8–15:9; 2CO 1:20–1:22; HEB 3:2–3:6; REV 1:5; REV 19:11

1040: God, fatherhood of

Primarily signifying God's paternal relationship to Jesus Christ, the term also refers to God's fatherly relationship to his creation, especially to believers as the "children of God".

Aspects of the fatherhood of God

He is the Creator and provider

1CO 8:6 See also DEU 32:6; DEU 32:18; ISA 64:8; ACT 17:24–17:28

He shows love and compassion

HOS 11:1 See also PSA 103:13; JER 3:19; 2CO 1:3

He exercises his providence and care

PSA 68:5 See also MAT 6:26; MAT 6:31–6:33 parallel LUK 12:29–12:31; MAT 7:11 parallel LUK 11:13

He disciplines and corrects

DEU 8:5 See also PRO 3:11–3:12; HEB 12:5–12:6

God as the Father of Jesus Christ

MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11; LUK 3:22 See also MAT 11:27; LUK 2:49; JHN 5:17–5:18; JHN 17:11; JHN 20:17; ROM 15:6; EPH 1:3 **1PE 1:3** See also 1JN 1:3

God is the father of Israel

He cares for his covenant people

JER 31:9 See also EXO 4:22; DEU 14:1; DEU 32:6; DEU 32:18; ISA 63:16; MAL 2:10

He is the father of the kings of Israel

2SA 7:13–7:14 parallel 1CH 17:12–17:13 This description of God's fatherhood involves the maintenance of a special relationship between God and David's descendants, which ultimately includes Jesus Christ. See also PSA 2:7; PSA 89:26–89:27

God is the father of Christian believers

He has an intimate relationship with believers

MAT 6:9 parallel LUK 11:2 See also JHN 20:17; 2CO 6:18; GAL 3:26; 1JN 2:13

He adopts believers into his family

JHN 1:12–1:13 See also ROM 8:14–8:17; GAL 4:5–4:7; 1JN 3:1

The fatherhood of God has implications for the church

Character: children are to reproduce the Father's likeness

MAT 5:48

Unity: one Father means one family

EPH 4:3–4:6 See also MAL 2:10; MAT 23:9; EPH 3:14–3:15

Status: believers are related to Jesus Christ

MAT 12:50 parallels MRK 3:35; LUK 8:21 See also ROM 8:29; HEB 2:11

Inheritance: believers are heirs of the Father's kingdom

ROM 8:17 See also LUK 12:32; GAL 3:29; COL 1:12; TIT 3:7

Submission: believers are to revere the Father**1PE 1:17** See also MAT 6:9 parallel LUK 11:2; EPH 3:14**1045: God, glory of**

The revelation of God's power and characteristics, sometimes accompanied by visible phenomena.

Glory as an attribute of God**PSA 24:7–24:8** See also PSA 29:3; JHN 11:40; ACT 7:2; REV 19:1**Visible phenomena accompanying God's glory****The appearance of God's glory****HAB 3:4** See also DEU 5:24; 2SA 22:8–22:16 parallel PSA 18:7–18:15; PSA 104:1; EZK 1:26–1:28**God's glory as a cloud****EXO 24:15–24:16** See also EXO 33:9–33:10; ISA 4:5; MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7; LUK 9:34; LUK 21:27 parallels MAT 24:30; MRK 13:26**God's glory in the tabernacle and the temple****2CH 5:13–5:14** parallel 1KI 8:10–8:11 The Jewish term for the outward sign of God's presence in the temple is "Shekinah". See also EXO 40:34–40:35; 2CH 7:1–7:3; EZK 8:4; EZK 9:3; EZK 10:19; EZK 43:1–43:5; REV 15:8**God's glory revealed****In Jesus Christ****HEB 1:3** See also ISA 49:3; JHN 1:14; JHN 13:31–13:32; JHN 17:5; 2CO 4:6; 2PE 1:17**In his people****COL 1:27** See also ISA 60:19–60:21; ISA 62:3; 2CO 3:18; EPH 3:21**In the whole world****ISA 6:3** See also NUM 14:21; PSA 57:5; PSA 57:11 parallel PSA 108:5; HAB 2:14; HAB 3:3**In heaven****REV 21:23** See also ROM 8:17; HEB 2:9; 1PE 5:10**In his name****NEH 9:5** See also DEU 28:58; 1CH 29:13; PSA 8:1; PSA 79:9**In his works****PSA 111:3** See also PSA 19:1; ISA 12:5; ISA 35:2; JHN 11:40–11:44; JHN 17:4**In his kingdom****PSA 145:11–145:12** See also 1CH 29:11; MAT 6:13; 1TH 2:12**God's glory cannot be fully seen****1TI 6:15–6:16** EXO 33:18–33:20; ; JDG 6:22–6:23, JDG 13:20–13:22; ; ISA 6:5; ; JHN 1:18**God's glory experienced****ACT 7:55** See also EXO 3:2 Moses; ISA 6:1–6:4 Isaiah; LUK 2:9 the shepherds**The effects of God's glory****God's glory is acknowledged****PSA 72:19** See also PSA 29:2; ROM 11:36; REV 4:11; REV 5:13; REV 19:1**God's glory brings guilt and fear****ROM 3:23** See also ISA 2:10; ISA 2:19; ISA 2:21; REV 11:13; REV 15:8**1050: God, goodness of**

All God's perfect qualities are made freely available to all for the benefit of the whole world.

God alone is good**MRK 10:18** parallels MAT 19:17; LUK 18:19**God demonstrates his goodness****In his actions****PSA 119:68** See also 2CH 30:18; NEH 9:20; PSA 73:1; PSA 143:10; ACT 10:38; ROM 2:4**In his work of creation****1TI 4:4** See also GEN 1:4; GEN 1:31; PSA 145:9**In his love****PSA 86:5** See also 1CH 16:34 parallel PSA 106:1; PSA 25:7–25:8; PSA 69:16; PSA 100:5**In his gifts****JAS 1:17** See also NUM 13:27; DEU 8:7; DEU 26:11; HEB 9:11**In his promises****JOS 23:14–23:15** See also 2SA 7:28 parallel 1CH 17:26; 1KI 8:56; JER 29:10**In his commands****PSA 119:39** See also PSA 19:7; ROM 7:12; ROM 7:16; ROM 12:2**God's goodness is to be experienced****God is good to those who trust him****PSA 34:8; NAM 1:7** See also EXO 33:19; 2CH 7:10; JOB 42:11; PSA 31:19–31:20; PSA 84:11; PSA 86:17; LAM 3:25; AMO 5:14–5:15; 1PE 2:3**God's people can rely on his goodness****JER 32:40** See also PSA 23:6; PSA 27:13; MAT 7:11 parallel LUK 11:13; PHP 1:6

God works positively for good in unfavourable circumstances

GEN 50:20 See also ACT 2:23–2:24; ROM 8:28; 2CO 4:17; HEB 12:10

God's goodness is to be praised

PSA 135:3 See also DEU 8:10; 2CH 5:13, 2CH 7:3; PSA 86:5, PSA 136:1, PSA 145:7

1055: God, grace and mercy of

The qualities of God's character by which he shows himself compassionate, accepting, and generous to sinful human beings, shielding them from his wrath, forgiving them, and bestowing on them his righteousness so that they can live and grow in faith and obedience. Grace and mercy are particularly expressed through God's covenant with his chosen people and through Jesus Christ's atoning death on the cross.

God's grace and mercy are made known in Jesus Christ

JHN 1:16–1:17

The abundance of God's grace and mercy

EPH 2:4–2:8 See also 2SA 24:14 parallel 1CH 21:13; PSA 69:13, PSA 84:11, PSA 102:13; ROM 2:4, ROM 5:17, ROM 9:23; 1TI 1:14

God's grace and mercy are always unearned and unmerited

DEU 7:7–7:8 See also DEU 9:5–9:6; EZK 36:22; DAN 9:18; ROM 9:16; EPH 1:6, EPH 2:8–2:9, EPH 3:8; TIT 3:5

God's grace and mercy are a source of blessing

GEN 21:1–21:2 See also GEN 33:11; 1SA 2:21

God's grace and mercy are expressed in the covenant relationship

JER 31:3 Hebrew “hesed” (translated as “love”, “loving-kindness”, “unfailing love”) expresses specifically the grace and mercy that underlie the covenant relationship. See also EXO 34:6; DEU 7:9, DEU 7:12; NEH 9:17; PSA 6:4; ISA 55:3; LAM 3:22, LAM 3:32

Salvation comes by grace

TIT 2:11 See also MRK 10:25–10:27 Jesus Christ's words to his disciples; ROM 5:15; EPH 1:5–1:6, EPH 2:8; 2TI 1:9–1:10

This is ultimately shown in the cross of Jesus Christ

ROM 3:24–3:25 See also ROM 5:8; EPH 1:7; HEB 2:9; 2PE 1:10–1:11

God's grace and mercy are offered to sinners

Punishment is withheld

EZR 9:13 See also 2KI 13:22–13:23; EZK 20:15–20:17; HOS 11:8; JOL 2:13

Sin is forgiven

MIC 7:18; 1JN 1:9 See also PSA 32:5; PRO 28:13; ISA 55:7; JER 3:12, JER 33:8; DAN 9:9

Sinners' prayers are heard

PSA 51:1; LUK 18:13–18:14 See also PSA 6:2–6:3, PSA 123:3; HAB 3:2

The favour of God

Examples of those who found favour with God

GEN 4:4 Abel; ; GEN 6:8 Noah; ; EXO 33:12 Moses; ; JDG 6:17–6:18 Gideon; ; 1SA 2:26 Samuel; ; EZR 7:27–7:28 Ezra; ; LUK 1:30 Mary; ; LUK 2:52 Jesus Christ; ; ACT 7:46 David

Examples of those who seek the favour of God

EXO 32:11 Moses; ; 2KI 13:4 Jehoahaz; ; 2CH 33:12 Manasseh; NEH 5:19, NEH 13:31; DAN 9:17 Daniel

Promises relating to the favour of God

LEV 26:9 It is given to the obedient (see Lev 26:3); ; PSA 5:12 It is given to the righteous; ; PSA 30:5 It lasts for a lifetime.

The OT predicts a future age of God's favour

ISA 49:8 See also ISA 60:10, ISA 61:2; EZK 36:9

Implications for believers of the grace and mercy of God

God's grace and mercy are to influence the character and conduct of believers

ROM 6:1–6:2 See also ACT 11:23; ROM 6:14, ROM 12:1; TIT 2:11–2:12

Believers must humbly rely on God's grace and mercy

GAL 2:21 See also PRO 3:34; JAS 4:6; JON 2:8; ROM 2:4; 2CO 6:1–6:2

God's grace strengthens believers for service

EPH 3:7–3:8 See also 1CO 3:10; 2CO 12:7–12:9; GAL 1:15–1:16; EPH 4:7, EPH 4:11

Illustrations of God's grace and mercy

God shows grace to Noah, saving him from the flood and afterwards establishing a covenant with him: GEN 6:8, GEN 6:22, GEN 9:9–9:11; ; JON 1:1–1:3, JON 1:17, JON 2:1–2:3, JON 3:1–3:10 God shows mercy in saving first Jonah and then (following their repentance) the people of Nineveh; ; LUK 15:11–15:32 The forgiving love of the prodigal's father illustrates the divine mercy of God.

1060: God, greatness of

God's nature, deeds and attributes are incomparable, for which he deserves all praise.

God is great

JER 10:6 See also 1CH 16:25 parallel PSA 96:4; 1CH 29:11; NEH 1:5; ISA 12:6

God's name is great

EZK 36:23 See also JOS 7:9; 1SA 12:22; 1KI 8:42 parallel 2CH 6:32

God is a great king

PSA 47:2 See also PSA 47:7, PSA 48:2; MAL 1:14; MAT 5:35; 1TI 6:15

God's deeds are great

He does great things

PSA 136:4 See also JDG 2:7; ISA 55:9; JER 32:19; LUK 1:49; EPH 3:20

His acts are powerful

DEU 9:29 God's powerful acts are often associated with the exodus. See also EXO 15:7; DEU 9:26; 1SA 19:5; 2SA 23:10; 1SA 40:26; JER 32:17; NAM 1:3; EPH 1:19–1:20 His great power at work in the resurrection

God's attributes are great

His great love

PSA 108:4 See also NUM 14:19; 2CH 1:8; LAM 3:22; EPH 2:4; 1JN 3:1

His great mercy

1CH 21:13 See also NEH 9:31; ROM 5:17; 1PE 1:3

His great anger

2KI 22:13 See also PSA 90:11, PSA 102:10; JER 21:5, JER 32:37

God's gifts are great

He bestows great gifts

DAN 5:18 See also GEN 12:2; 1SA 26:25; 1CH 29:25

He gives great joy

NEH 12:43 See also EZR 6:22; PSA 4:7, PSA 126:3

The effects of God's greatness

God's power is known in the nations

PSA 126:2 See also 2CH 9:6, 2CH 20:6; PSA 99:2; DAN 4:3

People are astonished

LUK 9:43 See also HAB 1:5; LUK 5:26

God must be praised for his greatness

PSA 48:1 See also DEU 32:3; PSA 89:1, PSA 96:4, PSA 145:3

God's greatness makes him unique

There is no-one like him

PSA 150:2 See also 2SA 7:22; PSA 71:19, PSA 86:10, PSA 145:3

He is greater than other gods

EXO 18:11 See also DEU 4:7, DEU 10:17; 2CH 2:5; PSA 135:5; 1CO 8:4–8:6

God is greater than human power and pride

JOB 33:12 See also 2CH 32:7–32:8; ISA 40:6–40:7; 1JN 3:20

1065: God, holiness of

The moral excellence of God that unifies his attributes and is expressed through his actions, setting him apart from all others. Believers are called to be holy as God is holy.

God's nature is holy

He is perfect

DEU 32:4; ISA 6:3; REV 4:8 See also 2SA 22:31; JOB 6:10; PSA 18:30, PSA 22:3, PSA 71:22, PSA 78:41; ISA 41:14, ISA 43:15; HAB 1:13; JHN 17:11; REV 6:10

He is uniquely holy

1SA 2:2 See also EXO 15:11; PSA 77:13; ISA 40:25; REV 15:4

God's name is holy

EZK 36:21–36:23 See also LEV 22:32; 1CH 16:35, 1CH 29:16; PSA 33:21, PSA 97:12; ISA 57:15; EZK 39:25; LUK 1:49

God's dwelling-place is holy

ISA 57:15 David's palace was regarded as holy because of the presence of the ark. See also 2CH 8:11, 2CH 30:27; PSA 2:6, PSA 3:4, PSA 5:7, PSA 11:4, PSA 15:1, PSA 20:6, PSA 47:8, PSA 48:1, PSA 65:4; ISA 63:15; JOL 3:17; OBA 1:16–1:17; JON 2:4; MIC 1:2; HAB 2:20; ZEC 2:13; ACT 21:28 The Jews accused Paul of defiling the temple area by bringing in Gentiles; EPH 2:21–2:22 the church as the dwelling in which God lives by his Spirit; HEB 10:19–10:22; REV 22:19

God's holiness is revealed in his righteous activity

ISA 5:16 See also JDG 5:11; 1SA 12:7; PSA 77:13, PSA 145:17; DAN 9:14, DAN 9:16; ZEP 3:5

God's holiness affects worship

It is celebrated in worship

PSA 99:5 See also 1CH 16:29; PSA 29:2, PSA 99:5, PSA 103:1, PSA 105:3, PSA 145:21; ISA 6:3

Coming before a holy God requires preparation

EXO 3:5 See also EXO 29:37; PSA 24:3–24:4; 1CO 11:28; HEB 10:1–10:2, HEB 10:22

Special requirements and tasks are given to worship leaders

LEV 21:7–21:8 the priests; ; LEV 21:10–21:15 the high priest; EXO 28:1–28:43; ; LEV 21:16–21:23; 2CH 29:5 the Levites

God's holiness is to be seen in his people

God's people are to be holy because he is holy

LEV 19:2; 2TI 1:9 See also EXO 19:6, EXO 22:31; LEV 11:44; MAT 5:48; ROM 12:1; 1CO 1:2; 2CO 11:2 the church is to be pure as the bride of Jesus Christ; EPH 1:4, EPH 5:3; PHP 4:8; COL 1:22, COL 3:12; 1TH 3:13, 1TH 4:3–4:7; TIT 1:8 a qualification for an elder; HEB 2:11, HEB 3:1, HEB 12:10; 1PE 1:15–1:16

Becoming holy involves striving after God

2PE 3:14 See also 2CO 7:1, 2CO 13:11; EPH 4:22–4:24; 1TI 5:22; HEB 12:14; JAS 1:20–1:21; 2PE 3:11–3:12

The holiness of believers originates from God

EXO 31:13 See also LEV 22:9; DEU 28:9; PSA 4:3; 1JN 3:1–3:3

Jesus Christ purifies Christian believers

1JN 1:7 See also HEB 7:26–7:28, HEB 9:26–9:28, HEB 10:10, HEB 10:14; 1JN 3:4–3:6

God's holiness makes sin objectionable to him

HAB 1:13 See also JOS 24:19–24:20; JER 50:29

God's holiness necessitates dependence upon him for forgiveness

PSA 51:1–51:17 See also DAN 9:4–9:19; 1JN 1:9

1070: God, joy of

God rejoices in the well-being and faithfulness of his covenant people, and in the repentance and conversion of sinners. He brings joy to his people, who rejoice in his presence and faithfulness.

God is the source of joy

PSA 37:4 See also ISA 2:1; NEH 1:11, NEH 12:43; ISA 61:10; JHN 15:11; PHP 4:4

God rejoices in the restoration of his people

JER 32:41 See also ISA 62:4–62:5 He rejoices as does a bridegroom; ISA 65:19; JER 31:20 He rejoices as does a father; ZEP 3:17

Joy can be found in the heavenly presence of God

1CH 16:27 JOB 38:4–38:7; ; PRO 8:30–8:31; LUK 15:7 over sinners who repent

Causes of God's joy

His own works

JER 9:24

His chosen servant

MAT 12:18; ; ISA 42:1; ; HEB 1:9; ; PSA 45:7

Jesus Christ

MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11, LUK 3:22; ; MAT 17:5

The restored temple

HAG 1:8

His people and their worship

PSA 149:4–149:9 See also PSA 69:30–69:31

Repentance

DEU 30:9

Obedience, honesty and integrity

ISA 15:22; PRO 12:22 See also 1CH 29:17; PSA 147:10–147:11; PRO 11:1, PRO 11:20

God's face shining on his people

NUM 6:25 When God's face shines on his people his divine pleasure and joy is implied. PSA 67:1 See also PSA 80:19, PSA 119:135 PSA 34:16; 1PE 3:12

1075: God, justice of

The moral righteousness of God is revealed in his laws and expressed in his judicial acts. God's commands and judgments meet perfect standards of justice, and his apportioning of punishments and rewards is also perfectly just. God's justice is impartial. Special praise is his for vindicating the penitent and the needy who have no human champions. Ultimately, all God's ways will be seen as just and equitable.

God's justice displays his righteousness

It conforms to his moral law

JOB 34:12 See also DEU 32:4; PSA 9:16, PSA 11:7; ZEP 3:5; ROM 2:2; 2TI 2:13; REV 15:3

It is seen in his perfect will

PSA 99:4 See also PSA 40:8; ISA 53:10; MAT 6:10, MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42; HEB 10:9–10:10

God acts with justice

PSA 33:5–33:15 See also NEH 9:33

God's justice is exercised fairly and equitably

PSA 9:7–9:8 See also PSA 96:13, PSA 98:9, PSA 99:4

He judges people according to their deeds

REV 20:12–20:13 See also EXO 34:6–34:7; PSA 62:12; JER 17:10; EZK 18:20; MAT 16:27; REV 22:12

He punishes wickedness

EZK 18:20 See also EXO 34:7; DEU 32:35; ISA 59:18, ISA 66:24; MAT 25:41–25:46; COL 3:25; 2TH 1:8–1:9

He rewards righteousness

PSA 58:11 See also ISA 62:11; MAT 5:12 parallel LUK 6:23; MAT 25:34–25:40, MAT 25:46; ROM 2:7, ROM 8:1–8:2; 2TI 4:8

God establishes justice**He upholds the cause of the oppressed**

PSA 103:6 See also DEU 10:18; PSA 140:12, PSA 146:7–146:9; ISA 61:8; LUK 1:52–1:53

He vindicates those who have been wronged

ISA 25:39 See also ISA 24:15; PSA 135:14; ROM 12:19; DEU 32:35; 1PE 2:23

He is completely impartial

JOB 34:18–34:19 See also DEU 10:17; 2CH 19:7; ACT 10:34–10:35; EPH 6:9

God's ways in exercising justice**God's justice is not always immediately apparent**

JER 12:1 See also JOB 21:7; PSA 73:3–73:14; ECC 7:15; HAB 1:2–1:4; MAL 2:17, MAL 3:14–3:15; MAT 20:10–20:12

God warns before punishing

2CH 36:15 See also 2KI 17:23; NEH 9:29–9:30; JER 7:13; JON 3:4; HEB 12:25

God gives opportunity for people to change their ways

JER 18:8–18:10 See also JER 7:5–7:7; EZK 18:25–18:32; MAT 21:28–21:32; 1JN 1:9

God's justice is truly equitable

GAL 6:7–6:8 See also GEN 18:25; NUM 32:23; PSA 73:17; LUK 16:25, LUK 18:7–18:8; COL 3:24–3:25

God's justice is satisfied by the work of Jesus Christ

ROM 3:25–3:26 See also ISA 53:10–53:11; HEB 9:22; 1JN 1:9, 1JN 2:1–2:2

God's justice will be established in the reign of Jesus Christ

MAT 25:31–25:33 See also ISA 9:6–9:7; ACT 17:31; REV 19:11–19:16

Heaven and earth will rejoice when God's justice is established

PSA 96:10–96:13 parallel 1CH 16:30–16:33; ; PSA 98:4–98:9; ; REV 15:3–15:4, REV 16:5–16:7, REV 19:1–19:2

God requires people to reflect his justice

PRO 21:3 See also LEV 19:15; DEU 16:20, DEU 24:17; 1KI 10:9 parallel 2CH 9:8; PSA 82:3–82:4; ISA 56:1; MIC 6:8; ZEC 7:9–7:10; COL 4:1; 1TI 5:21

1080: God, living and self-sustaining

God is alive and active. In contrast to idols, he is uncreated and the source of all continuing life.

God is alive

JER 10:10 See also GEN 1:1; DEU 5:26; JOS 3:10; JER 23:36; MAT 26:63; 1TI 3:15; HEB 3:12, HEB 12:22

God lives for ever

ISA 57:15 See also DAN 4:34, DAN 12:7; REV 4:9–4:10, REV 10:6, REV 15:7

God is self-existent

JHN 5:26 See also EXO 3:14; JHN 8:58; ACT 17:25

The living God is Father, Son and Holy Spirit

JHN 6:57; 2CO 3:3 See also MAT 16:16; 1CO 8:6; HEB 7:24

The living God is to be worshipped

DAN 6:26 See also DAN 6:20; ROM 9:26; HOS 1:10; 2CO 6:16; 1TI 4:10; HEB 9:14

Turning away from the living God is sin

HEB 3:12 See also ISA 17:26, ISA 17:36; 2KI 19:4 parallel ISA 37:4; 2KI 19:16 parallel ISA 37:17; HEB 10:31

The living God contrasts with dead idols

ACT 14:15 See also 1KI 18:26–18:29; PSA 115:2–115:7; ISA 46:1–46:4; JER 10:3–10:6; 1TH 1:9

God is the source of life

DEU 30:20 See also JHN 1:4

God gives life to created beings

GEN 2:7 See also JOB 27:3; PSA 104:30; ISA 40:28; ACT 17:25, ACT 17:28

God sustains the life of all people

PSA 54:4 See also 1CH 29:14; PSA 3:5, PSA 18:35, PSA 146:9, PSA 147:6; ISA 46:4; HEB 1:3

God gives spiritual life

JHN 10:28 See also JHN 5:21, JHN 11:25, JHN 14:6; 1PE 1:23

God is the source of new life

PSA 42:2 See also PSA 63:1, PSA 84:2; JHN 3:1–3:8

1085: God, love of

The deepest possible expression of God's character. Though God loves all people, he is especially committed to sacrificial, loyal relationships with his people.

God's nature is love

1JN 4:8 See also 1JN 4:16

His love is perfectly expressed within the Trinity

MRK 1:10–1:11 parallels MAT 3:16–3:17, LUK 3:21–3:22
See also JHN 5:20, JHN 10:17, JHN 14:23; EPH 1:6; COL 1:13

Characteristics of God's love

It is eternal

JER 31:3 See also PSA 103:17, PSA 136:1–136:26; ISA 49:15–49:16, ISA 54:8, ISA 54:10

It is a covenant love

DEU 7:9 See also EXO 20:6 parallel DEU 5:10; DEU 7:12; 1KI 8:23 parallel 2CH 6:14; PSA 106:45; DAN 9:4

It is lavish

EXO 34:6–34:7 See also NEH 9:17; PSA 103:8; JOL 2:13; JON 4:2; 1JN 3:1

It is holy and just

PSA 33:5 See also PSA 37:28, PSA 99:4; ISA 61:8

Images of God's love

God as a father: DEU 1:31; ; HOS 11:1–11:4; ; LUK 15:11–15:32; ; HEB 12:6; ; PRO 3:12; JER 31:32; ; HOS 2:14–2:20; ; REV 21:2

God's loving actions

The gift of God's Son is a unique act of love

1JN 4:9–4:10 See also JHN 3:16, JHN 15:13; ROM 5:7–5:8

God sets his love on the unlovely

DEU 7:7–7:8 See also EZK 16:1–16:14; ROM 5:8; EPH 2:4–2:5

God always acts in love towards believers

ROM 8:38–8:39 See also 2CO 13:14; 2JN 1:3

God's love for his people

Israel

ISA 43:4 See also DEU 10:15; 2CH 9:8; MAT 15:24; ROM 9:15–9:16; EXO 33:19; ROM 11:28

The church

REV 1:5 See also JHN 16:27, JHN 17:23

God's love for the world

DEU 10:18; JHN 3:16–3:17 See also PSA 145:9, PSA 145:17; MAT 5:45; ACT 14:17, ACT 17:25

God's love for individuals

2SA 12:24–12:25 “Jedidiah” means “loved by the LORD”. See also DEU 33:12 Benjamin 2SA 7:15 parallel 1CH 17:13; ISA 55:3 EZR 7:28 Ezra; NEH 13:26 Solomon

God's love transforms human love

Human love must respond to God's love

1JN 4:19 See also DEU 6:5, DEU 30:6; EPH 5:1; COL 3:12–3:14

Human love must be modelled on God's love

MAT 5:44–5:45 See also HOS 3:1; 1JN 2:15, 1JN 4:7–4:8, 1JN 4:11–4:12

1090: God, majesty of

The greatness and splendour of God, revealed in his creation and mighty works of deliverance. On account of his majesty, God is worthy of praise and adoration from all people.

God is majestic

HEB 8:1 See also 1SA 15:29; PSA 24:10 The word translated “glory” also means “majesty”; HEB 1:3–1:4

Majesty belongs to God

1CH 29:11 See also PSA 145:12; JUD 1:25

God's majesty is awesome

JOB 37:22 See also ISA 2:10, ISA 2:19, ISA 2:21

God's character is majestic

PSA 93:1 A figurative expression indicating that God is fully majestic. See also EXO 15:11; PSA 104:1, PSA 145:5; ISA 24:14, ISA 26:10

God's activity is majestic

EXO 15:6–15:7 “hand” is a symbol of God's power which accomplishes his purposes. See also DEU 9:26, DEU 11:2–11:3; 2CH 20:6; PSA 111:3; LUK 9:43

God's name is majestic

PSA 8:1 See also PSA 8:9

God's voice is majestic

PSA 29:4 See also JOB 37:4; ISA 30:30

God's presence is majestic

1CH 16:27 See also PSA 96:6; 2TH 1:9; 2PE 1:17

The risen Christ shares in God's majesty

2PE 1:16–1:17 See also HEB 1:3–1:4, HEB 8:1

God's delegated majesty

To the Messiah

MIC 5:4 See also ZEC 9:9

To kings**PSA 21:5** See also PSA 45:3–45:4, PSA 110:2–110:3**God's majesty provides help for his people****PSA 68:34–68:35** See also EXO 15:6; DEU 33:26–33:27**Experiences of God's majesty**

ISA 6:1–6:4 Isaiah's vision; ; EZK 1:4–1:28 Ezekiel's vision; ; HAB 3:3–3:6 Habakkuk's description of God's person and work; ; REV 4:1–4:11 John's vision

Human responses to the majesty of God**An awareness of sin****ISA 6:5****An awareness of insignificance**

See also ISA 40:15

Worship and adoration of God

1CH 16:29; ; PSA 92:1–92:8, PSA 93:1, PSA 95:3–95:6; ; LUK 1:46

1095: God, patience of

God shows forbearance in his character, decisions and actions. Above all, he waits patiently for people to turn to him for salvation.

God's patient character**God is slow to anger****NUM 14:18** "slow to anger" is the main OT expression for God's patient character. See also EXO 34:6; NEH 9:16–9:17; PSA 86:15, PSA 103:8, PSA 145:8; JOL 2:13; JON 4:2; NAM 1:3**God imparts patience****ROM 15:5** The Greek can be translated "God of endurance/patience". The phrase suggests that God is patient and imparts patience. See also JER 15:15; 2TH 3:5; 1PE 3:20**God's patience with sinful people****God's patience lasts a long time****ACT 13:18** See also DEU 8:2; NEH 9:30; PSA 78:38**God is patient in delaying punishment****ISA 42:14** See also NEH 9:30–9:31; PSA 50:20–50:21, PSA 78:38; ISA 48:9; HAB 2:3**Sinful people try God's patience****MAL 2:17** See also GEN 18:16–18:33; NUM 14:27; PSA 78:41, PSA 78:56; ISA 1:14, ISA 7:13, ISA 43:24**Examples of God's patience**

GEN 8:22 with creation; ; GEN 18:32 with the city of Sodom; ; ISA 3:10 with Samuel; EZK 20:17; ; MIC 7:19; JON 3:1 with Jonah

The purpose of God's patience**Repentance****ROM 2:4** See also 2PE 3:9**Salvation****2PE 3:15** See also ROM 9:22–9:24**1100: God, perfection of**

God is complete, faultless and totally sufficient in every aspect of his being and ways. That perfection is made known in Jesus Christ, and is the ultimate goal of the Christian life.

God's moral perfection**PSA 25:8** See also EXO 33:19; PSA 18:25–18:26, PSA 92:15; ISA 26:7; MRK 10:18 parallel LUK 18:19**Humanity should emulate God's moral perfection****MAT 5:48** See also LEV 19:2, LEV 11:44–11:45; 1PE 1:16; 2CO 7:1, 2CO 13:11**God's work is perfect****DEU 32:4** See also 2SA 22:31 parallel PSA 18:30; PSA 19:1, PSA 40:5, PSA 96:3, PSA 139:14, PSA 145:4–145:6; JER 32:19–32:20**God's will is perfect****ROM 12:2** See also PSA 19:7–19:11**God's words are perfect****PSA 12:6** See also PSA 18:30; PRO 30:5**Humanity cannot always grasp the perfection of God's ways****JOB 42:3** See also ECC 3:11; EZK 18:25, EZK 18:29, EZK 33:17–33:20**Examples of the perfection of God's attributes****Perfect knowledge**

JOB 37:16; ; PSA 139:1–139:6, PSA 147:5

Perfect faithfulness

ISA 25:1

Perfect love

1JN 3:1, 1JN 4:8–4:12, 1JN 4:16–4:19

God's perfection is seen in Jesus Christ**HEB 7:26** See also COL 1:19, COL 2:9; HEB 2:10, HEB 5:8–5:9, HEB 7:28**1105: God, power of**

God is all-powerful (that is omnipotent), and is able to do whatever he wills. His power is limited only by his character.

God is all-powerful

MRK 10:27 parallel MAT 19:26 See also GEN 18:14; PSA 93:1; MRK 14:36; LUK 1:37; 2CO 4:7

God cannot be thwarted

JOB 42:2 See also JOB 9:12; ISA 14:27

God's names denote his power**The uniqueness of God's power**

JER 10:6

He is the Almighty

the Almighty" is HebrewEl Shaddai": GEN 28:3, GEN 35:11, GEN 43:14; ; EXO 6:3; ; JOB 11:7, JOB 31:2

He is the LORD Almighty and God Almighty

Almighty" in these verses is usually HebrewSabaoth": PSA 24:10, PSA 89:8; ; JER 10:16; ; 2CO 6:18; ; REV 11:17, REV 19:6

He is the Mighty One

GEN 49:24; ; JOS 22:22; ; PSA 50:1; ; ISA 1:24, ISA 10:21, ISA 60:16; ; MRK 14:62; ; LUK 1:49

God's power is seen above all in his acts of redemption**God is powerful to save**

ZEP 3:17

God shows his power in the exodus

DEU 9:29 See also EXO 13:9, EXO 14:31; DEU 7:8, DEU 9:26; NEH 1:10; JER 32:21

God shows his power through the work of Jesus Christ

ACT 2:24 See also ROM 1:4; EPH 1:19–1:21; COL 2:13–2:15; REV 12:10

God shows his power through the proclamation of the good news about Jesus Christ

ROM 1:16 See also 1CO 1:18, 1CO 1:24–1:25; 2CO 10:4; COL 2:12

God's power is shown in Jesus Christ's life**God's power in Jesus Christ's earthly ministry**

LUK 5:17 See also LUK 6:19, LUK 8:46; ACT 10:38; 2PE 1:16

God's power in Jesus Christ's heavenly ministry

HEB 7:16 In contrast to all other priests, Jesus Christ exercises his ministry now in heaven because death could not hold him. See also ACT 4:10; 2CO 13:4

God's power seen in Jesus Christ's second coming

MRK 13:26 parallels MAT 24:30, LUK 21:27 See also 2TH 1:9–1:10

The Holy Spirit demonstrates God's power

MIC 3:8 See also ACT 1:8, ACT 10:38; ROM 15:19; 1CO 2:4–2:5; 1TH 1:5

God's power in the world**God rules the created order**

ROM 1:20 See also PSA 19:1, PSA 65:6, PSA 68:34; ISA 40:26; MAT 8:26 parallel MRK 4:39; MAT 21:19; HEB 1:3

God's works are powerful

DEU 3:24 See also PSA 71:18, PSA 77:12, PSA 145:4; JER 32:17–32:19; LUK 1:51

The ark symbolises God's powerful presence

PSA 132:8 parallel 2CH 6:41 See also 1SA 5:1–5:12; 2SA 6:6–6:8, 2SA 6:11–6:12; PSA 78:61

God keeps his promises

ROM 4:21 See also 2CO 9:8

God gives life to the dead

1CO 6:14 See also MAT 22:29 parallel MRK 12:24; PHP 3:21

God's power in the lives of believers**God gives his own power to his people**

1CH 29:11–29:12 See also 1SA 2:10; DAN 2:27–2:28; 2CO 13:3–13:4; PHP 4:13; 2TI 1:7; 1PE 4:11

God's power achieves his purposes in his people's lives

2TH 1:11 See also MIC 5:4; ACT 4:28; 1CO 5:4; EPH 1:20–1:21

God's power completes his work of salvation in believers' lives

1PE 1:5 See also 2TI 1:12; HEB 7:25; JUD 1:24

God's power gives believers inner strength

EPH 3:16–3:17 See also EPH 1:18–1:19, EPH 6:10; PHP 3:10; COL 1:11

God's power is made plain through human weakness

2CO 12:9–12:10 See also ISA 53:1–53:3; 2CO 4:7, 2CO 13:4

God's power gives help to believers in suffering

2TI 4:16–4:17 See also 2CH 25:8; PSA 46:1; DAN 3:17; 2CO 6:7; 2TI 1:8

God's power is limited only by his character**God cannot deny himself**

2TI 2:13 See also JAS 1:7

God cannot tolerate evil

HAB 1:13

God cannot be tempted

JAS 1:13

God cannot lie**NUM 23:19** See also 1SA 15:29; HEB 6:18**God's power is to be praised****PSA 68:35** See also PSA 21:13, PSA 118:14; 1TI 6:16; JUD 1:25; REV 5:12**1110: God, present everywhere**

God is omnipresent in that he transcends all limitations of space and is present in the fulness of his being in every place but in varying ways.

God transcends all spatial limitations**1KI 8:27** parallel 2CH 6:18 See also 2CH 2:6; PSA 113:4–113:6**God is present throughout heaven and earth****PSA 139:7–139:12; JER 23:23–23:24** See also NUM 14:21; DEU 4:39; ISA 6:3; ISA 66:1; AMO 9:2–9:3**God sees and knows everything****PRO 15:3** See also 2CH 16:9; ZEC 4:10**God is near to all human beings****ACT 17:27–17:28****God is present with special groups of people**

God is especially close to the poor and needy

PSA 34:18 See also ISA 57:15

God is especially close to those who call on him

PSA 145:18 See also PSA 16:8; ISA 50:8**God's presence with his people**

God is always present with his people

EXO 33:15–33:16 See also PSA 14:5; ISA 43:2; ZEP 3:17; 1CO 14:25**God's promise to be present****JOS 1:9** See also GEN 28:15, GEN 31:3; EXO 29:45; LEV 26:12; DEU 20:1, DEU 31:8; MAT 28:20

God is present in believers through the Holy Spirit

1CO 3:16 See also JHN 14:18; EPH 2:22; 1JN 3:24**God will be acknowledged everywhere****PSA 113:3** See also PSA 72:19, PSA 96:7–96:9, PSA 96:11–96:13; MAL 1:11; REV 5:13**1115: God, purpose of**

God has a plan for his creation which he will certainly accomplish. It is carried out through the control of circumstances and his choice and use of people, and above all in the life, death, resurrection and second coming of Jesus Christ.

God's purpose will be accomplished**ISA 46:10–46:11** See also PSA 135:6; PRO 16:4; ECC 3:14; ISA 14:24, ISA 14:26–14:27, ISA 25:1, ISA 55:11; EPH 1:11**God's purpose prevails**

It stands for ever

PSA 33:11 See also JOB 42:2; JER 23:20

It cannot be thwarted by human beings

PRO 19:21 See also JOB 9:12, JOB 23:13; ISA 8:10; DAN 4:35

It cannot be thwarted by evil powers

REV 17:17 See also ISA 16:14 The implication is that evil is subject to God's control and operates within the determined limits of his sovereign purpose; JOB 1:12, JOB 2:6; 2CO 12:7

It prevails in people's lives and circumstances

PRO 16:9 See also PRO 20:24, PRO 21:1

It is fulfilled through his choice of individuals

EPH 1:11 God's choice of individuals does not invalidate their free will to do or not to do anything, nor remove their answerability to God for their actions. See also GEN 18:19; ROM 11:5; 1CO 1:1; EPH 1:4–1:5; 2TH 2:13

Examples of the actions of evil people serving God's purpose

ACT 2:23 See also GEN 50:20; ISA 10:5–10:7**God's purpose is founded on divine wisdom****EPH 3:10–3:11** See also PSA 104:24; ROM 11:33**God's purpose is determined from eternity****2TI 1:9** See also 2KI 19:25; ISA 25:1, ISA 46:10; MAT 25:34; EPH 1:4; TIT 1:2; 1PE 1:20**God's purpose is for his own glory****EXO 9:16** See also ROM 9:17; EZK 36:22–36:23; EPH 1:5–1:6, EPH 1:11–1:12**God's purpose for his people**

God reveals his purpose to his people

AMO 3:7 See also GEN 18:17; 2SA 7:20–7:21; 1CO 2:9–2:10; EPH 1:9

Its fulness is beyond human understanding

ROM 11:33 See also DEU 29:29; 1CO 2:9–2:10; EPH 1:9, EPH 3:4–3:5

It is good and loving

ROM 8:28 See also JER 29:11; ROM 12:2; EPH 1:4–1:5; 2TI 1:9

God's purpose is revealed through Jesus Christ

In the church
EPH 3:10–3:11

It centres on the cross

ISA 53:10 See also ACT 4:27–4:28; 1PE 1:19–1:20; 1JN 4:10

It is God's purpose to redeem the world through the cross

MAT 26:18, MAT 26:45 parallel MRK 14:41 Jesus Christ often speaks of his appointed "hour". In John's Gospel in particular his "hour" refers to the cross. Jesus Christ refuses to allow anything except the cross to be the climax of his ministry (Jn 12:27).; ; JHN 7:6–7:8, JHN 12:23, JHN 13:1, JHN 17:1

It is God's purpose to exalt and establish Jesus Christ as Lord

EPH 1:9–1:10 See also ACT 2:36; PHP 2:8–2:11; COL 1:18; HEB 1:2–1:4

Jesus Christ submits to God's purpose

JHN 6:38 See also MAT 26:39–26:42 parallels MRK 14:35–14:36, LUK 22:42; JHN 4:34, JHN 5:30; HEB 5:7–5:8, HEB 10:7

God's ultimate purpose is to save

The salvation of people through Jesus Christ

JHN 6:40 See also JHN 3:16–3:17; GAL 1:3–1:4; 1TI 2:3–2:4; 1PE 1:2; 2PE 3:9

Specific aspects of God's purpose in salvation

2CO 5:5 knowing heavenly life; ; ROM 8:29 being conformed to Jesus Christ; ; EPH 1:4 being holy and blameless; ; EPH 2:15 becoming unified; ; EPH 3:10–3:11 that the wisdom of God be revealed

God wills that people submit to his purposes

JAS 4:15 See also PSA 40:8, PSA 143:10; MAT 6:10

God's people should pray for the fulfilment of his purposes

MAT 6:9–6:10 parallel LUK 11:2

People can reject God's purposes in their lives

See also LUK 7:30, LUK 19:41–19:42; ACT 13:46

Examples of God's purposes being worked out

GEN 45:5–45:9 in the life of Joseph; ISA 41:2, ISA 41:25, ISA 45:1, ISA 45:13, ISA 46:11, ISA 48:14; ACT 18:21, ACT 21:14; ; ROM 1:10, ROM 15:32; ; 1CO 4:19

1120: God, repentance of

A change in God's plan or intention, often in response to human repentance, but without implying any fault or moral imperfection on God's part.

God's repentance may show his pain and sorrow

GEN 6:6–6:7 God's change of purpose here involves his intention to punish. See also ISA 15:11, ISA 15:35

God's repentance may show his compassion

JON 4:2 God's change of purpose here involves his compassion for sinners: "relent" in this and other passages may also be translated "repent". See also DEU 32:36; 2SA 24:15–24:16 parallel 1CH 21:14–21:15; PSA 106:45; ISA 38:1–38:5; HOS 11:8; AMO 7:1–7:6

God may repent in response to human repentance

JER 18:8 See also EXO 32:14; 2CH 12:1–12:8; JER 26:13, JER 26:19; JOL 2:13; JON 3:6–3:10

God never repents of his oath or changes his character

NUM 23:19; ; PSA 110:4; ; HEB 6:17–6:18

1125: God, righteousness of

An aspect of God's nature which expresses his unique moral perfection and his readiness to save sinners. It is made known especially through the gospel of Jesus Christ.

God's nature is righteous

PSA 119:137 See also DEU 32:4; PSA 48:10, PSA 97:2, PSA 119:142, PSA 145:17; ISA 45:21; JER 12:1; JHN 17:25

God's righteousness shows his sovereignty

PSA 71:19 See also JOB 37:23; PSA 36:6, PSA 97:6; ISA 5:16

God's righteousness is eternal

PSA 111:3 See also PSA 112:3, PSA 112:9, PSA 119:142, PSA 119:160; ISA 51:8

God's actions are righteous

DAN 9:14 See also JDG 5:11; ISA 12:7; JER 9:24; REV 15:3

God's rule is righteous

PSA 9:8 See also 2SA 23:3–23:4; PSA 96:13, PSA 99:4; JER 9:23–9:24

God's righteous acts are saving acts

PSA 65:5 See also PSA 40:10, PSA 116:4–116:6, PSA 129:4; ISA 41:10, ISA 46:13; DAN 9:16; MIC 6:5

God's righteousness vindicates his people

PSA 35:24 See also PSA 4:2–4:3, PSA 7:9, PSA 9:4, PSA 103:6; ISA 50:8; MIC 7:9; ROM 8:33

God's righteousness shows his faithfulness

NEH 9:8 See also PSA 4:1; ZEP 3:5; ZEC 8:8

God's righteousness shows his justice

JER 11:20 See also GEN 18:25; JOB 8:3; PSA 11:7, PSA 50:6, PSA 51:4; PRO 21:12; ECC 3:17; 2TI 4:8

God's righteousness is seen in his judgments

PSA 7:11 See also 2CH 12:5–12:6; EZR 9:15; ISA 10:22, ISA 28:17; LAM 1:18; MAL 3:5; ROM 2:2, ROM 2:5

God's laws show his righteousness

PSA 19:8–19:9 See also DEU 4:8; PSA 33:4, PSA 119:7, PSA 119:144; ROM 1:32, ROM 7:12, ROM 8:4

God's righteousness contrasts with human un-righteousness

ROM 3:5 See also EXO 9:27; NEH 9:33; JOB 4:17, JOB 9:2; DAN 9:7; ROM 10:3

God's righteousness is revealed primarily in Jesus Christ

ROM 3:21–3:22 See also ISA 11:2–11:5; JER 23:6; ZEC 9:9; ACT 3:14; ROM 10:4; 1CO 1:30; 2PE 1:1; 1JN 2:1

God's righteousness is revealed in the gospel

ROM 1:17 See also PHP 3:9

God gives his righteousness to believers

ROM 4:22–4:24 See also GEN 15:6; JOB 33:26; HOS 10:12; ROM 3:22, ROM 4:3–4:8, ROM 5:17, ROM 10:4; 2CO 5:21

The Holy Spirit reveals God's righteousness

GAL 5:5 See also JHN 16:8, JHN 16:10; ROM 14:17

God's righteousness is to be sought after

MAT 6:33 See also ISA 51:1; ZEP 2:3

God's righteousness is a pattern for human living

1JN 3:7 See also GEN 18:19; HOS 14:9; EPH 4:24; 1JN 2:29, 1JN 3:12

God's righteousness is worthy of praise

ISA 24:15–24:16 See also PSA 7:17, PSA 22:31, PSA 35:28, PSA 51:14, PSA 71:15, PSA 71:24, PSA 145:7

1130: God, sovereignty of

The fact that God is free and able to do all that he wills; that he reigns over all creation and that his will is the final cause of all things. This is often expressed in the language of kingship.

God is free to do all he wills

PSA 135:6 See also PSA 115:3; ISA 46:10; DAN 4:35; ROM 9:19–9:21

God is able to do whatever he wills

LUK 1:37 Gabriel speaking to Mary. See also JOB 42:2; MAT 19:26; EPH 3:20

God cannot be successfully opposed

JOB 42:2 From Job's prayer of submission and repentance. See also ISA 2:10; 2CH 20:6; JOB 9:12; ECC 7:13; ISA 43:13, ISA 45:9–45:10; ACT 5:39

God rules and reigns**He is King**

PSA 29:10 See also 1CH 16:31; PSA 47:2; ISA 6:5, ISA 43:15; JER 10:7, JER 10:10; ZEC 14:9; 1TI 1:17, 1TI 6:15; REV 15:3, REV 19:6

He is Lord of heaven and earth

DEU 4:39 See also GEN 24:3; DEU 10:14; JOS 2:11; 1CH 29:11; NEH 9:6; PSA 121:2, PSA 134:3; LUK 10:21; ACT 17:24

His throne is a symbol of his sovereignty

EXO 17:16; ; PSA 45:6, PSA 93:2, PSA 123:1; ; ISA 6:1 Isaiah's commission; ; ISA 66:1; ; JER 49:38; ; LAM 5:19; ; EZK 1:26; ; DAN 7:9 Daniel's dream; ; MAT 5:34, MAT 19:28 Jesus Christ teaches his disciples about things to come; ; ACT 7:49; ; HEB 1:8, HEB 8:1, HEB 12:2; ; REV 4:2, REV 20:11

God's sovereignty extends over all things**He is sovereign over creation**

REV 4:11 See also PSA 93:1; ISA 40:22, ISA 41:18–41:19

He is sovereign over human life

1CH 29:12 Part of David's prayer on the occasion of gifts being brought to the temple. See also 2CH 25:8; LUK 1:51–1:53; ACT 18:21; JAS 4:15

He is sovereign over the minutest details of life

MAT 10:29–10:30 parallel LUK 12:6–12:7

He is sovereign in electing his people

EPH 1:11 See also ROM 8:29, ROM 9:11, ROM 9:18

He is sovereign in the life and salvation of his people

1CO 1:30 See also JER 18:6; 1CO 12:11; PHP 2:13; JAS 1:18

He is sovereign over the sufferings of believers

PHP 1:29; ; 1PE 3:17

He is sovereign over world history

PRO 21:1 See also EXO 9:16; PSA 22:28; JER 18:7–18:10; DAN 4:35

God is sovereign over all other gods and over demonic forces**God is supreme over all gods**

PSA 95:3 "gods" are part of the created order and subject to God's sovereignty. See also EXO 18:11; DEU 10:17; 1CH 16:26; PSA 96:5; DAN 2:47; COL 1:16

Satan is defeated through God's sovereign purposes at work in Jesus Christ

COL 2:15 See also JHN 12:31; ROM 16:20; 2TH 2:8; HEB 2:14; 2PE 2:4; 1JN 3:8; JUD 1:6; REV 12:7-12:10

1135: God, suffering of

God suffers on account of the failures and pain of his people, and especially through his Son, Jesus Christ. Scripture often likens God to a parent who suffers pain and grief on account of children.

God feels real suffering

He suffers pain because people sin

GEN 6:6 See also ISA 15:10-15:11, ISA 15:35

He is angered because people sin

PSA 78:58 See also DEU 32:15-32:16; JDG 2:12-2:13; 1KI 21:22; EZK 8:17; HOS 12:14

God identifies with suffering

He suffers with his chosen people

ISA 63:9 See also EXO 3:7; JDG 10:16; 2CH 36:15

He suffers with all humanity

ISA 16:11 parallel JER 48:31 See also 2SA 24:15-24:17 parallel 1CH 21:14-21:17 God suffers even with those who endure punishment from his own hand; ISA 16:9; JER 48:32-48:36; HOS 11:8-11:9

He suffers as a parent

JER 31:20 An indication that God suffers in both disciplining and loving. See also ISA 42:14, ISA 49:15; HOS 11:1-11:4

God's plan of salvation causes him suffering

He suffered in giving his Son

ROM 8:32 See also ISA 7:13-7:14; JHN 3:16; ROM 3:25-3:26, ROM 8:3; GAL 4:4; HEB 1:2; 1JN 4:14

He suffers because he endures the rejection his Son suffers

LUK 10:16 See also 1PE 2:4

God's creation reflects his suffering

ROM 8:22 See also ROM 8:19-8:21

God's people share his suffering

ROM 8:17 There is a sense in which the sufferings of Father and Son are indistinguishable. See also MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23; MAT 20:22-20:23 parallel MRK 10:38-10:39; PHP 1:29; 1PE 2:21

1140: God, the eternal

God transcends all limitations of time and endures for ever.

God endures for ever

NEH 9:5 See also DEU 32:40, DEU 33:27; JOB 36:26; PSA 48:14, PSA 102:12; ISA 40:28; HAB 1:12

God transcends all concepts of time

REV 1:8 See also PSA 90:4; ISA 41:4; 1CO 2:7; HEB 13:8; 2PE 3:8; REV 11:17, REV 22:13

He existed before time

PSA 90:2 See also PRO 8:23; JHN 17:5, JHN 17:24; EPH 1:4; 1PE 1:20

He will exist after time

HEB 1:11-1:12 See also PSA 102:26-102:27

The eternity of God's qualities

His love

1CH 16:34 parallel PSA 106:1 See also 2CH 5:13; PSA 103:17; JER 31:3; HOS 2:19

His faithfulness

PSA 100:5 See also PSA 117:2, PSA 146:6

His power

PSA 66:7 See also ROM 1:20; 1PE 5:11

His righteousness

PSA 111:3 See also PSA 112:3, PSA 119:142; DAN 9:24

God's word is eternal

PSA 119:89 See also MRK 13:31; 1PE 1:24-1:25; ISA 40:8

God's covenant is eternal

GEN 17:7 See also NUM 18:19; PSA 105:10; ISA 24:5, ISA 54:10, ISA 55:3; JER 32:40

God's kingdom is eternal

PSA 145:13 See also EXO 15:18; PSA 9:7, PSA 45:6; LAM 5:19; DAN 4:3, DAN 7:14, DAN 7:27; 2PE 1:11

God's gifts are eternal

ROM 11:29

He gives eternal life

JHN 10:28 See also JHN 5:24, JHN 6:47; ROM 2:7, ROM 6:23

He gives eternal salvation

ISA 45:17 See also HEB 5:9, HEB 9:12

He gives eternal joy

ISA 35:10 See also PSA 16:11; ISA 51:11, ISA 61:7

He gives eternal possessions

GEN 48:4 See also GEN 17:8

1145: God, transcendence of

God is far above, beyond and outside the created order.

God is outside and above all creation

PSA 113:4; ISA 40:22 1KI 8:27; ; 2CH 2:6; JOB 37:23 Elihu declares the LORD to be beyond reach; ; PSA 8:1, PSA 57:5, PSA 57:11, PSA 97:9, PSA 108:5, PSA 148:13; ; ISA 33:5; ; ACT 7:49, ACT 17:24; ; EPH 1:20–1:21 Jesus Christ is above all, in the place of highest honour and authority; ; EPH 4:6; ; HEB 7:26

**God is able also to draw near to his creatures
ISA 57:15****The invisibility of God**

God is invisible to people and hidden from their sight
EXO 33:20; ISA 45:15 See also EXO 3:6JOB 9:11, JOB 23:8–23:9 PSA 10:1, PSA 13:1, PSA 89:46; JHN 1:18 Jesus Christ has made God known; JHN 5:37; COL 1:15 Jesus Christ is the image of God; 1TI 1:17, 1TI 6:16; 1JN 4:12

OT saints who saw God

EXO 33:11 These exceptions indicate that God's invisibility is not inherent, but the result of sinful people's inability to look upon a holy God. See also GEN 32:30; EXO 24:10; JDG 13:22; ISA 6:5

God is made visible in Jesus Christ

JHN 1:18, JHN 14:9; ; 2CO 4:4, 2CO 4:6; ; COL 1:15

Redeemed people will be able to look at God's face
MAT 5:8; ; 1CO 13:12; ; 1JN 3:2; ; REV 22:4

God's ways are beyond human understanding

ISA 55:8–55:9 See also DEU 29:29; JOB 5:9, JOB 11:7, JOB 36:22–36:23; PSA 139:1–139:6; PRO 25:2; ECC 3:11; ISA 40:28; ROM 11:33–11:34; 1CO 2:11, 1CO 2:16

1150: God, truth of

God's unique integrity is displayed in his perfection of character and attributes. It is further emphasised by the consistent truth of his words and works, supremely shown in Jesus Christ.

God is the one and only true God**He alone is God**

JER 10:10 See also DEU 4:39; 2CH 15:3; ISA 43:10–43:11, ISA 45:5–45:6, ISA 45:14, ISA 45:21; ZEC 14:9; JHN 1:18, JHN 17:3; REV 6:10

The contrast with other ``gods``

ROM 1:25 See also EXO 15:11; DEU 4:35, DEU 32:39; PSA 86:8; ISA 43:3; 1TH 1:9

The contrast with earthly rulers

JER 10:6–10:8

God is characterised by truth

PSA 31:5 See also PSA 40:10, PSA 43:3; ISA 65:16; JHN 3:33, JHN 7:28, JHN 8:26; 1JN 5:20; REV 15:3

God's truth is demonstrated in the revelation of himself in Jesus Christ**Jesus Christ is ``the truth``**

JHN 14:6 In the light of this statement it may be concluded that truth is actually defined by the person and work of Jesus Christ. See also 1JN 5:20

Jesus Christ and the Spirit bring truth

JHN 1:14, JHN 14:16–14:17; ; ROM 15:8

God's words are truthful**His words are consistently true and reliable**

NUM 23:19 See also 1SA 15:29; PSA 12:6, PSA 33:4, PSA 119:151, PSA 119:160; ROM 3:4; TIT 1:2; HEB 6:18; JAS 1:17

His words of promise are totally true and trustworthy

PSA 132:11 See also 2TI 2:13 The guarantee of God's faithfulness is the truthfulness of his promises which depend in turn upon the truth that characterises God himself; HEB 7:21; PSA 110:4

God's people live in the light of his truth

PSA 86:11 See also PSA 26:3, PSA 119:141–119:142; DAN 9:13; JHN 17:17

1155: God, truthfulness of

To call the LORD "the true God" means that he alone has in his being the fulness of deity and is worthy to be worshipped as God. He and his word are a trustworthy foundation for life because he speaks the truth and is utterly reliable and consistent in his character, his revelation of himself, his promises and his pronouncements.

Titles reflecting God's truthfulness**The true God**

2CH 15:3; ; JER 10:10; ; 1TH 1:9

The God of truth

PSA 31:5; ; ISA 65:16

Jesus Christ is ``the truth``

JHN 14:6 See also JHN 1:14, JHN 1:17, JHN 6:32 Jesus Christ calls himself "the true bread" meaning that he is real, substantial, reliable and life-giving; 1JN 5:20; REV 3:7, REV 3:14

The Spirit of truth

JHN 14:17, JHN 15:26, JHN 16:13; ; 1JN 4:6, 1JN 5:6

God is true to his character and his word

He speaks the truth

ISA 45:19 See also 2SA 7:28; PSA 33:4, PSA 119:160; JHN 17:17; REV 21:5, REV 22:6

He does not lie

NUM 23:19 See also ROM 3:4; 2TI 2:13; TIT 1:2; HEB 6:18

He is true to himself and his promises

DEU 32:4; ; PSA 25:10, PSA 33:4, PSA 145:13, PSA 146:6; ; LAM 3:23; ; 2TI 2:13

The truthfulness of God undergirds the law

PSA 119:142 See also PSA 19:7, PSA 119:151, PSA 119:160; MAL 2:6–2:7

The truthfulness of God undergirds the covenant

PSA 25:10 The Hebrew word translated “faithful” can also be translated “true”. The word is particularly associated with God steadfastly upholding his covenant promises. See also PSA 145:13; HOS 2:19–2:20; 2TI 2:13

The truthfulness of God undergirds the prophetic word

EZK 12:25 See also ISA 55:11; JER 1:12, JER 28:9; EZK 33:33; DAN 2:45

The truthfulness of God undergirds his promises

JOS 23:14–23:15 See also NUM 23:19; 1KI 8:20; PSA 105:42; ROM 4:20–4:21

The truthfulness of God undergirds his judgment

PSA 96:13 See also PSA 98:9; ISA 11:3–11:5; ROM 2:2

The truthfulness of God undergirds the teaching of Jesus Christ

JHN 1:17 See also MAT 5:18, MAT 22:16 parallels MRK 12:14, LUK 20:21; MRK 3:28; LUK 4:24; JHN 1:51, JHN 8:31–8:32, JHN 18:37

1160: God, unchangeableness of

God’s nature, plans and actions do not change even though he is active and his relationships do not remain static. His moral consistency guarantees his commitment to unchanging principles.

God’s being is unchangeable

PSA 102:27 See also HEB 1:12; MAL 3:6; HEB 13:8; JAS 1:17

God’s characteristics do not change

God’s love is constant

PSA 89:2 See also PSA 136:1–136:26; 2TI 2:13

God’s purposes and plans do not change

HEB 6:17 See also NUM 23:19; ISA 15:29; PRO 19:21; JER 44:29; HEB 7:21; PSA 110:4

God does not revoke his promises

PSA 132:11 See also PSA 145:13; HEB 4:1

God’s word does not change

ISA 40:8 See also PSA 119:89; MAT 5:18; 1PE 1:23–1:25

God’s failure to inflict promised judgment is a sign of his unchanging grace

HOS 11:8 See also EXO 32:10–32:14; JON 3:10, JON 4:2

1165: God, uniqueness of

No-one and nothing is comparable to the triune God in his nature or comparable to him in his character and activity.

There is no God except the LORD

ISA 45:5–45:6 God alone stands outside nature as its Creator. All other beings are created by him. See also DEU 4:35, DEU 6:4, DEU 32:3; 1KI 8:60; PSA 83:18, PSA 86:10; ISA 43:10–43:11, ISA 44:6–44:8, ISA 45:18; 1CO 8:4–8:6; EPH 4:6; 1TI 2:5

There is no-one like God

PSA 89:6–89:8 See also EXO 8:10; ISA 40:18

In his creative power

ISA 40:25–40:26 See also JHN 1:3; NEH 9:6; ACT 14:15; COL 1:16; REV 4:11

In his mighty acts

PSA 86:10 See also PSA 135:5–135:6

In his character and glory

EXO 15:11 See also 2SA 7:22; 1CH 29:11

In his ability to save

DEU 33:26 See also ISA 45:20–45:22; JER 10:5–10:6

In his covenant love

1KI 8:23 See also 2SA 7:22–7:23 parallel 1CH 17:20–17:21

In his sovereignty

ZEC 14:9 See also DEU 4:39; 1TI 1:17

Implications of God’s uniqueness

God alone is to be worshipped

EXO 20:2–20:3 parallel DEU 5:6–5:7 See also EXO 23:13, EXO 23:24; LEV 19:4; DEU 6:13–6:14; 2KI 17:35

Idolatry is empty and worthless

JON 2:8 See also DEU 4:28; ISA 44:18–44:20, ISA 45:20; HAB 2:18

1170: God, unity of

God acts as a unity in all his deeds. The three persons of the Trinity are united in one Godhead. They are interrelated with one another, share the same attributes and co-operate in the same work. God's characteristics are consistent, expressing his integral divine nature.

God is one

DEU 6:4 See also MRK 12:29, MRK 12:32; 1CO 8:4; GAL 3:20; EPH 4:5-4:6; 1TI 2:5; JAS 2:19

The three persons of the Trinity are united in one Godhead

All three are interrelated

ROM 8:9-8:11 The interchange between the persons of the Trinity reflects their unity in terms of activity. See also JHN 14:23; 2CO 13:14; EPH 2:18; 1PE 1:2

The Son is one with the Father

JHN 10:30 See also MAT 10:40; MRK 9:37 parallel LUK 9:48; LUK 10:16; JHN 8:16, JHN 14:9

The Spirit is one with God

2SA 23:2-23:3 See also PSA 51:11; 1CO 3:16

The three persons are one in character

All three are eternal

ROM 16:26 the Father; ; ISA 9:6 the Son; ; HEB 9:14 the Spirit

All three are all-knowing

ISA 40:13-40:14 the Father; JHN 2:24-2:25, JHN 21:17; 1CO 2:10-2:11 the Spirit

All three are holy

JHN 17:11 the Father; MRK 1:24; ; ACT 3:14; JHN 14:26; ; ROM 1:4

All three are called Lord and God

The Father: MAT 11:25; ; ACT 3:22; ; 1CO 8:6; JHN 1:1, JHN 20:28; ; ACT 10:36; ; 2PE 1:1; ACT 5:3-5:4; ; 2CO 3:17-3:18

All three are glorious

The Father: ACT 7:2; ; EPH 1:17; JHN 1:14, JHN 12:41; 2CO 3:8, 2CO 3:18; ; 1PE 4:14

The three persons share in the same work

In creation

GEN 1:1-1:3 See also PSA 33:6, PSA 104:30; JHN 1:3-1:4; COL 1:16

In Jesus Christ's ministry

JHN 3:34 See also ACT 10:38

In salvation

1PE 1:2 See also 2CO 1:21-1:22; TIT 3:4-3:6

In indwelling the church

EPH 2:22 1CO 3:16, 1CO 6:19; GAL 2:20; ; EPH 3:17

In directing the church's mission

ACT 16:6-16:10 ACT 14:27; ; GAL 1:1; MAT 28:18-28:20; ; ACT 1:7-1:8; ACT 13:2, ACT 13:4

God's characteristics are consistent

His love and justice are in unity

EXO 34:6-34:7 See also 2SA 7:14-7:15; PSA 103:6-103:8; ROM 3:25-3:26

His wrath and mercy are in unity

JOL 2:11-2:13 See also JHN 3:16-3:18 It is particularly in the cross of Jesus Christ that the perfect balance between God's wrath and justice and his love and mercy are seen; ROM 2:4, ROM 2:7-2:8

1175: God, will of

The intent and purpose of God, as revealed in Scripture. God's will for his creation and his people is set out in the Law and the Prophets, which find their fulfilment in Jesus Christ. A central aspect of the will of God is that his people be faithful and obedient.

The revelation of God's will

In his word

2TI 3:16 See also 2SA 7:21 parallel 1CH 17:19; PSA 103:20-103:21; COL 1:25-1:26; 1JN 2:4-2:5

Through the law

EXO 18:15-18:16, EXO 24:12; ; DEU 30:16; ; PSA 119:43; ; ROM 7:12; ; 1TI 1:8

Through the prophets

1KI 22:6-22:7 parallel 2CH 18:5-18:6; ; 2KI 3:11; ; JER 42:3-42:4; ; EZK 12:25; ; AMO 3:7

In the apostolic gospel

ACT 20:27; ; GAL 1:11-1:12

The fulfilment of God's will

God's will is fulfilled in Jesus Christ

EPH 1:9-1:10 See also EPH 3:4-3:11; COL 1:27

Jesus Christ obeyed his Father's will

JHN 6:38 See also MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42; JHN 4:34, JHN 5:30; HEB 10:7; PSA 40:8

Jesus Christ's death fulfilled God's will

GAL 1:3-1:4 See also ISA 53:10; ACT 2:23

God's will for the world

God desires justice and righteousness

AMO 5:24 See also PSA 33:5; ISA 5:7; JER 9:24; MIC 6:8

God desires honesty and truth

PRO 12:22 See also EXO 20:16 parallel DEU 5:20; LEV 19:35–19:36; PRO 11:1; ZEC 8:16–8:17

God desires harmony and peace

1TI 2:2–2:3 See also ISA 2:3–2:4 parallel MIC 4:2–4:3; ISA 11:6–11:9

God desires the world to be saved

1TI 2:4 See also EZK 18:23, EZK 33:11; MAT 18:14; JHN 3:16–3:17; 2PE 3:9

God's will for his redeemed people**God desires loving obedience**

MAT 22:35–22:38 parallels MRK 12:28–12:29, LUK 10:27
See also DEU 6:5PSA 51:16–51:17; ISA 1:11; JER 7:22–7:23; 1JN 2:5

God desires worship

1PE 2:9 See also PSA 100:4; ISA 45:23; 1TH 5:18; REV 1:6

God desires holiness

1TH 4:3 See also LEV 19:1–19:2; 1CO 1:2; COL 1:22; 1TH 4:7; HEB 10:10; 1PE 1:15–1:16

God desires love for one another

JHN 13:34–13:35 See also LEV 19:18; MAT 22:39 parallels MRK 12:31, LUK 10:27; JHN 15:12–15:13; GAL 5:14; 1JN 3:11

God desires high moral standards

1PE 2:15 See also MAT 5:16, MAT 5:48; 1PE 3:4

God's will may involve suffering

1PE 3:17 See also ACT 14:22, ACT 21:13–21:14; HEB 12:5–12:7; 1PE 4:19

Proper responses to God's will**Discovering God's will**

EPH 5:17 See also ROM 2:18; COL 1:9

Obeying God's will

MAT 7:21 See also EZR 10:11; MAT 12:50 parallel MRK 3:35; EPH 6:6; HEB 13:21; JAS 4:15

Praying for God's will

MAT 6:10 See also PSA 143:10; MAT 26:42; JHN 14:13–14:14; 1JN 5:14

Making radical changes to do God's will

ROM 12:2 See also ROM 8:5; GAL 5:16–5:17; JAS 1:20; 1PE 1:14, 1PE 4:2; 1JN 2:15–2:17

Rejecting God's will

LUK 7:30 See also PSA 107:11; ISA 30:1; EZK 3:7; MAT 23:37 parallel LUK 13:34; JHN 8:44

Examples of people who obeyed God's will

DEU 33:21 Gad; ISA 13:14; ; ACT 13:22, ACT 13:36; ISA 44:28–45:1 Cyrus; ACT 18:21, ACT 21:14; ; ROM 1:10, ROM 15:32; ; 1CO 4:19

Ways of discovering God's will

EXO 18:20 teaching; ; EXO 28:30 Urim and Thummim; ; PSA 86:11 prayer; ; PSA 119:105 God's word; ; DAN 2:22–2:23 revelation; ; JHN 14:26 the Holy Spirit; ; ACT 1:26 drawing lots

God's will and the human will**God's will overrules human wills**

PRO 19:21 See also PSA 33:10–33:11; PRO 16:9

God's will overrides the desires of the wicked

GEN 50:20; ; ISA 10:5–10:11; ; HAB 1:5–1:11; ; ACT 2:23

God's will can harmonise with human wills

1CH 13:2; ; PSA 37:4, PSA 145:19; ; ACT 15:28

God's will is sovereign**Over all things**

EPH 1:11

Over creation

See also MAT 10:29; ROM 8:20; REV 4:11

Over evil

GEN 45:8; ; 1SA 2:25; ; PRO 16:4; ; ISA 65:12; ; ROM 9:18

Over the gospel

MIC 7:18; ; MAT 11:25–11:26 parallel LUK 10:21; ; JHN 5:21; ; ACT 13:48; ; ROM 9:18; ; 1CO 1:21

In the church

1CO 1:1, 1CO 12:11, 1CO 12:28; ; PHP 2:13; ; 2TI 1:1; ; HEB 2:4

1180: God, wisdom of

Scripture declares that God alone is wise and discerning, and that human wisdom is often unable or unwilling to understand his ways. God's wisdom is expressed in both creation and redemption.

God's wisdom described

ISA 28:29 See also 1SA 2:3; ROM 16:27

God's wisdom is beyond measure

PSA 147:5 See also ISA 44:7; JER 10:7; ROM 11:33

God's wisdom is profound

ISA 40:28 See also JOB 9:4, JOB 28:12–28:24; PSA 92:5; ECC 8:17

God's wisdom is superior to human wisdom

ISA 55:9 See also JOB 21:22

God's wisdom exhibited

God's wisdom in creation

JER 10:12 See also JOB 28:25–28:27, JOB 37:14–37:16; PSA 104:24, PSA 136:5; PRO 3:19–3:20; ISA 40:12–40:14

God's wisdom as an agent in creation

PRO 8:22–8:31 Wisdom here is given personality, and may refer to the pre-incarnate Jesus Christ.

God's wisdom in historical events

ISA 31:2 See also JOB 12:13–12:25; DAN 2:20–2:22

God's wisdom in knowing the human mind

1CH 28:9 See also PSA 139:2, PSA 139:4, PSA 139:6

Jesus Christ the wisdom of God

1CO 1:30 See also ISA 9:6, ISA 11:2; 1CO 1:24; COL 2:2–2:3

God's wisdom in the gospel

1CO 1:25 See also 1CO 1:18–1:21; EPH 3:10

God gives his wisdom to human beings

EPH 1:17 See also 2CH 1:11–1:12; EZR 7:25; PRO 2:6; ECC 12:11; DAN 2:23; 1CO 2:6–2:16; JAS 1:5

Examples of God's wisdom

ISA 16:7; ; 1KI 3:28; ; ISA 28:24–28:29; ; LUK 11:49

1185: God, zeal of

The intense and protective commitment of God to his people and to his purposes which seeks a passionate and obedient response. The zeal of God is often linked with the idea of the “jealousy of God”, in which God refuses to contemplate his people giving their allegiance or affection to another.

God in his zeal demands exclusive loyalty from his people

EXO 20:5 The jealousy of God implies that he seeks for and insists on exclusive loyalty which is due to him and which will benefit those who give it. See also EXO 34:14; DEU 4:24, DEU 5:9; JOS 24:19; NAM 1:2

God's zeal for the honour of his name

ISA 42:8 See also EXO 20:7; DEU 32:51; ISA 48:9–48:11; EZK 20:9, EZK 20:14, EZK 20:22, EZK 36:20–36:23, EZK 39:7, EZK 39:25

God's zeal on behalf of his people

ZEC 1:14 See also 2KI 19:31 parallel ISA 37:32; JOL 2:18; ZEC 8:2

God's zeal to establish the Messiah's reign

ISA 9:7

God's zeal is aroused by his people's idolatry

DEU 32:16 See also DEU 29:20, DEU 32:21; 1KI 14:22; PSA 78:58; EZK 8:3, EZK 8:5, EZK 16:38, EZK 23:25; 1CO 10:21–10:22

God's zeal in judgment

He judges the nations

EZK 36:5–36:6, EZK 38:18–38:19; ; ZEP 1:18, ZEP 3:8

He restrains his zeal in judgment

EZK 16:42 See also NUM 25:11

God's people appeal for his zeal to be shown

ISA 63:15 See also PSA 74:10–74:11; ISA 26:11

God's people reflect his zeal

NUM 25:11–25:13 See also 1KI 19:10, 1KI 19:14; PRO 23:17; ROM 12:11

1190: glory

The distinctive feature of the presence of God, often compared to power, weight or brightness. Scripture affirms that God's glory is made known through his work of creation, his acts of intervention in history and supremely in the life and resurrection of Jesus Christ.

1191: glory, of God

See [1045: God, glory of](#)

1192: glory, of Jesus Christ

See [2024: Jesus Christ, glory of](#)

1193: glory, revelation of

God's majestic brilliance shown to the world through Israel and the church, and supremely in and through Jesus Christ.

God's glory revealed in nature

PSA 19:1 See also GEN 1:31; PSA 29:3–29:9, PSA 104:1–104:4; ROM 1:20

God's glory revealed through Israel

In the exodus

EXO 15:11 See also EXO 16:7, EXO 16:10, EXO 24:9–24:11

At his sanctuary

EXO 40:34–40:35 See also EXO 29:43; LEV 9:6, LEV 9:23; NUM 20:6; 1KI 8:10–8:11 parallel 2CH 5:13–5:14; 2CH 7:1–7:3; ISA 6:1; EZK 44:4; HAG 2:7

In the nation as a whole

ISA 44:23 See also PSA 85:9; ISA 43:6–43:7, ISA 46:13, ISA 49:3, ISA 55:5; ZEC 2:4–2:5

To individuals in Israel

Moses: EXO 24:15–24:17, EXO 33:18–33:23; EZK 1:28, EZK 3:23, EZK 8:4, EZK 9:3, EZK 10:4, EZK 10:18–10:19, EZK 11:22–11:23, EZK 43:2–43:5

God's glory revealed through the church

2CO 3:18 See also EPH 1:12, EPH 3:21; 1PE 4:14

God's glory revealed to the whole earth**To all peoples**

PSA 57:5 parallel PSA 108:5 **HAB 3:3** See also PSA 57:11, PSA 72:19, PSA 97:6; ISA 6:3, ISA 40:5

God's glory revealed in his judgments

REV 19:1–19:2 See also NUM 14:10, NUM 14:21–14:23, NUM 16:19–16:20; ISA 2:10, ISA 2:19, ISA 2:21; EZK 39:21; REV 15:8

God's glory revealed in the future

ISA 60:19–60:20 See also ISA 4:5, ISA 24:23, ISA 35:2, ISA 58:8, ISA 60:1–60:2

God's glory revealed through Jesus Christ**Jesus Christ reveals God's glory**

HEB 1:3 See also LUK 2:9; JHN 11:40, JHN 14:8–14:9; ACT 7:55

Jesus Christ reveals his own glory

JHN 1:14 See also LUK 9:32; JHN 2:11, JHN 12:41, JHN 17:24; HEB 2:9; 2PE 1:16–1:17

Glory revealed in Jesus Christ's death

JHN 12:23 See also JHN 12:27–12:33, JHN 13:31–13:32

Glory revealed at Jesus Christ's second coming

MAT 16:27 parallels MRK 8:38, LUK 9:26; ; MAT 24:30 parallels MRK 13:26, LUK 21:27; ; MAT 25:31; ; 2TH 1:10

God's glory revealed in the new Jerusalem

REV 21:10–21:11 See also REV 21:23

1194: glory, divine and human

Through the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ, believers will finally be glorified. All human glory derives from God.

Human glory in the creation**Human glory as God's intention**

HEB 2:6–2:7 See also PSA 8:4–8:5

People are created in God's image

GEN 5:1 See also GEN 1:26–1:27, GEN 9:6; 1CO 11:7; JAS 3:9

Human beings have precedence over the rest of creation

MAT 6:26 parallel LUK 12:24 See also MAT 10:29–10:31 parallel LUK 12:6–12:7; MAT 12:12

Human responsibility for creation

GEN 2:19–2:20 See also GEN 1:28; PSA 8:6–8:8; HEB 2:8; JAS 3:7

Human glory diminished after the fall

ROM 3:23 See also GEN 5:3; ECC 7:29; ROM 5:12

The imperfect nature of human glory

1PE 1:24–1:25 See also ISA 40:6–40:8; PSA 49:10–49:11, PSA 49:16–49:17, PSA 103:15; 2CO 3:7–3:8, 2CO 3:10, 2CO 3:13

Human glory is given and taken by God

PSA 82:6–82:7 See also EXO 9:16; 1KI 3:13 parallel 2CH 1:12; JER 27:6–27:7; DAN 2:37–2:39, DAN 4:29–4:31, DAN 4:36; JHN 19:11; ROM 13:1

The temporary nature of the glory of the wicked

PHP 3:19 See also ISA 5:15; LUK 16:25; REV 18:14–18:17

The temptation associated with human glory

MAT 4:8–4:9 parallel LUK 4:5–4:7 See also 2TI 4:10; 1JN 2:15

The uniqueness of God's glory

JOB 40:9–40:10 God shows Job the impossibility of human beings attaining the perfection of God's glory. See also EXO 15:11; 1CH 16:24–16:28 parallel PSA 96:3–96:7; ISA 42:8, ISA 48:11

God's glory revealed to human beings

EXO 24:17 See also EXO 16:10; PSA 26:8; EZK 1:25–1:28; LUK 2:9; ACT 7:55

Glory is not to be sought from other human beings but from God

MAT 6:2 See also JER 9:23–9:24; HOS 4:7; JHN 5:41–5:44; PHP 3:3; 1TH 2:4–2:6; JAS 4:16

It is a human duty to glorify God

PSA 34:3 See also PSA 63:3, PSA 86:12; DAN 4:37; ROM 15:6; GAL 1:3–1:5

Glory is restored to redeemed humanity by the death of Jesus Christ

ROM 8:30 See also ROM 9:23; 1CO 15:47–15:49; COL 3:10

Spiritual glory is divinely given

JHN 17:22 See also PSA 84:11; 2CO 3:18

Glorification when Jesus Christ returns**COL 3:4** See also ROM 8:18; PHP 3:21; 1TH 2:20; 1JN 3:2**1200: God, titles and descriptions of**

- 1205: God, titles and names of
- 1250: Abba
- 1255: face of God
- 1260: finger of God
- 1265: hand of God
- 1270: right hand of God

1205: God, titles and names of

These reflect the great and varied aspects of God's being and character. They are particularly used by the psalmists to speak of God as a source of strength, security, blessing and hope.

Titles which denote God's greatness**God Almighty**

GEN 17:1 This was the special name by which God revealed himself to the patriarchs. The Hebrew is "El-Shaddai" possibly meaning "God the mountain", emphasising God's might. See also GEN 28:3, GEN 48:3; EXO 6:3; RUT 1:20-1:21; JOB 5:17 JOB 6:4, JOB 37:23 PSA 91:1; REV 16:14, REV 19:15

God Most High

GEN 14:18-14:20 The Hebrew "El-Elyon" denotes the supremacy and sovereignty of God. See also GEN 14:22; DEU 32:8; 2SA 22:14 parallel PSA 18:13; PSA 9:2, PSA 21:7, PSA 46:4, PSA 47:2, PSA 78:35, PSA 97:9; ISA 14:14; DAN 3:26 MRK 5:7 parallel LUK 8:28; LUK 1:32, LUK 1:35 LUK 6:35; ACT 16:17

The Eternal God

GEN 21:33 The Hebrew "El-Olam" only occurs in this verse. See also DEU 33:27; ROM 16:26

The Ancient of Days

DAN 7:9, DAN 7:13, DAN 7:22

The Mighty One

LUK 1:49 See also JOS 22:22; PSA 50:1, PSA 132:2, PSA 132:5; ISA 1:24, ISA 49:26, ISA 60:16; MRK 14:62

The living God

PSA 84:2; DAN 6:26-6:27 See also DEU 5:26; JOS 3:10; 1SA 17:26, 1SA 17:36; 2KI 19:16 parallel ISA 37:17; PSA 42:2; JER 10:10; MAT 16:16; ACT 14:15; HEB 10:31

The Holy One of Israel

ISA 12:6 "the Holy One of Israel" is a favourite divine title in the book of Isaiah. See also 2KI 19:22 parallel ISA 37:23; PSA 71:22, PSA 78:41, PSA 89:18; ISA 30:12, ISA 30:15, ISA 41:14, ISA 45:11, ISA 55:5, ISA 60:9

The LORD

GEN 4:26; EXO 6:2 See also EXO 3:15, EXO 34:5-34:7

Titles which refer to God as LORD

DEU 10:17, DEU 28:10; ; 1KI 2:3; ; PSA 146:10; ; JER 14:9; ; DAN 9:14

The Lord God

REV 1:8, REV 22:5

The LORD God Almighty

PSA 89:8 See also PSA 80:4; JER 5:14, JER 15:16; HOS 12:5; AMO 4:13

The LORD Most High

PSA 7:17 See also PSA 47:2, PSA 97:9

The Sovereign LORD

2SA 7:28 See also DEU 9:26; JOS 7:7; ISA 25:8; JER 32:17; AMO 7:2

Titles referring to God as the source of light

2SA 22:29; ; PSA 27:1, PSA 84:11 the sun; ; ISA 10:17 the Light of Israel; ; MIC 7:8; ; JAS 1:17 the Father of the heavenly lights

Titles referring to God as the source of strength

PSA 59:9 See also EXO 15:2; PSA 18:1, PSA 22:19, PSA 28:7, PSA 46:1, PSA 59:17, PSA 81:1; ISA 12:2

Titles referring to God as the source of security**A shield**

GEN 15:1 See also DEU 33:29; 2SA 22:3 parallel PSA 18:2; 2SA 22:31 parallel PSA 18:30; PSA 28:7, PSA 84:11, PSA 115:9; PRO 2:7, PRO 30:5

A refuge

PSA 46:1 See also PSA 9:9, PSA 61:3, PSA 91:2, PSA 91:9, PSA 119:114, PSA 142:5; JER 16:19; JOL 3:16; NAM 1:7

A hiding-place

PSA 32:7

A fortress

2SA 22:2 parallel PSA 18:2; ; PSA 31:3, PSA 62:2, PSA 62:6, PSA 91:2, PSA 144:2; ; ISA 17:10; ; JER 16:19

A stronghold

2SA 22:3 parallel PSA 18:2; ; PSA 9:9, PSA 27:1, PSA 37:39, PSA 43:2, PSA 144:2; ; JOL 3:16

A defender

DEU 10:18; ; PSA 68:5; ; PRO 23:11

A Rock

GEN 49:24; ; DEU 32:4; ; PSA 19:14; ; ISA 26:4

Titles referring to God as the source of provision

GEN 22:14; LAM 3:24 See also GEN 22:8; PSA 73:26, PSA 119:57, PSA 142:5; JER 10:16, JER 51:19

Titles referring to God as the source of hope

JER 14:8 See also JER 17:13, JER 50:7

Titles referring to God as the source of peace

ROM 15:33 See also JDG 6:24; ROM 16:20; 2CO 13:11; PHP 4:9; 1TH 5:23; 2TH 3:16; HEB 13:20

Titles referring to God as the source of comfort

JER 8:18; ; 2CO 1:3

Titles referring to God as the source of grace

EXO 34:6; ; NEH 9:31; ; PSA 86:15; ; JON 4:2; ; 1PE 5:10

Titles referring to God as the source of love

PSA 59:10, PSA 59:17, PSA 144:2; ; 2CO 13:11; ; 1JN 4:7–4:16

God as shepherd

PSA 23:1 See also GEN 48:15, GEN 49:24; PSA 80:1

The true God

2CH 15:3; ; JER 10:10; ; JHN 17:3; ; 1JN 5:20

1210: God, human descriptions of

Figures of speech which describe God in human terms, sometimes referred to as anthropomorphisms. Since God is Spirit, these expressions help the human mind to understand God, and enable God to reveal himself to human beings.

Bodily form ascribed to God

EXO 33:23 See also GEN 18:2–18:14; JOS 5:13–5:15; EZK 1:26–1:28

His face

NUM 6:25–6:26 See also PSA 27:8, PSA 51:9; MAT 18:10; REV 22:4

His heart

2CH 7:16 See also GEN 6:6, GEN 8:21; ISA 13:14; ACT 13:22

His hands

ISA 14:27 See also 1CH 28:19, 1CH 29:14, 1CH 29:16; PSA 45:4; ACT 2:33–2:34; 1PE 3:22, 1PE 5:6

His eyes

2CH 16:9 See also DEU 11:12; PRO 15:3; AMO 9:8; ZEC 4:10; 1PE 3:12; PSA 34:15

His feet

EZK 43:7 See also DEU 33:3; 2SA 22:10 parallel PSA 18:9; PSA 45:5; ISA 60:13

His arm

ISA 59:1; JER 32:21 God's arm is particularly used as a symbol of his power at the exodus. See also EXO 6:6; DEU 5:15; JOB 40:9; ISA 51:9, ISA 52:10, ISA 63:5; LUK 1:51; JHN 12:38; ISA 53:1

His mind

ROM 11:34 See also ISA 40:13; 1SA 15:29; JER 7:31; HEB 7:21; PSA 110:4

Human actions ascribed to God**He walks**

GEN 3:8 See also LEV 26:12; 2CO 6:16

He speaks

DEU 4:12 See also JOB 40:6; PSA 29:3–29:9, PSA 33:6, PSA 33:9; EZK 1:24; MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11, LUK 3:22; ACT 7:6

He rests

GEN 2:2 See also EXO 20:11; HEB 4:4

He rides

PSA 68:4 See also DEU 33:26; 2SA 22:11 parallel PSA 18:10; PSA 68:33; HAB 3:8

He laughs

PSA 59:8 See also PSA 2:4, PSA 37:13

Other actions

ISA 5:26 God whistles; ; REV 3:20 God knocks

Human senses ascribed to God**He hears**

PSA 4:3 God's hearing usually refers to his answering of prayer. See also GEN 16:11; 2CH 7:14; PSA 94:9; LUK 1:13; JHN 11:42; HEB 5:7

He sees

GEN 16:13 See also GEN 1:4; 2CH 12:7; NEH 9:9; PRO 24:18; EZK 8:12–8:13; JON 3:10

He smells

GEN 8:21 God's smelling refers to his acceptance of sacrifices. See also LEV 1:9

God experiences emotion**He shows delight**

ZEP 3:17 See also DEU 30:9; PSA 149:4; ISA 5:7, ISA 62:4

He is compassionate

JAS 5:11 See also PSA 145:9; ISA 54:10; HOS 2:19, HOS 11:8; 2CO 1:3

He is angry

PSA 95:10–95:11 See also 2KI 17:11; PSA 78:58, PSA 106:29; ISA 5:25, ISA 54:8

He experiences pain

GEN 6:6 See also ISA 15:11, ISA 15:35; 2SA 24:16 parallel 1CH 21:15; EZK 6:9

Human occupations ascribed to God

ISA 29:16 God as a potter. See also EXO 15:3 God as a warrior; PSA 23:1 God as a shepherd; HEB 11:10 God as a builder

Human relationships ascribed to God**God as a loving husband**

ISA 54:5–54:8 See also JER 3:14, JER 31:32; HOS 2:16

God as a loving father

PSA 103:13 See also ISA 1:2–1:3; JER 31:9; HOS 11:1–11:4; MAT 11:27; JHN 16:27

God is not to be brought down to human levels

HOS 11:9 See also NUM 23:19; JOB 9:32; PSA 50:21; ISA 55:8–55:9

1215: God, feminine descriptions of

Some expressions attribute feminine qualities to God, especially relating to motherhood.

Descriptions of God relating to childbirth**God gives birth to his people**

ISA 44:2 God giving birth to Israel at the exodus. See also NUM 11:12; DEU 32:18; ISA 44:24

God gives birth to individuals

PSA 139:13 See also GEN 29:31, GEN 30:22; ECC 11:5; ISA 49:5; JER 1:5

God as a midwife

PSA 22:9 See also JOB 10:18; PSA 71:6; ISA 66:9

Descriptions of God relating to motherhood**God nurses his people**

ISA 49:15

God comforts his people

ISA 66:13 See also ISA 40:11

God as a mother bird protecting her young

DEU 32:10–32:11; MAT 23:37 parallel LUK 13:34 See also RUT 2:12; PSA 17:8, PSA 91:4

1220: God, as shepherd

The image of God as a shepherd points to his continual direction, guidance and care for his people.

Shepherd as a title for God

PSA 80:1 See also GEN 49:24; ECC 12:11

God's people are his flock**Israel is God's flock**

PSA 95:7 See also PSA 79:13, PSA 100:3; JER 50:7; EZK 34:31

The church is God's flock

1PE 5:2 See also LUK 12:32; ACT 20:28–20:29

The tasks undertaken by God the shepherd**The shepherd leads and guides**

PSA 23:2–23:3 See also ISA 40:11

The shepherd provides

PSA 23:1 See also GEN 48:15; PSA 23:5–23:6; HOS 4:16; MIC 7:14

The shepherd protects

PSA 28:9 See also GEN 49:23–49:24

The shepherd saves those who are lost or scattered

JER 31:10 See also PSA 119:176; ISA 53:6; EZK 34:11–34:16; MAT 18:12–18:14 parallel LUK 15:3–15:7

The shepherd judges

EZK 34:17–34:22 See also JER 23:1; ZEC 10:2–10:3, ZEC 11:16; MAT 25:32–25:46

God gives shepherds to be leaders over his people**He gives David's line**

EZK 34:23 See also 2SA 5:2 parallel 1CH 11:2; PSA 78:70–78:72; EZK 34:23–34:24, EZK 37:24; MIC 5:4; MAT 2:6

He gives individual leaders

ISA 44:28, ISA 63:11

He gives faithful leaders

JER 3:15 See also JER 23:4; 1PE 5:2–5:4

1225: God, as Spirit

God has no material body and he is not subject to human limitations. While his spiritual nature is clearly inferred in Scripture, it is seldom directly stated; the emphasis is on his dynamic, living personhood.

God as spirit

JHN 4:24 See also ISA 28:5–28:6, ISA 31:3

God is not subject to physical limitations

1SA 16:7; ; 1KI 18:27 Elijah's mockery of Baal implies a contrast with the true God who is not subject to the limitations suggested; ; JOB 10:4–10:8; ; PSA 121:3–121:4

God as the Spirit

PSA 139:7 See also PSA 51:11 The Spirit and the presence of God are equated; PSA 143:10 God's guidance

and the Spirit's leading are equated; ISA 34:16 God's Spirit participates in God's plans; 2CO 3:17–3:18

God cannot be represented physically

Images of God are prohibited

EXO 20:4, EXO 34:17; ; LEV 26:1; ; ACT 17:29

God transcends spacial limitations

ACT 17:24 See also 1KI 8:27 parallel 2CH 6:18; 2CH 2:6; ACT 7:48–7:50

God is invisible

1TI 6:15–6:16 See also EXO 33:20; DEU 4:15–4:19; JHN 1:18; COL 1:15; 1TI 1:17

1230: God, the Lord

God is the almighty ruler to whom everything and everyone is subject. His lordship is seen in his power and his victory over his enemies and also in his deliverance of his people and his loving care for them. He is the recipient of their obedience and their prayers. ("Lord" is the translation of the Hebrew word "Adonai" meaning "Ruler" or "Master" and is distinct from "LORD" which is the translation of the divine name "Yahweh").

God is the almighty ruler

He is Lord of lords

1TI 6:15 God exercises his lordship over all creation, but especially over all humanity. See also DEU 10:17; PSA 136:3; DAN 2:47

He is Lord of all the earth

PSA 97:5 See also JOS 3:11, JOS 3:13; MIC 4:13; ZEC 4:14; ACT 17:24

Characteristics of God as Lord

He is great and powerful

PSA 147:5 See also NEH 4:14; PSA 86:8, PSA 114:7–114:8, PSA 135:5; ISA 28:2; DAN 9:4; ACT 4:24

He is majestic and exalted

ISA 6:1 See also PSA 8:1, PSA 8:9; 2TH 1:9

He is righteous

DAN 9:16 See also PSA 97:5–97:6; DAN 9:7

He is loving and caring

PSA 86:15 See also PSA 62:12, PSA 86:5

He is merciful and forgiving

DAN 9:9 See also PSA 86:3–86:5, PSA 130:2–130:4

God, the Lord, is triumphant over his enemies

PSA 78:65–78:66 See also PSA 2:4–2:5, PSA 37:13, PSA 110:5–110:6

God, the Lord, delivers his people and cares for them

PSA 68:19 See also PSA 38:15, PSA 38:22, PSA 40:17, PSA 54:4, PSA 59:11, PSA 77:2, PSA 90:1, PSA 90:17

God is addressed as Lord

As a mark of respect or obedience

JOS 5:14 See also EXO 4:10, EXO 4:13, EXO 5:22; JDG 6:15; LUK 2:29

In prayer

NEH 1:11 See also GEN 18:27, GEN 18:30–18:32; EXO 34:9; JOS 7:8; JDG 13:8; PSA 30:8; DAN 9:4, DAN 9:15, DAN 9:19

Jesus Christ is God, the Lord

JHN 20:28 See also MAT 22:41–22:45 parallels MRK 12:35–12:37, LUK 20:41–20:44; ACT 2:34–2:36; HEB 1:13; PSA 110:1

1235: God, the LORD

The translation of the Hebrew name "Yahweh" which is the personal name of God whose meaning was revealed to Moses. It emphasises that God is the one who is eternal, unique, unchangeable and always actively present with his people. It expresses God's role as Israel's Redeemer and covenant Lord.

The name of God, the LORD

The LORD is the personal name of God

ISA 42:8 "The LORD" is the NIV rendering of the Hebrew "Yahweh".

The name's meaning

EXO 3:14–3:15 This forms part of God's explanation of who he is. "I AM" (in Hebrew closely resembling "Yahweh") expresses the ever-present, unchanging, totally dependable character of God.

The name is revealed to Moses

EXO 6:2–6:3 The name had been used previously (e.g., Ge 4:26) but its meaning was not fully understood until God revealed it to Moses in the context of the exodus from Egypt.

The name is glorious and awesome

DEU 28:58–28:59 See also JOS 7:9; 1SA 12:22

The name is not to be misused

EXO 20:7 parallel DEU 5:11 The misuse referred to here is swearing falsely by God's name. See also LEV 19:12, LEV 24:11, LEV 24:15–24:16 The Jews came to believe that just uttering the name "Yahweh" was an offence and as a result its exact pronunciation has been lost. What merited the death penalty here was using God's name as a curse.

God's character is revealed by his name the LORD

He is unique

EXO 8:10; ; DEU 4:35, DEU 4:39; ; 1KI 8:60; ; ISA 45:5, ISA 45:18; ; JOL 2:27

He is eternal

GEN 21:33; ; PSA 9:7, PSA 29:10, PSA 102:12, PSA 135:13; ; ISA 26:4

He is holy

LEV 11:44; ; 1SA 2:2; ; PSA 30:4; ; ISA 43:15

He is powerful

EXO 15:6; ; JOS 22:22; ; PSA 93:4; ; JER 10:6

He is majestic

PSA 83:18, PSA 93:1, PSA 97:9; ; ISA 2:10, ISA 2:19, ISA 2:21; ; MIC 5:4

He is compassionate and gracious

EXO 34:6–34:7; ; PSA 103:8, PSA 145:8–145:9

He is faithful and true

PSA 145:13

He is unchangeable

PSA 33:11, PSA 110:4; ; MAL 3:6

He is actively present with his people

DEU 31:6; ; JOS 1:9; ; 1KI 8:57; ; HAG 1:13

God reveals the relevance of his name the LORD by his actions

In creation

JER 33:2 See also ISA 42:5, ISA 43:15 “The LORD” is Creator of the universe but also the Creator of the people Israel; ISA 45:18 Human beings are the purpose of God's creation; they know God as “the LORD”.

In the deliverance of his people from Egypt

EXO 6:6 Deliverance is a central concept in the revelation of the divine name. See also EXO 12:51, EXO 14:30, EXO 16:6, EXO 20:2; LEV 26:13; PSA 81:10

In establishing a covenant with his people

EXO 6:7 See also EXO 29:46; 2SA 7:24 parallel 1CH 17:22; JER 14:9

In the judgment of his enemies

EXO 12:12 See also EXO 7:5, EXO 8:22–8:23; 1SA 17:45–17:47; 2CH 14:11–14:13

In the restoration of his people

EZK 36:36 See also PSA 102:15–102:22; ISA 60:15–60:22; EZK 37:6, EZK 37:13–37:14 The theme “then you, my people, will know that I am the LORD” (with slight variations) runs throughout the book of Ezekiel and is connected to divine acts of judgment and restoration.

God, the LORD denotes God's lordship

He is the Sovereign LORD

EZK 2:4 “Sovereign LORD” is the NIV rendering of “Adonai Yahweh”, the favourite divine title in Ezekiel. See also GEN 15:2, GEN 15:8; DEU 3:24; JOS 7:7; JDG 6:22; 2SA 7:18–7:29; PSA 73:28; ISA 61:1; JER 1:6; AMO 1:8

He is the LORD Almighty

1SA 1:3 “The LORD Almighty” is the NIV rendering of “Yahweh Sabaoth” (“the LORD of hosts”) which emphasises the sovereignty of “the LORD”. See also 1CH 11:9; PSA 24:10, PSA 46:7, PSA 46:11; ISA 2:12; JER 39:16; HAG 2:6–2:9; ZEC 1:3–1:4, ZEC 1:6; MAL 1:14

He is the Lord, the LORD Almighty

ISA 1:24 “The Lord, the LORD Almighty” is the NIV rendering of “Adonai Yahweh Sabaoth” which is often associated with the LORD's authority to rule and to judge. See also PSA 69:6; ISA 3:15, ISA 19:4; JER 2:19, JER 46:10, JER 49:5; AMO 9:5

As the LORD, God interacts with his people

He enforces the moral code

LEV 18:1–18:5 The phrase “I am the LORD” occurs over 40 times in Leviticus chapters 18–26 and is the authority behind the moral law given to God's people. See also LEV 11:44–11:45, LEV 19:2

He makes his people holy

LEV 22:32 See also EXO 31:13; LEV 20:8, LEV 21:8; EZK 20:12, EZK 37:28

He is the object of his people's worship

EXO 4:22–4:23 The purpose of Israel's redemption from Egypt was that they would be free to worship the LORD. See also EXO 12:31, EXO 23:25; 1CH 16:29 parallel PSA 96:9; PSA 29:2, PSA 99:5, PSA 100:2; JON 1:9

Jesus Christ takes God's name to himself

JHN 8:58–8:59 The form of expression used by Jesus Christ meant that he was clearly identifying himself with the divine name “I AM”. The response of the crowd confirms this.

1240: God, the Rock

An OT title for God and a Messianic title signifying that God's people can rely on him for absolute protection and salvation.

Rock as a title for Israel's God

PSA 78:35 See also GEN 49:24; DEU 32:15, DEU 32:18, DEU 32:30; 2SA 23:3; PSA 42:9; ISA 30:29; HAB 1:12

God the Rock is unique

2SA 22:32 parallel PSA 18:31 See also 1SA 2:2; ISA 44:8

The Rock is superior to other gods**DEU 32:31** See also DEU 32:37**The Rock is worthy to be praised****PSA 144:1** See also DEU 32:4; PSA 92:15**God the Rock and his people****God the Rock is a refuge for his people****PSA 62:7** See also PSA 28:1, PSA 31:1–31:3, PSA 61:2, PSA 71:3; ISA 26:4**God the Rock is his people's fortress****PSA 94:22** See also PSA 28:8, PSA 46:7, PSA 46:11, PSA 48:3, PSA 59:9, PSA 59:16–59:17, PSA 91:2, PSA 144:2; JER 16:19**God the Rock is his people's security****2SA 22:3** parallel PSA 18:2 See also PSA 9:9, PSA 27:1, PSA 37:39, PSA 43:2, PSA 52:7; JOL 3:16**God the Rock saves and delivers his people****PSA 95:1** See also 2SA 22:47 parallel PSA 18:46; PSA 19:14, PSA 62:2, PSA 89:26; ISA 17:10**Rock as a Messianic title****The Messiah is the rock/stone on which God's living temple stands****ISA 8:14, ISA 28:16** See also PSA 118:22; MAT 21:42 parallels MRK 12:10, LUK 20:17; ACT 4:11; 1PE 2:6–2:7**The Messiah's kingdom is eternal and immovable like a rock****DAN 2:34–2:35** See also DAN 2:44–2:45**Consequences of rejecting the rock/stone**

MAT 21:44 parallel LUK 20:18; ; ROM 9:32–9:33; ; 1PE 2:4–2:8

1245: God of the fathers

God's particular association with Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, the fathers of the nations of Israel, highlights his faithfulness in fulfilling the promises made to them. He is the God who establishes a covenant with his people for their everlasting blessing.

God's relationship with the fathers**The God of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob****ACT 7:32** See also EXO 3:6, EXO 3:15, EXO 4:5**The God of Jacob**

PSA 20:1 "Jacob" is used here as a synonym for the nation of Israel. This usage is common in the Psalms as a reminder to God's people of his faithfulness to Jacob and the emergent nation of Israel. See also GEN 32:27–32:28; PSA 14:7, PSA 46:7, PSA 46:11, PSA 75:9, PSA 76:6, PSA 114:7

Such a relationship served as an encouragement to others

Abraham's servant was encouraged to trust God in his mission by the example of Abraham's faith: GEN 24:12, GEN 24:27, GEN 24:42, GEN 24:48; GEN 26:24, GEN 31:42, GEN 31:53; GEN 46:1–46:3 Jacob learned to fear and trust God through his father Isaac.

God's covenant with the fathers**God's promises that they will be the fathers of a great nation****GEN 28:13–28:15** See also GEN 26:2–26:4; EXO 3:16–3:17**God remembers and fulfils his promises****EXO 2:24** See also EXO 6:3–6:5, EXO 32:13; LEV 26:42; DEU 1:8; ACT 7:17**God makes a covenant with his people to be their God****DEU 29:12–29:13** See also GEN 17:7; EXO 6:7–6:8; PSA 105:8–105:11**Characteristics of the God of the fathers****He blesses his people****DEU 1:11** See also DEU 30:20**He is powerful**

1KI 18:36–18:39

He is gracious and compassionate

2KI 13:23

He keeps his people faithful

1CH 29:18

He gives wisdom

DAN 2:23

He is the God of the living**MAT 22:32** parallels MRK 12:26–12:27, LUK 20:37–20:38**People sometimes fail to respond to the God of their fathers****JOS 18:3** See also NUM 32:11; DEU 6:10–6:12, DEU 9:27; 2CH 30:7**1250: Abba**

The Aramaic word "Abba" is thought to be a very intimate term for "Father" suggesting that those who use it to refer to God enjoy a close relationship with him. Jesus Christ uses the term as a consequence of his natural sonship of God; believers may use it as a consequence of their adopted sonship of God through faith.

“Abba” used in addressing God

By Jesus Christ

MRK 14:36

By believers

ROM 8:15; ; GAL 4:6

1255: face of God

A term used to refer to the character of God, especially his favour towards his people. For God to turn his face to his people is to offer them his grace and help; for God to turn his face against his people is to withhold his favour and blessing. To seek the face of God is to seek his favour.

The face of God as a sign of blessing

NUM 6:25–6:26 See also 2SA 21:1; 1CH 16:11; PSA 4:6, PSA 31:16, PSA 67:1, PSA 80:19, PSA 105:4, PSA 119:135; EZK 39:29

Parts of God’s face

His ears

2SA 22:7; ; 2KI 19:28; ; PSA 34:15, PSA 102:2; ; ISA 59:1

His eyes

PSA 34:15 See also DEU 11:12; 2CH 16:9; PSA 139:16; PRO 15:3

His hair

DAN 7:9

His lips

PSA 89:34; ; ISA 11:4, ISA 30:27

His mouth

2SA 22:9; ; JOB 15:30; ; ISA 45:23

His nostrils

2SA 22:9, 2SA 22:16

The visibility of God’s face

His face cannot be seen

EXO 33:20–33:23 “The face of God” may mean here God’s real and true self, the inference being that no one can look on God as he is in his total purity and majesty.

Apparent exceptions where God is seen face to face

GEN 32:30 After Jacob’s wrestling with a figure whose exact identity is not explicit in the preceding verses. Jacob did experience a real encounter with God but God was in a real and approachable form, not in his transcendent and visible glory. See also EXO 33:11; NUM 12:8; DEU 5:4, DEU 34:10; EZK 20:35

The angels in heaven look upon the face of God

MAT 18:10

God must reveal himself if people are to see his face

JOB 34:29 The Greek word for “revelation” literally means “removing a veil from one’s face”.

The righteous will see God’s face in the life to come

1CO 13:12; ; REV 22:4

When God hides his face blessing is withheld

Complaints at God hiding his face

PSA 44:24 See also PSA 13:1, PSA 88:14

Cries for help

PSA 27:9 See also PSA 69:17, PSA 102:2, PSA 143:7

Statements concerning God’s anger and judgment

ISA 54:8 See also DEU 31:17–31:18; PSA 22:24, PSA 30:7, PSA 51:9, PSA 104:29; ISA 8:17, ISA 64:7; JER 33:5; EZK 39:23–39:24; MIC 3:4; REV 6:16

Other phrases synonymous with God hiding his face

2CH 30:9; ; JER 18:17; ; EZK 7:22

God sets his face against sinners

LEV 17:10, LEV 20:3, LEV 26:17; ; PSA 34:16; ; EZK 14:8; ; 1PE 3:12; ; EZK 15:7

God’s face as a symbol of his favour

Seeking the face of God in prayer

2CH 7:14 See also 2SA 21:1; 1CH 16:11; PSA 24:6, PSA 105:4, PSA 119:58; HOS 5:15

Seeking the favour of God

EXO 32:11 See also 1SA 13:12; 2KI 13:4; 2CH 33:12; JER 26:19; DAN 9:13; ZEC 7:2, ZEC 8:21; MAL 1:9

Appearing before God in worship

EXO 23:15 The phrase seems to recall the fact that in ancient religions worshippers came before carved faces of their idols. In Israel such physical representations of God were forbidden but the phrase was still used underlining the belief that Israel’s God was present in his sanctuary. See also EXO 23:17, EXO 34:20; DEU 16:16, DEU 31:11; PSA 42:2; ISA 1:12

The shining of God’s face upon his people indicates his blessing

NUM 6:25–6:26 See also PSA 4:6, PSA 31:16, PSA 44:3, PSA 67:1, PSA 80:3, PSA 80:19, PSA 119:135

God’s face accompanies Israel as a symbol of his presence

EXO 33:14 Literally “my face will go ...” Here this phrase may allude not only to God’s presence but also to the manifestations of his presence (e.g., the cloud in verse 9). See also DEU 4:37; ISA 63:9

1260: finger of God

A figure of speech which gives expression to God's creative power and authority over his creation.

God creates with his finger

PSA 8:3 See also ISA 48:13, ISA 64:8

God writes with his finger

He writes the law

EXO 31:18 See also EXO 24:12, EXO 32:16, EXO 34:1

He writes judgment

DAN 5:5 See also DAN 5:24–5:28

God works miracles with his finger

He sends plagues

EXO 8:19

He exorcises evil spirits

LUK 11:20

1265: hand of God

A figure of speech which points to God's sovereign power in creation and in his actions on his people's behalf, especially in redemption. Also used as a symbol of authority and in taking oaths.

God creates by his hand

ACT 7:50 See also ISA 66:2; JOB 10:3, JOB 10:8; PSA 8:3, PSA 19:1, PSA 95:5, PSA 138:8; ISA 48:13, ISA 64:8

God holds the world in his hand

PSA 95:4 See also JOB 12:10, JOB 26:13, JOB 36:32; PSA 31:15; ISA 40:12, ISA 41:19–41:20; DAN 5:23

God's creatures are fed from his hand

PSA 145:16 See also PSA 104:28; ISA 34:17

God's hand symbolises his power

God's hand is mighty

HAB 3:4 See also 1CH 29:12; PSA 118:15–118:16; JER 18:6; DAN 4:35; AMO 9:2

God executes judgment by the power of his hand

AMO 1:6–1:8 Judgment on the Philistine cities. See also DEU 32:41; 1SA 5:6–5:9; ISA 40:2; JER 15:6; LAM 2:3; EZK 6:14; ZEP 1:4; ACT 13:11

God's hand holds a cup of judgment

JER 25:15–25:17 See also PSA 75:8; ISA 51:17; HAB 2:16

God's hand brings trouble

JOB 19:21 See also RUT 1:13; 1SA 6:3; JOB 1:11; PSA 38:2, PSA 39:10

God's hand causes fear

ISA 19:16 See also ISA 23:11

Pleas for God to use his powerful hand

PSA 74:11 See also PSA 10:12, PSA 60:5 parallel PSA 108:6; PSA 77:10, PSA 144:7–144:8

God's powerful hand used on his people's behalf

God redeems by his powerful hand

PSA 138:7 See also 1KI 8:41–8:42 parallel 2CH 6:32; PSA 98:1; ISA 11:11; EZK 20:21–20:22, EZK 20:33–20:34; MIC 4:10

God redeemed Israel from Egypt by his powerful hand

EXO 13:3 See also EXO 3:19–3:20, EXO 13:9, EXO 13:14; DEU 5:15, DEU 7:8; NEH 1:10; JER 32:21; DAN 9:15

God's hand ensures success for his people

ISA 41:10 "righteous" has the sense of "victorious". See also PSA 16:8, PSA 18:35, PSA 89:21; ISA 42:6, ISA 49:4

God's powerful hand is invincible

JHN 10:29 See also PSA 139:10; ISA 43:13

God's hand protects his people

EZR 8:31 See also EXO 33:22–33:23; 1CH 4:10; PSA 121:5; ISA 41:13, ISA 49:2, ISA 49:16, ISA 62:3

God's hand inspires the prophets

JER 1:9 See also ISA 8:11; JER 15:17; EZK 1:3, EZK 3:14, EZK 3:22, EZK 33:22, EZK 37:1, EZK 40:1

God's hand fulfils his purposes

EZR 7:6 See also 2CH 30:12; EZR 7:9, EZR 7:28, EZR 8:18; NEH 2:8, NEH 2:18; PRO 21:1; ECC 2:24; ISA 45:1; LUK 1:66; ACT 11:21

God's uplifted hand

Signifies his taking an oath

NEH 9:15 See also EXO 6:8; NUM 14:30; DEU 32:40; EZK 47:14

Signifies his power

ISA 9:12, ISA 9:17, ISA 9:21, ISA 26:11

God's right hand symbolises his authority

ACT 7:55–7:56 See also PSA 110:1; ACT 5:31; ROM 8:34; COL 3:1; HEB 1:3; 1PE 3:22

God's hand must be recognised

God requires submission under his hand

1PE 5:6 See also ROM 10:21; ISA 65:2

The works of God's hand must be acknowledged

PSA 28:5, PSA 92:4, PSA 143:5

1270: right hand of God

A figure of speech that represents God's ultimate power and authority, and where the exalted Jesus Christ now sits.

The right hand of God as a symbol

A symbol of power

PSA 89:13

A symbol of protection

PSA 16:8 See also PSA 63:8, PSA 139:10; ISA 41:13; LAM 2:3

A symbol of God's presence

PSA 16:11 See also PSA 48:10, PSA 73:23; ISA 62:8

A symbol of God's saving power

PSA 60:5 parallel PSA 108:6 See also PSA 17:7, PSA 20:6, PSA 80:15, PSA 98:1, PSA 138:7

A symbol of victory

PSA 18:35, PSA 44:3, PSA 78:54; ; ISA 41:10

A symbol of the defeat of God's enemies

EXO 15:6 See also EXO 15:12; PSA 21:8, PSA 74:11

A symbol of God's mighty works

PSA 45:4 See also PSA 77:10, PSA 118:15-118:16; ISA 48:13

A symbol of judgment

LAM 2:4; ; HAB 2:16

Jesus Christ at God's right hand

Jesus Christ is exalted to God's right hand

HEB 1:13 Comparison between Jesus Christ and the angels confirms Christ's absolute supremacy. See also PSA 110:1; MAT 22:44 parallels MRK 12:36, LUK 20:42; LUK 22:69; ACT 2:34, ACT 7:55-7:56; COL 3:1; HEB 1:3, HEB 12:2

Jesus Christ rules every authority at God's right hand

1PE 3:22 See also EPH 1:20-1:21

Jesus Christ continues his work at God's right hand

ROM 8:34 See also ACT 2:33, ACT 5:31; HEB 4:14-4:16, HEB 8:1

Jesus Christ will return at God's right hand

MAT 26:64 parallel MRK 14:62

Jesus Christ takes a scroll from God's right hand

REV 5:1-5:7 The scroll probably refers to God's decrees for the destiny of the world.

The right hand of Jesus Christ

The place of the righteous on judgment day

MAT 25:32-25:34

A privileged place granted by the Father

MAT 20:20-20:23 parallel MRK 10:35-10:40

A place of protection for Christians

REV 1:20 The angels of the churches are probably the church leaders. See also REV 1:16, REV 2:1

1300: God, work of

- 1305: God, activity of
- 1335: blessing
- 1340: consistency
- 1345: covenant
- 1355: providence

1305: God, activity of

God is not passive or remote from his creation but dynamically involved in all that he has made. In the past, this activity was seen in the history of Israel and in the ministry of Jesus Christ. In the present, God's activity can be seen in the life of believers and of the church.

God is active by nature

He actively works out his purposes

JHN 5:17 See also NUM 23:19; PSA 115:3; PRO 16:4; ISA 43:13

His names reflect his activity and involvement in his people's lives

GEN 22:14 "The LORD Will Provide"; ; EXO 15:26 "The LORD, who heals you"; ; EXO 17:15 "The LORD is my Banner": this title emphasises that God is like a warrior who champions his people's cause; ; PSA 95:6 "The LORD our Maker": the Hebrew word used does not refer to original creation but to the way in which God is fashioning a people for himself.

His word is active

ISA 55:10-55:11 The Hebrew for "word" can also be translated "deed" or "action". God's word is not merely a communication of abstract truth but a powerful force active in the world. See also GEN 1:3; EZK 37:4, EZK 37:7

God is active in the creation

In making the universe

NEH 9:6 See also GEN 1:1, GEN 1:31, GEN 2:2, GEN 5:1-5:2; PSA 102:25; AMO 4:13; ACT 17:24; REV 4:11

In sustaining the created order

PSA 103:19 See also PSA 104:10-104:17, PSA 107:33-107:35; MAT 6:28-6:30; ACT 14:17; EPH 1:11; COL 1:16-1:17

In bringing about changes in the weather

JOB 37:10, JOB 38:22–38:30, JOB 38:34–38:35; ; PSA 107:25, PSA 147:8; ; MAT 5:45; ; ACT 14:17

In the stars and other heavenly bodies

JOB 38:31–38:33; ; PSA 104:19, PSA 147:4; ; ISA 40:26; ; JAS 1:17

In the animal creation

JOB 39:1–39:30, JOB 40:15–40:24, JOB 41:1–41:11; ; PSA 104:20–104:27, PSA 147:9; ; MAT 10:29 parallel LUK 12:6

God is active in Israel's history**In the calling and creation of Israel as a people**

EXO 6:6–6:8 See also GEN 12:1–12:3; EXO 19:3–19:6; DEU 4:32–4:34; ISA 51:2; EZK 16:6–16:7; HOS 11:1–11:4; MAL 2:10

In saving and delivering his people

PSA 106:2 This verse introduces a psalm which recounts the history of God's dealings with his people. See also EXO 33:16–33:17; 2SA 7:7–7:11; 1KI 18:36–18:38; PSA 28:8–28:9, PSA 107:2–107:3

In judgment

NUM 25:3–25:4; ; 1SA 2:25, 1SA 12:16–12:18; ; 2SA 21:1

In bringing victory in battle

EXO 14:27–14:28, EXO 17:8–17:16; ; NUM 21:1–21:3; ; JOS 6:2, JOS 10:30; ; JDG 7:9, JDG 7:22; ; 1SA 17:47; ; 2CH 20:22–20:23

In raising up and sending leaders to the people

2SA 7:8–7:9; ; 2CH 24:19; ; EST 4:14; ; JER 7:25; ; ZEC 7:7

God is active in the nations of the world**His rule over the nations**

PSA 22:28 See also GEN 11:8; DEU 32:8; JDG 2:20–2:23; JOB 12:23; PSA 46:8–46:10, PSA 66:7; ISA 41:2; ACT 17:26

Examples of nations through which God acts

Assyria: 2KI 17:18–17:23; ; ISA 28:11; 2KI 24:10–24:14; ; 2CH 36:15–36:18; 2CH 36:22–36:23 parallel EZR 1:1–1:4 Persia

God is active in human life**He determines the course of human lives**

ACT 17:28 See also 1CH 29:12; PSA 8:3–8:4, PSA 75:6–75:7, PSA 139:16; LUK 1:52; JHN 1:4

Examples of God's intervention in human lives

NUM 22:21–22:23 Balaam; ; 1SA 1:19–1:20 Hannah; ; 2KI 5:14–5:15 Naaman; ; JON 1:17 Jonah; ACT 9:3–9:6, ACT 13:1–13:3, ACT 16:6, ACT 16:10

God is active in Jesus Christ's ministry

ACT 10:38 See also LUK 5:17, LUK 11:20; JHN 3:2, JHN 5:17–5:19, JHN 9:3–9:4, JHN 14:10; 2CO 5:19

God is active through the Holy Spirit

GEN 1:2; ; 2KI 2:16; ; EZK 8:3, EZK 11:1, EZK 43:5

God is active in the church

1CO 12:6 This verse comes in the context of teaching about the body of Christ and the gifts which the Spirit gives to the church. See also 1CO 14:24–14:25; GAL 2:8, GAL 3:5; EPH 3:10, EPH 3:20–3:21; PHP 1:6, PHP 2:13

1310: God, as judge

As a part of his sovereignty and authority, God is executor of his righteousness within the created order. Jesus Christ shares in this ongoing work.

God has authority to judge**God's status as judge**

PSA 75:7 See also PSA 50:6, PSA 76:8–76:9; ECC 11:9; ISA 33:22, ISA 66:16; 2TI 4:8; HEB 12:23; JAS 4:12

He decides disputes

JDG 11:27 See also GEN 16:5, GEN 31:53; 1SA 24:15; ISA 2:4 parallel MIC 4:3; JAS 5:9

He presides in the heavenly court

ISA 3:13 See also PSA 50:4, PSA 82:1; DAN 7:9–7:10; JOL 3:12; REV 20:11–20:15

God is judge over the whole of creation**He judges the earth**

GEN 18:25 See also PSA 9:8, PSA 58:11, PSA 82:8, PSA 94:2, PSA 96:13, PSA 98:9

He judges every individual

EZK 33:20 See also ECC 3:17; HEB 9:27; 1PE 4:5; JUD 1:15; REV 20:12

He judges the nations

JOL 3:12 See also PSA 9:19–9:20, PSA 110:6; OBA 1:15; ZEP 3:8

He judges rulers of nations

ISA 40:23; ; JER 25:17–25:27; ; REV 6:15–6:17

He judges his own people

HEB 10:30 See also DEU 32:36; PSA 78:62; JER 1:16; 1PE 4:17

He judges angels

2PE 2:4; ; JUD 1:6

He judges Satan

GEN 3:14–3:15; ; MAT 25:41; ; 1TI 3:6; ; REV 20:10

God's judgment is inescapable**No-one can hide from God**

OBA 1:4 See also GEN 3:8–3:9; JOB 11:20; JER 11:11; AMO 9:1–9:4

God searches human hearts**JER 17:10** See also 1CH 28:9; PSA 7:9; PRO 5:21; JER 11:20**God reveals secrets****ROM 2:16** See also ECC 12:14; JER 16:17; 1CO 4:5; HEB 4:13**Examples of God acting as judge****His judgment of the earth in sending the flood**

GEN 6:7, GEN 6:13, GEN 6:17, GEN 7:21–7:23

His judgment of individuals

GEN 4:9–4:12 Cain; ; ACT 5:3–5:10 Ananias and Sapphira; ; ACT 13:8–13:11 Elymas the sorcerer

His judgment of families

JOS 7:24–7:25 of Achan; ; ISA 3:12–3:13 of Eli

His judgment of cities

GEN 19:24–19:25 Sodom and Gomorrah; ; JOS 6:24 Jericho

His judgment of nations

DEU 7:1–7:5 the Canaanite nations

His judgment of the rulers of nations

2CH 26:16–26:21 Uzziah; ; DAN 4:31–4:33 Nebuchadnezzar; ; DAN 5:22–5:30 Belshazzar; ; ACT 12:22–12:23 Herod

His judgment of his own people

JDG 2:11–2:15; ; 2CH 36:15–36:20; ; ISA 33:22

God's character is revealed through his righteous judgments**His sovereignty**

PSA 9:7, PSA 96:10, PSA 99:4; ; EZK 6:14

His power

EXO 6:6, EXO 14:31; ; EZK 20:33–20:36; ; REV 18:8

His holiness

LEV 10:1–10:3; ; 1SA 6:19–6:20; ; EZK 28:22; ; REV 16:5

His anger

NAM 1:2–1:3; ; ROM 2:5

His truth

PSA 96:13; ; ROM 2:2; ; REV 16:7

His impartiality

2CH 19:7; ; ROM 2:9–2:11; ; COL 3:25; ; 1PE 1:17

His compassion

LAM 3:31–3:33; ; HOS 11:8–11:9; ; JON 3:10, JON 4:2

His patience

NUM 14:18; ; NEH 9:30; ; 2PE 3:9

His mercy

NEH 9:31; ; JOB 9:15; ; PSA 78:38; ; MIC 7:18

Jesus Christ continues God's work as judge**JHN 5:22** See also JHN 5:27; ACT 10:42**God will act as judge on the last day****REV 20:12** See also ISA 2:17; ZEP 1:14–1:18; JHN 12:48; ACT 17:31; ROM 2:16, ROM 14:10; 1CO 4:5; 2TI 4:1; 1PE 4:5; 2PE 2:9, 2PE 3:7**1315: God, as redeemer**

God alone has the ability to save his people from slavery and captivity. God's redemptive will and power is demonstrated in his deliverance of Israel from bondage in Egypt, and supremely through the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ.

God as the sole redeemer of Israel**ISA 47:4** See also DEU 13:5; PSA 19:14**He redeems because of his love**

DEU 7:8; ; PSA 44:26

He is able to redeem because of his power

DEU 9:26; ; 2SA 7:23 parallel 1CH 17:21; ; NEH 1:10

God acts as Israel's redeemer

PSA 78:35, PSA 111:9; ; ISA 43:1, ISA 48:17, ISA 54:5, ISA 63:16

He promises to redeem Israel from Egypt**EXO 3:8–3:10** See also EXO 3:21, EXO 14:4**He redeems Israel in the exodus from Egypt****DEU 5:15** See also DEU 15:15, DEU 21:8, DEU 24:18; NEH 9:9–9:11; PSA 77:14–77:20, PSA 105:23–105:38; HOS 13:4; MIC 6:4; ACT 7:30–7:36**He redeems Israel from Babylonian exile**

ISA 41:14 "Redeemer" is a characteristic title for God in the second part of Isaiah. In the context of the exile Isaiah reminds Israel that God would act as redeemer. See also ISA 43:4, ISA 44:6, ISA 44:24, ISA 49:26, ISA 54:5, ISA 60:16, ISA 62:12; JER 50:33–50:35, JER 51:12; MIC 4:10; ZEC 10:8

God redeems his people from difficult personal circumstances

PSA 34:22 See also ISA 29:22 Abraham was redeemed from the land of idolatry to become God's servant; JOB 19:25 Job, in the midst of his despair, declares God to be his redeemer; PSA 31:4–31:5 part of the psalmist's prayer for deliverance when confronted by an evil conspiracy; LAM 3:58 the lamentor recognises personal redemption within the context of national despair

He brings deliverance from enemies

PSA 69:18, PSA 106:10, PSA 107:2; ; JER 15:21, JER 31:11

God redeems his people from the bondage and guilt of sin

PSA 130:7–130:8 See also PSA 34:22; ISA 59:20

Those who remain sinful do not find redemption

HOS 7:13 See also PSA 26:11 The request for redemption is made on the basis of uprightness; ISA 1:27–1:28

God redeems his people from death

PSA 49:15 See also JOB 19:25–19:27; PSA 103:4

Jesus Christ is central to God's redemptive purposes

COL 1:13–1:14 See also LUK 1:68; ROM 3:23–3:24; 1CO 1:30, 1CO 7:23; GAL 3:13–3:14, GAL 4:4–4:5; EPH 1:7; HEB 9:11–9:12; 1PE 1:18–1:21

God will finally redeem all creation at Jesus Christ's second coming

ROM 8:19–8:23 See also LUK 21:28; EPH 1:13–1:14, EPH 4:30; TIT 2:13–2:14

God's redemptive work brings him praise and worship

EPH 1:3–1:7 See also EXO 15:1–15:21; PSA 71:23, PSA 111:9, PSA 119:134, PSA 136:1–136:26; ISA 35:4–35:10, ISA 44:22–44:23, ISA 48:20, ISA 51:11, ISA 52:9

1320: God, as Saviour

God is the only Saviour and deliverer of his people. His work of salvation is inaugurated in the OT, and reaches its climax in the work of Jesus Christ.

God is the only Saviour

ISA 45:21–45:22 See also JDG 10:13–10:14; ISA 43:11; JER 2:28, JER 3:23, JER 11:12

God's deliverance can be worked through a human agent

JDG 2:16 See also GEN 45:5–45:7; EXO 3:10; JOS 10:6–10:10; JDG 2:18, JDG 6:14–6:16; 2KI 13:5; ISA 45:1, ISA 45:13

Examples of God's saving deeds

God delivers his people from Egypt: EXO 6:6–6:7, EXO 14:13–14:14, EXO 14:21–14:23, EXO 14:27–14:28; ; PSA 77:19–77:20; ; HOS 13:4; ISA 17:37; ; 2SA 22:1–22:3 parallel PSA 18:2; ; 2SA 22:18 parallel PSA 18:17; ; PSA 3:8; DAN 6:16–6:22 God delivers Daniel from the lions' den.; ACT 5:18–5:19, ACT 12:6–12:11, ACT 16:25–16:26

God's acts of deliverance reveal his nature and character

ISA 52:10 See also PSA 98:2; ISA 49:6; LUK 3:4–3:6; ISA 40:3–40:5; ROM 1:16

His strength is seen

PSA 18:2 “rock” and “horn” symbolise God's strength; they are frequently used to emphasise his ability to save. See also EXO 15:2 parallel PSA 118:14; 1SA 2:1; 2SA 22:2–22:3, 2SA 22:47 parallel PSA 18:46; PSA 28:8

His glory is seen

EXO 14:4 See also EXO 14:17–14:18; NUM 14:22; PSA 85:9; ISA 66:19; EZK 39:21

God's deliverance is anticipated

PSA 31:2 See also GEN 49:18; PSA 35:4, PSA 69:13–69:15; ISA 33:22, ISA 35:4

God's deliverance is promised

EXO 6:6 See also PSA 50:15, PSA 91:14; ISA 38:6, ISA 46:4; EZK 34:12

Implications of God's deliverance for believers

God is able to deliver believers from trials and testing

2TI 4:18 See also DAN 12:1; MAT 6:13; 1CO 10:13; 2PE 2:9; REV 3:10

God is able to deliver believers from sin and death

ROM 7:24–7:25 God delivers both from death owing to adversity and from death that comes about as a result of sin. See also 2SA 12:13; PSA 33:19; EZK 37:23; 1CO 15:56–15:57; 2CO 1:9–1:10

Testimony to God as Saviour and deliverer

GEN 50:20 See also PSA 13:5, PSA 18:46–18:48; ISA 61:10; DAN 6:27; HAB 3:18; LUK 1:47; 1TI 4:10

1325: God, the Creator

God's power is revealed in the initial creation and the continuing sustenance of the universe. Humanity represents the climax of the Creator's purposes.

God is the Creator

NEH 9:6 See also GEN 1:1; ISA 45:7, ISA 66:2; EPH 3:9; REV 4:11

God's creative activity demonstrates his uniqueness

PSA 96:5 See also ISA 37:16; JER 10:11

God's creative activity implies that he is good

1TI 4:4 See also GEN 1:4, GEN 1:31

God creates all things

He creates the physical world

ISA 45:18 See also GEN 1:1–1:25

He creates the spiritual world

PSA 148:2–148:5 See also ROM 8:38–8:39; COL 1:16

The human race is the apex of God's creation

PSA 8:3–8:8 See also GEN 1:26–1:28, GEN 5:1, GEN 9:6; PSA 100:3, PSA 139:13; ISA 42:5; ACT 17:26–17:28

The Creator's agents**He creates through Jesus Christ**

1CO 8:6 See also JHN 1:3; COL 1:16; HEB 1:2

He creates by the Spirit

JOB 33:4 See also GEN 1:2; PSA 104:30

He creates by his word

PSA 33:6 See also JOB 38:8–38:11; PSA 33:9

He creates by wisdom

PRO 3:19 Wisdom is personified and is active with the Creator. See also PRO 8:30; JER 10:12–10:13

He creates from nothing

HEB 11:3 God creates out of non-existent material, which emphasises the absolute dependence of all creation upon him. See also JOB 26:7; ROM 4:17

The Creator sustains the created order

ISA 44:24 The Hebrew indicates continuous activity. See also DEU 30:20; JOB 9:8–9:9; PSA 104:2–104:4; ISA 42:5

Examples of God sustaining creation

MAT 5:45 See also JOB 5:10, JOB 38:31–38:33; MAT 6:28–6:30

The Creator watches over his creation

PSA 33:14 See also PSA 121:2–121:8

The creation is a vehicle for God's self-revelation

ROM 1:20 See also PSA 19:1; ISA 40:26; AMO 4:13

God renews his creation through redemption

JHN 3:17; 2CO 5:17 See also JHN 1:12–1:13; ROM 4:17, ROM 6:4, ROM 8:19–8:23 The redemption of the physical world must wait until the sons of God are revealed at the end of time; GAL 6:15

God renews his new creation of believing people

2CO 4:16 See also COL 3:10

God will reveal a new universe

REV 21:1 See also REV 21:5; ISA 65:17

1330: God, the provider

God supplies the needs of all creation, but gives special care to his own people.

God is called “The LORD who provides”

GEN 22:13–22:14 The name “Yahweh Yireh” (or “Jehovah Jireh”) is from the verb “to see”, and means “The

LORD foresees” or “The LORD will see to it”. See also GEN 22:8

God provides for the needs of all creation**He provides for the earth**

PSA 65:9–65:13 See also DEU 11:12, DEU 11:14–11:15; PSA 68:9, PSA 104:10–104:18, PSA 135:7, PSA 147:8; EZK 34:26–34:29

He provides for the animals

PSA 145:16 See also JOB 38:41; PSA 104:27–104:28, PSA 147:9; MAT 6:26 parallel LUK 12:24

He provides for all people

ACT 14:17 See also 1CH 29:12; PSA 68:5, PSA 107:9; MAT 5:45; ACT 17:28

He provides for the poor and needy

PSA 140:12 See also 1SA 2:8; PSA 35:10, PSA 145:13–145:14, PSA 146:7–146:9; ISA 25:4

Special instances of God's practical provision

Food and water in the wilderness: EXO 16:13–16:18, EXO 17:3–17:6; ; NUM 11:4–11:9, NUM 11:31–11:32; 1KI 17:6, 1KI 17:16, 1KI 19:5–19:8; 2KI 4:42–4:44 Elisha feeds 100 men from 20 barley loaves; ; MAT 14:15–14:21 parallels MRK 6:35–6:44, LUK 9:12–9:17, JHN 6:5–6:13 Jesus Christ feeds 5,000; ; MAT 15:32–15:38 parallel MRK 8:1–8:9 Jesus Christ feeds 4,000

God's special provision for his own people**He provides for their practical needs**

PHP 4:19 See also DEU 2:7; PSA 68:10, PSA 111:5; MAT 6:25–6:33 parallel LUK 12:22–12:31

He provides for their protection

PSA 5:12 See also GEN 28:15; DEU 33:27; 1SA 2:9; PSA 91:9–91:13, PSA 121:3–121:8; ISA 46:4; PHP 4:7; 1PE 1:5; JUD 1:24; REV 3:10

He provides for their every need

2PE 1:3 See also 1CO 3:21–3:23; COL 2:10

Examples of God's provision for his people

2SA 7:10 parallel 1CH 17:9 security in the promised land; ; ISA 61:3 consolation in grief; ; JER 33:6–33:9 restoration from captivity; ; 1CO 10:13 a way of escape from temptation

Implications of God's providential care**Freedom from worry**

MAT 6:31–6:33 parallel LUK 12:29–12:31

Generosity

LUK 6:38 See also 1CH 29:14; 2CO 9:6–9:11; PHP 4:18

Faithfulness

ROM 2:4 See also ISA 5:1-5:7; HOS 10:1-10:2, HOS 11:1-11:4

1335: blessing

Spiritual and material benefits given by God to be enjoyed. Blessing the name of God is also the appropriate response of believers to all that God has done for them.

God is the source of all blessing

1CH 29:11-29:12 See also PSA 89:11

At creation he blessed humans with fertility and authority over the earth

GEN 1:28-1:30

The disobedience of Adam and Eve caused God to remove his blessing

GEN 3:16-3:19 See also GEN 6:5-6:7

After the flood God renewed his promise of blessing to Noah

GEN 9:1-9:3 See also GEN 8:22; JOB 5:10; PSA 65:9-65:13

The blessings promised to Abraham

The blessings included descendants and nationhood

GEN 12:2-12:3 See also GEN 17:1-17:8, GEN 18:18, GEN 26:4, GEN 35:11; EXO 1:6-1:7; DEU 1:10-1:11, DEU 7:13; 1KI 3:8; NEH 9:23; ISA 51:2

The blessings included land

GEN 17:8 See also GEN 12:7, GEN 26:3; DEU 1:8, DEU 4:40, DEU 11:8-11:12

The promises of blessing to Abraham were fulfilled in Jesus Christ

GAL 3:16 See also ACT 3:25-3:26; GAL 3:29

Blessings promised to Israel

Blessings of fruitfulness and prosperity

DEU 7:13-7:14 See also GEN 49:25; LEV 26:10; DEU 15:4, DEU 28:8, DEU 28:12

Blessings of good health and long life

EXO 23:25-23:26 See also EXO 15:26; DEU 7:15

Blessings of peace and victory over enemies

DEU 28:7 See also EXO 23:22; LEV 26:6-26:8; DEU 7:24; PSA 29:11

The promise of being blessed by future restoration

JER 31:23 See also ISA 61:9, ISA 65:17-65:25; EZK 34:25-34:31

The conditions of God's blessings

Fear of the Lord brings blessing

JER 32:40 See also DEU 6:1-6:3, DEU 10:12-10:20; ECC 12:13; ISA 50:10

Obedience to the Lord brings blessing

DEU 11:26-11:28 See also DEU 28:1-28:14, DEU 30:15-30:20

To bless God is to worship and adore him

NEH 9:5 See also GEN 9:26, GEN 14:20

People may bless one another in the name of the Lord

NUM 6:24-6:26 There is a close link between blessing and prayer. See also GEN 27:27-27:29, GEN 49:1-49:28; RUT 1:8-1:9; ISA 2:20; 1CH 4:10; MAT 23:39

1340: consistency

God's nature, plans and purpose do not change. The same consistent plan of salvation can be seen throughout the OT and NT, culminating in Jesus Christ who is "the same yesterday and today and for ever". Believers are also called to show the same consistency in their faith and witness.

God's nature is consistent and unchanging

MAL 3:6 See also PSA 102:27; JAS 1:17

God's plans and purpose are consistent and unchanging

PSA 33:11 See also NUM 23:19; ISA 15:29; JOB 36:5; PSA 89:34; TIT 1:2; HEB 7:21; PSA 110:4

God's plan of salvation is consistent

GEN 12:2-12:3; HEB 6:17-6:18, HEB 13:8 See also GEN 18:18, GEN 22:17-22:18, GEN 26:4, GEN 28:14; DEU 18:15, DEU 18:18; PSA 72:17; JER 4:1-4:2; ZEC 8:13; ACT 3:23-3:26; GAL 3:8

Believers are to live lives consistent with their profession of faith

EPH 4:1; PHP 1:27 See also MAT 5:37; 1TH 4:12; 1TI 3:7; HEB 13:7; JAS 5:12; 2PE 3:11

1345: covenant

God's commitment to, and requirement of, his people expressed in promise, law, judgment, faithfulness and mercy. Also used of commitment within human relationships based upon agreements.

1346: covenants, nature of

A solemn agreement or promise, sometimes confirmed by sacrifice or by sharing in a meal, by which

two or more parties commit themselves to the rights and responsibilities demanded by their relationship and their agreed course of action, and accept the serious consequences of breaking faith.

Kinds of covenant relationship

The relationship between king and people

2SA 5:3 parallel 1CH 11:3 See also 2SA 3:21; 2KI 11:17; 2CH 23:3

Terms for peace granted to a weaker party

JOS 9:15 See also 1SA 11:1; 1KI 15:19–15:20, 1KI 20:34; EZK 17:13–17:14

A mutual commitment to peaceful relations

1KI 5:12 See also GEN 21:27, GEN 26:28–26:29, GEN 31:44; AMO 1:9

An agreement on a common course of action

JER 34:8 See also 2KI 11:4 parallel 2CH 23:1; EZR 10:3; NEH 9:38; PSA 83:5

The relationship between husband and wife

PRO 2:17; ; MAL 2:14; JER 2:2; ; EZK 16:8

An expression of friendship

1SA 18:3 See also 1SA 20:16–20:17

Sealing a covenant

By sharing a meal

GEN 26:30, GEN 31:53–31:54; MAT 26:26–26:29 parallels MRK 14:22–14:25, LUK 22:17–22:20; ; 1CO 11:23–11:25

By offering a sacrifice

JER 34:18–34:19 The Hebrew expression for making a covenant means, literally, “to cut a covenant”. This may refer to the solemn practice, described here, of cutting an animal in half and walking between its pieces; ; GEN 15:9–15:18; ; EXO 24:4–24:8; ; PSA 50:5; ; HEB 12:24 Sacrifice is an important part in sealing covenants made by God.

By making an oath

GEN 21:31, GEN 26:31; ; JOS 9:15; ; 2KI 11:4; ; NEH 10:28–10:29

The obligations of a covenant

Covenant responsibilities must be honoured

NUM 30:2; 1SA 20:8 See also JOS 9:18; MAT 5:33–5:37; GAL 3:15

Covenant obligations are watched over by God

1SA 20:42 See also GEN 31:48–31:54; JOS 9:19; JER 34:15–34:16; MAL 2:14–2:16

The consequences of breaking covenant faith

JOS 9:20 See also JER 34:18–34:22; EZK 17:16–17:18; AMO 1:9

Covenants with other nations are forbidden

EXO 34:12 See also DEU 23:6; JOS 9:7

Covenants with other nations lead to a commitment to foreign gods

EXO 23:32–23:33, EXO 34:15–34:16; ; DEU 7:2–7:4

Covenants with other nations lead to a denial of faith in God

ISA 28:15, ISA 28:18, ISA 30:1–30:2, ISA 31:1; ; HOS 12:1

1347: covenant, God's with Noah

God's confirmation of, and commitment to maintain, his relationship with the natural order- implicit in the act of creation- whereby he promised never again to destroy the earth with a flood. This divine pledge, given unconditionally to Noah and to every living creature on earth, was accompanied by the sign of the rainbow.

The occasion of the covenant

The flood as divine judgment

GEN 6:17 See also GEN 6:5–6:7, GEN 6:11–6:13; 2PE 2:5

God's promise of salvation to Noah and his family

GEN 6:18 See also GEN 7:23, GEN 8:1, GEN 8:15–8:17; HEB 11:7; 1PE 3:20

God's promise never again to destroy the earth with a flood

GEN 9:11 See also GEN 8:21; ISA 54:9

The sign of the covenant

GEN 9:13 See also GEN 9:14–9:17

A universal covenant

God's relationship with every living creature

GEN 9:8–9:10 See also GEN 7:1–7:3; EZK 34:25; HOS 2:18; ZEC 11:10

God's relationship with the natural order

GEN 8:22; JER 33:25–33:26 God's relationship with the created order is here expressed as a covenant. It is probable that this is a reference to the Noahic covenant through which the implicit relationship between Creator and creation was confirmed. See also GEN 1:14, GEN 1:31, GEN 2:1; PSA 74:16–74:17; JER 5:24, JER 33:20–33:21

An everlasting covenant

GEN 9:16 See also GEN 9:12 **ISA 24:5** The reference here is to the Noahic covenant. Though this covenant was unconditional, the prohibition of bloodshed-often described as bringing pollution to the land-was associated with it. There may be, also, a wider reference to the effects of mankind's disregard for the norms

laid down at creation. See also GEN 9:6; NUM 35:33; ISA 26:21

1348: covenant, God's with Abraham

God's gracious promise made to Abraham, and repeated to his descendants, to bless both them and, through them, the whole world. In response God calls for faithful obedience, expressed particularly in the outward sign of circumcision.

Features of the Abrahamic covenant

The covenant is based upon God's gracious promise

GAL 3:18 See also GEN 15:4–15:7, GEN 17:4–17:8, GEN 18:10, GEN 18:14; HEB 6:13–6:15

The covenant was confirmed by sacrifice

GEN 15:9–15:18

The covenant was given in perpetuity

GEN 17:7 See also GEN 17:13, GEN 17:19; 1CH 16:15–16:17 parallel PSA 105:8–105:10; JER 33:23–33:25

God's promises to Abraham

GEN 12:2–12:3

God promised the land of Canaan

GEN 17:8 See also GEN 12:7, GEN 15:18–15:21; EXO 6:4; JOS 1:3; NEH 9:8; ACT 7:5

God promised that Abraham would be the father of a nation

GEN 15:5 See also GEN 12:2, GEN 17:4–17:6 The change of name from Abram to Abraham is a sign of God's covenant with him; GEN 17:16, GEN 22:17; HEB 11:11–11:12

God promised a relationship with himself

GEN 17:8 See also GEN 26:24; DEU 29:13; MAT 22:32 parallel MRK 12:26; EXO 3:6; ACT 7:32

The requirements of the covenant

Obedience

GEN 17:9–17:14 Circumcision is the sign of Abraham's commitment to God's covenant with him; **GEN 22:18** See also GEN 26:5; NUM 32:11 by contrast, the consequences of disobedience; HEB 11:8, HEB 11:17–11:19

Faith

GEN 15:6; NEH 9:8 See also ROM 4:3, ROM 4:11–4:12, ROM 4:18; GAL 3:6–3:7; HEB 11:8–11:12; JAS 2:23

God's faithfulness to the covenant

God remembers his promise

PSA 105:42 See also GEN 21:2, GEN 50:24; EXO 33:1; ACT 7:17; HEB 6:15

God shows compassion for his people

2KI 13:23 See also EXO 2:24–2:25, EXO 32:13–32:14; DEU 9:27; LUK 1:72–1:73

The scope of the covenant

The covenant continued through Isaac, not Ishmael

GEN 17:19–17:21 See also GEN 21:12; ROM 9:7–9:8; GAL 4:28

The covenant confirmed through Abraham, Isaac and Jacob

LEV 26:42 See also GEN 26:24 Isaac GEN 28:13–28:14, GEN 32:12 EXO 3:6; DEU 1:8; ACT 7:8

The people of Israel are heirs to the covenant

DEU 29:12–29:13 See also ACT 3:25

All nations will be blessed through Abraham

GEN 18:18 See also GEN 26:4; ACT 3:25; GAL 3:8–3:9, GAL 3:14, GAL 3:29

1349: covenant, God's at Sinai

God's faithful commitment, made in pursuance of his promises to Abraham, to acknowledge the newly-redeemed Israel as his own special people. Israel's required response to the grace of God in election was to be holiness and obedience to the law.

The occasion of the covenant

The covenant fulfilled God's promises to Abraham

DEU 29:12–29:13 See also EXO 2:24, EXO 6:4–6:8; DEU 7:8

The covenant followed Israel's redemption from slavery

JER 34:13 God's covenant at Sinai was made in the context of his historical acts of deliverance. Covenants ("treaties") between a supreme (suzerain) overlord and a subordinate ruler (vassal) are well known in ancient Near Eastern writings. They are not "agreements" but "requirements". See also EXO 20:2 parallel DEU 5:6; LEV 26:45

The covenant was mediated through Moses

EXO 34:27; ; LEV 26:46; ; DEU 29:1; ; JHN 1:17

The covenant was accompanied by signs of God's presence

EXO 19:18–19:19, EXO 20:18–20:19, EXO 24:16; ; PSA 68:8

Sealing the covenant

Sharing a meal

EXO 24:11

Offering a sacrifice

EXO 24:5–24:8; ; PSA 50:5

God's oath

DEU 28:9, DEU 29:14; ; EZK 16:8

Israel's promise

EXO 19:8, EXO 24:3, EXO 24:7

The covenant relationship**Israel as God's people**

DEU 7:6 See also EXO 19:5–19:6; LEV 26:12; DEU 14:2; JER 13:11

Israel adopted into God's family

HOS 11:1 See also DEU 1:30–1:31, DEU 8:5; ISA 63:16; MAL 2:10

Israel as God's bride

JER 2:2 See also ISA 54:5–54:8; JER 31:32; EZK 16:8; HOS 2:14–2:16

The blessings of the covenant**Inheriting God's promises**

DEU 6:3, DEU 26:18–26:19, DEU 28:9; ; JOS 23:5

Provision and protection

LEV 26:3–26:13; ; DEU 28:1–28:14 This pattern of blessings and curses is also a feature of Near Eastern political treaties.

The requirements of the covenant**Obedience to the law**

EXO 24:7, EXO 34:27–34:28 See also DEU 4:13; JOS 8:31; NEH 8:1

Holiness

DEU 14:2 Israel has been made holy through her election as the covenant people of God. The ensuing call for holiness is a call to work out the implications of that relationship and to live in accordance with its demands; **LEV 11:45** See also LEV 20:26

Wholehearted devotion

EXO 34:14; DEU 10:12 See also EXO 23:32; DEU 4:23, DEU 6:5, DEU 10:20; JOS 24:14–24:15

Breaking the covenant**The consequences of breaking the covenant**

Disease: LEV 26:15–26:16; ; DEU 28:21–28:22; LEV 26:19–26:20; ; DEU 28:23–28:24; LEV 26:17, LEV 26:25; ; DEU 28:25; LEV 26:32–26:33; ; DEU 28:36–28:37; ; JOS 23:16; ; EZK 17:19–17:20

Israel's unfaithfulness to the covenant

PSA 78:37 See also 2KI 18:12; 1CH 5:25; JER 3:8, JER 11:10; EZK 16:32; HOS 6:7

God's commitment to the covenant**God's covenant of love**

DEU 7:9 “love” translates the Hebrew word “hesed”, which here expresses God's loyalty and faithful commitment to his covenant people. See also NEH 1:5; DAN 9:4

The everlasting covenant

EZK 16:60 God's faithfulness to the covenant at Sinai will result in a new covenant that will never come to an end. See also ISA 61:8; JER 32:40

Renewing the covenant

LEV 26:40–26:45; ; DEU 29:1; ; JOS 24:22–24:25; ; 2KI 23:3 parallel 2CH 34:31

1350: covenant, God's with Israel's priests

God's promise to the Levites, and to the family of Phinehas in particular, to maintain those who serve him faithfully in a lasting priesthood.

God's covenant with Phinehas

NUM 25:12–25:13 Phinehas was the grandson of Aaron. God's pledge of “a lasting priesthood”, granted to him as a result of his zeal, probably means that the high priesthood would remain in his family. See also NUM 25:10–25:11; EZR 7:1–7:5; PSA 106:30–106:31

God's covenant with the Levites**An everlasting covenant**

NUM 18:19 This covenant confirms the privileges and responsibilities of Aaron and his fellow Levites who have been called to Israel's priesthood. The reference to “salt” may underline the permanent nature of the covenant. God's covenant with David is also described as a “covenant of salt”. See also 2CH 13:5; JER 33:18–33:22

Requirements of the covenant

MAL 2:5–2:6

The Levites' portion is the LORD

DEU 10:8–10:9 See also NUM 3:12

The covenant violated

MAL 2:8 By their unfaithfulness, Judah's priests have forfeited the blessings of God's promise to Levi. See also NEH 13:29

1351: covenant, God's with David

God's promise to establish David and his descendants on Israel's throne for ever. It provided Israel with a basis for the hope of deliverance and restoration, and became a focus for the Messianic expectation which was fulfilled, ultimately, in Jesus Christ.

God's promise to establish David's line

God's election of David

PSA 78:70 See also 2SA 6:21; 1KI 8:16 parallel 2CH 6:6

God's covenant is everlasting

PSA 89:3–89:4 See also 2SA 7:11–7:16, 2SA 23:5; 1KI 2:45; 2CH 13:5; PSA 18:50, PSA 89:28–89:29, PSA 89:35–89:37; JER 33:17

God's covenant is inherited through obedience

PSA 132:11–132:12 Though God's promise to maintain David's throne is unbreakable, individual descendants must continue to be faithful if they are to inherit the blessings promised to David. See also 1KI 8:25–8:26 parallel 2CH 6:16–6:17; 1KI 9:4–9:5 parallel 2CH 7:17–7:18

God's covenant blessings are forfeited through disobedience

JER 22:4–22:5 Failure to remain faithful to God brings judgment on the royal house and the people. See also 1KI 9:6–9:9 parallel 2CH 7:19–7:22; 1KI 11:11–11:13, 1KI 11:31–11:33; JER 7:24–7:26, JER 22:6–22:9, JER 36:30–36:31

God's promise is fulfilled by grace

2CH 21:7 parallel 2KI 8:19 Though particular kings may suffer God's anger because of their sin, God's faithfulness to the house of David as a whole, and thus to the nation of Israel, will continue. See also 1KI 11:34–11:36, 1KI 11:39, 1KI 15:4; PSA 89:30–89:34

The Davidic covenant as a basis for hope

God's election of Jerusalem

2KI 21:7 parallel 2CH 33:7 God's Name signifies his presence. God's choice of David was closely related to his choice of Jerusalem, the city established by David, as the place where the divine presence symbolised in the temple and the ark of the covenant was to be found. See also 1KI 8:20–8:21 parallel 2CH 6:10–6:11; 1KI 11:32, 1KI 11:36; 1CH 23:25; 2CH 6:41–6:42 parallel PSA 132:8–132:10

God's promise to defend Jerusalem

ISA 37:35 parallel 2KI 19:34 See also 2KI 19:20; ZEC 12:7–12:9

God's promise to restore David's house

AMO 9:11 See also ACT 15:16; JER 33:25–33:26

Hopes expressed in the Davidic covenant are focused in the Messiah

The Messiah fulfils the Davidic hope

JER 23:5–23:6 See also PSA 110:1–110:2; ISA 9:7, ISA 11:1–11:2, ISA 16:5, ISA 55:3; EZK 34:23–34:25; ZEC 3:8; JHN 7:42

God's promise to David fulfilled in Jesus Christ

LUK 1:32–1:33; REV 22:16 See also MAT 1:1, MAT 22:41–22:46 parallels MRK 12:35–12:37, LUK 20:41–20:44MRK 11:10 parallel MAT 21:9; LUK 24:21; ACT 1:6 ACT 2:29–2:31, ACT 13:34; ROM 1:3; 2TI 2:8

1352: covenant, the new

The fulfilment of God's purposes of salvation expressed in the covenants of the OT, mediated by Jesus Christ and sealed in his blood. It is a covenant of grace, the benefits of which include forgiveness, a renewed relationship with God and, through the Holy Spirit, an inward transformation that enables obedience to its demands and so ensures that it will not again be broken. **JER 31:31** The "new" covenant is contrasted with the covenant made at Sinai which is sometimes referred to as the "old" or "first" covenant.

The new covenant fulfils the OT covenants

God's covenant with Noah

ISA 54:9–54:10; ; HOS 2:18

God's covenant with Abraham

LUK 1:72–1:73; ; ACT 3:25–3:26; ; GAL 3:14–3:16

God's covenant at Sinai

EZK 16:60, EZK 16:62, EZK 20:37

God's covenant with David

ISA 55:3; ; EZK 34:24–34:26, EZK 37:25–37:26; ; LUK 1:69

Jesus Christ, the mediator of the new covenant

The new covenant fulfilled in the Messiah

MAL 3:1 See also ISA 42:6, ISA 49:8

The new covenant effected through Jesus Christ's death

HEB 9:15 See also HEB 9:16–9:17

The new covenant sealed in Jesus Christ's blood

LUK 22:20 parallels MAT 26:28, MRK 14:24 See also EXO 24:8 Blood was an important element in sealing the Sinaitic covenant; JHN 6:54; 1CO 10:16, 1CO 11:25; HEB 10:29

The ministry of the Holy Spirit

2CO 3:6, 2CO 3:18 See also ISA 59:21; EZK 36:26–36:27; ROM 8:2–8:4; 2CO 3:8

The superior blessings of the new covenant

God's grace and mercy

HEB 12:24 The blood of Abel cried out to God for justice and retribution; the blood of Jesus Christ, shed to seal the new covenant, cries out for mercy and forgiveness.

A complete forgiveness**HEB 8:12** See also JER 31:34; ROM 11:27; HEB 10:17**Release from the law's condemnation**

2CO 3:9; GAL 3:13–3:14

An inward enabling to obey God's laws**JER 31:32–31:33** The old covenant was broken because its demands were not met. Under the new covenant the requirements of obedience are not abolished, but in writing his laws on human hearts, God gives the ability to meet the covenant demands. See also JER 32:38–32:40; EZK 11:19–11:20; 2CO 3:3; HEB 8:9–8:10, HEB 9:14, HEB 10:16**A new knowledge of God****HEB 8:11** See also JER 31:34; 2CO 3:15–3:16**A renewed relationship with God****EZK 37:26–37:27** “peace” refers to spiritual and material well-being; real peace is possible only for those in a right relationship with God. The formula “I will be their God, and they will be my people” is associated also with the Abrahamic and especially the Sinaitic covenants. See also JER 24:7, JER 31:1; EZK 34:30–34:31; HOS 2:19–2:23**A superior priesthood****HEB 8:6** See also HEB 7:22, HEB 9:24–9:25**A superior sacrifice****HEB 9:14** See also HEB 9:20–9:23, HEB 9:26–9:28, HEB 10:4, HEB 10:8–10:14**A lasting covenant****ISA 61:8; 2CO 3:11** See also JER 50:5; HEB 8:7, HEB 8:13, HEB 13:20**1355: providence**

The continuing and often unseen activity of God in sustaining his universe, providing for the needs of every creature, and preparing for the completion of his eternal purposes.

God's general providence**God sustains the created order****GEN 8:22** A promise given by God to all peoples. See also NEH 9:6; ISA 40:26; COL 1:17; HEB 1:3**All life is dependent on God****1TI 6:13** See also 1SA 1:27; JOB 1:21; PSA 127:3; ECC 3:2, ECC 9:9; EZK 24:16; DAN 5:26; MAT 4:4, MAT 10:29**God controls the elements****PSA 147:8** See also JOB 37:1–37:13; PSA 29:3–29:9, PSA 135:6–135:7; MAT 5:45; ACT 17:25–17:28**God provides for the created world****PSA 145:15–145:16** See also JOB 38:39–38:41; PSA 104:27–104:28, PSA 136:25, PSA 147:9; LUK 12:6–12:7; ACT 14:17; 1TI 6:17**God's providence through miraculous means****JOB 5:9–5:10** God's regular activity in providing for human beings is regarded as being miraculous in just the same way as special demonstrations of his power. See also EXO 16:11–16:14; NUM 16:28–16:35; JDG 15:18–15:19; 1KI 17:5–17:6; 2KI 4:42–4:44**God's providence in human history****God's control of human intentions****HAB 1:12** See also 1KI 22:19–22:20; 2KI 19:27–19:28 parallel ISA 37:28–37:29; ISA 10:15; HAB 1:6**God's providential actions on behalf of individuals****ROM 8:28** See also JOB 1:12, JOB 2:6; PSA 107:12–107:14, PSA 107:24–107:29, PSA 107:33–107:38; ISA 38:17**God's saving purposes fulfilled through providence****GEN 50:20** See also GEN 22:13, GEN 45:5–45:8; 2CH 36:22–36:23 parallel EZR 1:1–1:3; EZR 6:14; ISA 44:28–45:1; ACT 2:23, ACT 4:27–4:28; GAL 4:4–4:5**God's providence prepares for the completion of his ultimate purpose****God is forming a people for himself****REV 21:3** See also EXO 6:7; JER 31:33; 2CO 6:16; EPH 2:14–2:16; 1PE 1:3–1:5; REV 7:9**God will bring all things under Jesus Christ's authority****EPH 1:9–1:10** See also ISA 45:22–45:23, ISA 66:23; 1CO 15:24–15:26; PHP 2:10–2:11; COL 1:20; REV 11:15**God will complete his purpose for creation****ROM 8:20–8:21** See also ISA 65:17, ISA 66:22; 2PE 3:13; REV 21:1**God directs all things for his glory****ROM 11:36** See also PSA 46:10; ROM 9:23, ROM 11:36; EPH 1:4–1:6, EPH 1:11–1:12**1400: God, knowledge of**

- 1403: God, revelation of
- 1406: burning bush
- 1409: dream
- 1412: foreknowledge
- 1415: miracles
- 1421: oracles
- 1424: predictions
- 1427: prophecy
- 1436: reality
- 1439: revelation

- 1448: signs
- 1454: theophany
- 1457: trance
- 1460: truth
- 1466: vision
- 1469: visions

1403: God, revelation of

God graciously makes himself known to humanity since people cannot discover him on their own. He achieves this in many ways, but supremely through his Son Jesus Christ.

The necessity of revelation

God is hidden from human view because of sin

ISA 59:2 See also DEU 31:18; ISA 1:15, ISA 45:15, ISA 64:7; EZK 39:23; MIC 3:4

People are ignorant of God

ACT 17:23 See also EXO 5:2; JDG 2:10; JER 4:22; JHN 4:22, JHN 15:21; GAL 4:8; EPH 4:18; 1TH 4:5

People cannot know God unaided

MAT 11:25–11:27 parallel LUK 10:21–10:22 See also JOB 34:29; 1CO 1:21

The means by which God reveals himself

In the Scriptures

PSA 119:105 See also PSA 19:7–19:10, PSA 119:130, PSA 147:19; PRO 6:23; 2TI 3:16; 2PE 1:19–1:21

By the Holy Spirit

EPH 1:17 See also NEH 9:20; LUK 2:26, LUK 12:12; JHN 14:26; 1CO 2:10, 1CO 2:12; 1JN 2:27

Supremely in Jesus Christ

HEB 1:1–1:2 See also JHN 1:18, JHN 8:26, JHN 12:49, JHN 14:10, JHN 17:6

In the creation

PSA 19:1 See also PSA 97:6; ACT 14:17, ACT 17:26–17:27

Through the prophets

AMO 3:7 See also NUM 12:6; 2SA 7:17 parallel 1CH 17:15; 2SA 7:27 parallel 1CH 17:25; ISA 22:14; 1PE 1:12

In visions and dreams

DAN 1:17 See also GEN 15:1; ISA 1:1; EZK 11:24; DAN 8:1; NAM 1:1; MAT 1:20, MAT 2:12, MAT 2:22; ACT 9:10, ACT 16:9, ACT 22:17–22:18

Face to face

NUM 12:8 See also GEN 32:30; EXO 24:9–24:10; JDG 13:22; JOB 42:5; ISA 6:5

In the exodus

EXO 7:5 See also EXO 14:4; 1SA 2:27; EZK 20:5, EZK 20:9

In special signs

JDG 6:36–6:40 Gideon's fleece; ; 1KI 13:3–13:5 an altar split apart; ; 2KI 20:9–20:11 parallel ISA 38:7–38:8 a shadow moving backwards

The nature of God's self-revelation in Jesus Christ

God reveals Jesus Christ's true identity

MAT 16:17 See also MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11, LUK 3:22; MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:35; JHN 1:31; GAL 1:15–1:16; 2PE 1:17–1:18

Jesus Christ is the visible image of God

COL 1:15 See also 2CO 4:4; PHP 2:6; HEB 1:3

Jesus Christ's glory is still to be fully revealed

LUK 17:30; ; 1CO 1:7; ; 2TH 1:7; ; 1PE 1:7, 1PE 1:13, 1PE 4:13

Things that God reveals

Hidden mysteries

DAN 2:22 See also GEN 41:16; JOB 12:22; DAN 2:28–2:30, DAN 2:47

Future events

GEN 41:25 See also 1SA 9:15–9:16; 2KI 8:10; JER 11:18, JER 38:21; MAT 2:13; ACT 18:9–18:10, ACT 27:22–27:24

His righteousness

ROM 1:17 See also ISA 56:1; ROM 3:21; REV 15:4

His wrath

ROM 1:18 See also NUM 11:1; 2SA 6:7 parallel 1CH 13:10; PSA 7:11; ROM 2:5

His salvation

PSA 98:2 See also ISA 52:10; LUK 2:30–2:32, LUK 3:6; TIT 2:11

His glory

ISA 40:5 EXO 16:10, EXO 33:9; ; NUM 12:5; ; DEU 1:33; ; NEH 9:12; ; PSA 78:14, PSA 105:39; EXO 33:18–33:23 the LORD shows his glory to Moses; EXO 40:34; ; LEV 16:2; ; DEU 31:15; ; EZK 9:3, EZK 10:4; DEU 5:24; ; PSA 97:6, PSA 102:16; ; ISA 35:2, ISA 44:23, ISA 60:2; ; ACT 7:55

The mystery of the gospel

EPH 3:2–3:3 "mystery" in the NT means "something previously hidden, undiscoverable by human means but now revealed by God". See also MAT 13:11 parallels MRK 4:11, LUK 8:10; ROM 16:25–16:26; GAL 3:23; EPH 3:5–3:6; COL 1:26–1:27; 2TI 1:10

The revelation of God's will

Physical means by which God reveals his will

By the Urim and Thummim: EXO 28:30; ; NUM 27:21; JOS 18:6–18:10; ; JON 1:7; ; ACT 1:26

God's self-revelation makes his will plain

ROM 1:20 See also ZEC 7:11–7:12; JHN 9:41, JHN 16:8; ROM 7:7

God's self-revelation is according to his own sovereign purpose

ISA 65:1 See also DAN 2:30; ROM 10:20; GAL 1:11–1:12

1406: burning bush**God spoke to Moses through a bush which burned but was not consumed**

ACT 7:30–7:34 See also EXO 3:1–3:5; DEU 33:13–33:16; MRK 12:26 parallel LUK 20:37; ACT 7:35

1409: dream

A series of images or thoughts experienced in one's mind while asleep. A means by which a divine message may be conveyed while the recipient sleeps. God may communicate directly in the dream, or interpretation may be necessary.

Direct communication through dreams

GEN 31:24 See also GEN 20:3, GEN 20:6; ISA 28:6, ISA 28:15; 1KI 3:5, 1KI 3:15; JOB 33:14–33:15; MAT 1:20, MAT 2:12–2:13, MAT 2:19–2:20, MAT 2:22

Dreams involving unusual images

GEN 28:12–28:15, GEN 31:10–31:13, GEN 37:5–37:7, GEN 37:9, GEN 40:9–40:11, GEN 40:16–40:17, GEN 41:1–41:7; ; JDG 7:13; ; DAN 2:31–2:35, DAN 4:10–4:17

God is the source of interpretation of such dreams

DAN 2:26–2:28 See also GEN 40:8, GEN 41:15–41:16, GEN 41:25, GEN 41:28; DAN 4:24

Interpretation of unusual images

GEN 40:12–40:13, GEN 40:18–40:19, GEN 41:26–41:31; ; JDG 7:14–7:15; ; JER 23:28, JER 31:23–31:26; ; DAN 2:36–2:45, DAN 4:19–4:26

Revelation to prophets through dreams

NUM 12:6; JOL 2:28 See also DAN 1:17, DAN 2:19–2:23; ACT 2:17

Dreams and false prophets

DEU 13:1–13:3 See also DEU 13:5; JER 23:25–23:27, JER 23:32, JER 27:9, JER 29:8–29:9; ZEC 10:2

Ordinary dreams

ISA 29:7–29:8 Not every dream is a vehicle for divine communication. Most are part of the natural process of sleep. See also JOB 7:13–7:15; PSA 73:20; ECC 5:3, ECC 5:7; ISA 56:10

1412: foreknowledge

Foreknowledge is an aspect of God's knowledge of everything, and thus nothing can surprise him. Jesus Christ had foreknowledge of his own death, resurrection and coming in glory.

God's foreknowledge**Everything is within God's knowledge**

ISA 42:9 See also 1KI 22:14; DAN 2:28; MAT 24:36 parallel MRK 13:32

What God knows he ordains

ISA 46:10–46:11 See also ACT 2:23; ROM 8:28–8:30; 1PE 1:1–1:2

God's foreknowledge of the Messiah

ACT 3:18 See also ISA 11:1–11:3, ISA 53:7–53:9; MIC 5:2; ACT 2:22–2:23, ACT 4:27–4:28; 1PE 1:20

God's foreknowledge and his election of his people**God's sovereign choice**

ROM 8:29 See also PRO 16:4; ROM 9:11–9:12, ROM 11:2; EPH 1:4; 1PE 1:1–1:2, 1PE 1:20

Human responsibility

HEB 2:3 See also JHN 3:18, JHN 3:36; 1CO 15:2; 2CO 6:1–6:2; EPH 5:5–5:6; HEB 3:12, HEB 6:4–6:6; 2PE 2:1; HEB 3:15; PSA 95:7–95:8

Jesus Christ's foreknowledge**Of events within his general ministry**

JHN 6:64 See also MAT 17:27, MAT 26:31–26:34 parallel MRK 14:27–14:30; LUK 22:34; JHN 13:38

Of his suffering and departure

JHN 13:1 See also MAT 26:18; MRK 8:31 parallel LUK 9:22; LUK 12:50, LUK 22:37; JHN 3:14, JHN 7:33, JHN 13:11, JHN 13:33, JHN 14:28, JHN 17:5, JHN 18:4, JHN 19:28

Of his coming in glory and judgment

MAT 16:27 See also MAT 24:30–24:31 parallel MRK 13:26–13:27; MAT 25:31; MRK 8:38 parallel LUK 9:26; LUK 24:26

Jesus Christ's lack of knowledge of the timing of his coming in glory

MRK 13:32 parallel MAT 24:36

1415: miracles

Events that are totally out of the ordinary and that cannot be adequately explained on the basis of natural occurrences, such as those associated with the ministry of Jesus Christ. They are seen as evidence of the presence and power of God in the world or

as demonstrating authority on the part of one of his servants.

1416: miracles, nature of

Miracles may be performed directly by God or through a human agent. Those recorded in Scripture include healing, raising the dead, miracles of nature and the casting out of demons.

Miracles demonstrate God's greatness and power

PSA 77:14 See also EXO 14:30–14:31, EXO 34:10; DEU 3:24; 1KI 18:37–18:39; JOB 5:9; PSA 78:4; LUK 9:42–9:43

Miracles bringing God's judgment

LEV 10:1–10:2 See also GEN 19:24–19:26; NUM 12:10, NUM 16:31–16:35; 1KI 13:4–13:5; 2KI 1:9–1:12; 2CH 26:19–26:20; ACT 5:5, ACT 5:10, ACT 13:11

Miracles which meet human need

The provision of food and water

EXO 17:6 See also EXO 15:25; NUM 11:31–11:32, NUM 20:10–20:11; JDG 15:18–15:19; 1KI 17:5–17:6, 1KI 17:8–17:16; 2KI 2:19–2:22, 2KI 4:42–4:44; MAT 14:15–14:21; MRK 8:1–8:10

Healing

ACT 5:16 See also NUM 21:6–21:9; 2KI 5:1–5:14; LUK 9:6; ACT 3:1–3:10, ACT 9:33–9:34, ACT 28:7–28:9

Exorcism

ACT 16:18 See also MRK 6:13, MRK 9:38 parallel LUK 9:49; LUK 10:17; ACT 8:7

The raising of the dead

JHN 11:38–11:44 See also 1KI 17:17–17:24; 2KI 4:32–4:37, 2KI 13:21; ACT 9:36–9:41, ACT 20:9–20:12

Miraculous births

GEN 18:10–18:14 See also JDG 13:2–13:3; 1SA 1:20; 2KI 4:14–4:17; LUK 1:34–1:37

Miracles involving military victory

2CH 32:21 parallels 2KI 19:35–19:36, ISA 37:36–37:37 See also EXO 12:29–12:36, EXO 14:26–14:28; JOS 10:12–10:14; 1SA 7:10–7:12; 2KI 6:18–6:23; 2CH 20:22–20:26

Miraculous help in trouble

DAN 6:27 See also PSA 91:11–91:12; DAN 3:19–3:27, DAN 6:19–6:23; MAT 8:23–8:27 parallels MRK 4:36–4:41, LUK 8:22–8:25; ACT 12:6–12:11, ACT 16:25–16:26

Gifts of supernatural strength

JDG 14:5–14:6 See also JDG 14:19, JDG 15:14–15:16, JDG 16:26–16:30; 1KI 18:46

Nature miracles

2KI 2:7–2:8 See also EXO 10:13–10:23, EXO 14:15–14:22; JOS 3:14–3:17; 2KI 2:13–2:14; MAT 21:18–21:22 parallels MRK 11:12–11:14, MRK 11:20–11:24; JHN 2:1–2:11

Miracles are part of God's plan of redemption

2SA 7:23 parallel 1CH 17:21 See also MRK 16:17–16:18; ACT 2:22–2:24, ACT 14:3; HEB 2:3–2:4

Miracles occur at times of special significance

At the time of the exodus

EXO 3:2–3:3, EXO 7:3–7:4, EXO 16:11–16:15, EXO 17:6–17:7; ; NUM 17:8; ; DEU 4:34

At times of national religious crisis

1KI 18:30–18:39; ; 2KI 3:16–3:25, 2KI 4:3–4:7, 2KI 4:40–4:41, 2KI 6:5–6:7

In the time of Jesus Christ

MAT 14:15–14:21 parallels MRK 6:35–6:44, LUK 9:12–9:17, JHN 6:5–6:13; ; MAT 20:29–20:34 parallels MRK 10:46–10:52, LUK 18:35–18:43; ; JHN 11:38–11:44

In the time of the first Christians

LUK 10:17; ; ACT 8:6, ACT 8:13, ACT 14:8–14:10, ACT 14:19–14:20, ACT 19:11–19:12

Miracles are God's gift

They authenticate the message of his servants

JHN 10:38 See also EXO 4:30–4:31; MAT 11:2–11:5 parallel LUK 7:20–7:22; MRK 9:39, MRK 16:20; JHN 14:11; 2CO 12:12

They are given by God's sovereign will

1CO 12:8–12:11 See also MAT 10:1 parallel LUK 9:1; 1CO 12:28–12:30; GAL 3:5

Miracles are not in themselves proof of God's work

They are no guarantee of genuine faith

MAT 7:22–7:23 See also LUK 16:27–16:31; JHN 2:23–2:24; 1CO 13:1–13:2

They can be counterfeited

MAT 24:24 See also EXO 7:11–7:12, EXO 7:22, EXO 8:7; ACT 8:9–8:11; 2TH 2:9; REV 13:13, REV 16:14, REV 19:20

1417: miracles, of Jesus Christ

See [2351: Jesus Christ, miracles of](#)

1418: miracles, responses to

Miracles often depend upon faith on the part of those who will benefit from them. Human responses to miracles take various forms. Some respond in faith and obedience, whilst others are confirmed in their unbelief and rebellion.

Faith and obedience required in the working of miracles

1KI 17:13–17:15 The widow gave Elijah her last meal before she could be miraculously provided for. See also EXO 14:16, EXO 14:21; NUM 21:8–21:9; JOS 3:13–3:17; 1KI 17:5; 2KI 4:41, 2KI 5:10–5:14; MAT 9:6–9:7 parallels MRK 2:10–2:12, LUK 5:24–5:25; MAT 9:22 parallels MRK 5:34, LUK 8:48; LUK 1:38; HEB 11:29–11:30

Miracles limited by lack of faith

MAT 13:58 parallel MRK 6:5–6:6 See also 2KI 4:3–4:6 The number of jars limited the miraculous supply of oil; MAT 14:28–14:31, MAT 17:14–17:20

Positive responses to miracles

Faith

EXO 14:31 See also EXO 4:30–4:31; JHN 7:31; ACT 9:33–9:35, ACT 9:40–9:42, ACT 13:12

Amazement

MAT 15:31 parallel MRK 7:37 See also DAN 3:24; ACT 3:10, ACT 8:13, ACT 12:16

Praise and worship

ACT 3:8 See also EXO 15:11, EXO 15:21; PSA 9:1; DAN 3:28, DAN 4:2–4:3, DAN 6:26–6:27; MAT 15:31; LUK 19:37; ACT 4:21–4:22

A closer attention paid to the word of God

ACT 8:6 See also 1KI 17:24

Temporary faith as a response to miracles

JHN 2:23–2:24 See also EXO 15:20–15:24, EXO 16:1–16:3, EXO 17:3; NUM 20:3–20:5; LUK 17:17–17:18; JHN 6:49

Negative responses to miracles

Fear

MRK 5:15–5:17 parallel LUK 8:36–8:37; ; ACT 5:5, ACT 5:11, ACT 19:17

Disbelief

ACT 12:14–12:15 See also GEN 17:17–17:18, GEN 18:12–18:13; LUK 1:18, LUK 1:20

Hardness of heart

EXO 8:19 See also EXO 7:3–7:4, EXO 11:10; PSA 78:32; MAT 11:20–11:22 parallel LUK 10:13–10:14; JHN 9:18, JHN 9:28–9:29, JHN 10:25–10:26, JHN 12:37, JHN 15:24

Opposition

JHN 11:47–11:48; ; ACT 6:8–6:9, ACT 16:19–16:21

Disobedience

PSA 106:7 See also NUM 14:11, NUM 14:22–14:23; PSA 78:11–78:22, PSA 78:42–78:43

Jealousy

ACT 8:13, ACT 8:18–8:19

1421: oracles

Divine utterances or messages spoken through human lips. Especially noteworthy are the oracles of Balaam. Several other prophecies are also referred to as oracles.

The oracles of Balaam

Divine inspiration is irresistible

NUM 22:38 See also NUM 22:18–22:19, NUM 23:11–23:12, NUM 23:25–23:26, NUM 24:12–24:13

Balaam's experience

NUM 24:2–24:4 See also NUM 23:3–23:5, NUM 24:15–24:16

Balaam's oracles

NUM 23:6–23:10 See also NUM 23:18–23:24, NUM 24:2–24:9, NUM 24:15–24:19, NUM 24:20–24:24

Oracles of the prophets

MAL 1:1 See also ISA 13:1, ISA 14:28, ISA 21:1–21:17, ISA 30:6–30:11; EZK 12:7–12:11 This oracle involved actions as well as words; NAM 1:1

False oracles condemned

LAM 2:14 See also JER 23:33–23:40

Wise judgment likened to oracles

PRO 16:10

Oracles of David

PSA 36:1 See also 2SA 23:1–23:4

1424: predictions

Speaking authoritatively of the future. Since God knows the future he is able to reveal it to people beforehand. Predictions, which are often but not necessarily contained in prophecies, should not be confused with promises or expressions of intention.

God's knowledge of the future

GEN 41:15–41:16, GEN 41:28 See also GEN 18:17; NUM 24:2–24:4; ISA 44:24–44:26

Impossible to predict the future apart from God

ECC 8:7 See also ECC 7:14; ISA 41:22–41:24

Jesus Christ predicted the future

Concerning his death and resurrection

MAT 16:21 parallels MRK 8:31, LUK 9:22 See also MAT 17:22–17:23 parallels MRK 9:31, LUK 9:44; MAT 20:18–20:19 parallels MRK 10:33–10:34, LUK 18:31–18:33; JHN 2:19–2:21, JHN 12:32–12:33

Concerning the donkey on which he would enter Jerusalem

MAT 21:1–21:3 parallels MRK 11:1–11:3, LUK 19:29–19:31

The fall of Jerusalem

MAT 24:1–24:2 parallels MRK 13:1–13:2, LUK 21:5–21:6; ; MAT 24:15–24:25 parallels MRK 13:14–13:23, LUK 21:20–21:24

That Judas would betray him

MAT 26:21–26:25 parallel MRK 14:18–14:20; ; LUK 22:21; ; JHN 13:21, JHN 13:26

That Peter would deny him

MAT 26:34 parallels MRK 14:30, LUK 22:34 See also JHN 13:38

Concerning the nature of Peter's death

JHN 21:18–21:19

The ability to interpret dreams and so predict the future

GEN 40:9–40:13, GEN 40:16–40:19, GEN 41:28–41:32; ; DAN 2:45, DAN 8:26, DAN 10:14

Predictions were made through OT prophets

ISA 15:28, ISA 28:16–28:17; ; 1KI 11:29–11:32; ; HEB 3:5

Predictions made through some of the first Christians

ACT 11:27–11:28 See also ACT 21:10–21:11; JUD 1:17–1:18

False predictions

JER 28:8–28:17 See also ISA 47:13–47:15; ACT 16:16

The Messiah predicted

1PE 1:10–1:11 Most OT references to the coming of the kingdom of God and his Messiah are not, strictly speaking, predictions but promises made by God in which he expresses his intention to save his people through the Messiah. See also ACT 7:52

1427: prophecy

The disclosing of the will and purposes of God through inspired or Spirit-filled human beings. The OT emphasises the importance of prophecy as a means of knowing God. Many OT prophecies find their fulfilment in Jesus Christ. The NT sets out the place of prophecy in the life of the church and gives guidance concerning the use of this gift.

1428: prophecy, inspiration of OT

The prophecies of biblical messengers are acknowledged as being of divine origin, inspired through the activity of the Holy Spirit.

God speaks through his prophets

2PE 1:20–1:21 See also NEH 9:30; ZEC 7:12; HEB 1:1

God is the source of prophecy

EZK 24:20–24:21 The phrase “the word of the LORD came to ...” is frequently used of (and by) the prophets to indicate that the message they proclaimed came directly from God. See also ISA 15:10; 2SA 7:4; 1KI 13:20, 1KI 16:1, 1KI 17:2; 2KI 20:4; JER 1:2; EZK 6:1; JON 1:1; HAG 2:10; ZEC 1:1

Prophets inspired by God speak the truth

DEU 18:22 See also JER 28:9

1429: prophecy, fulfilment of OT

All divinely inspired prophecy achieves its purpose. Scripture records the fulfilment of many prophecies.

The principle that all prophecy achieves its purpose

ISA 55:10–55:11 See also DEU 18:22

Fulfilment of prophecy concerning individuals in the OT

1KI 20:35–20:36 See also 1KI 8:15–8:21 parallel 2CH 6:4–6:11; 1KI 8:23–8:24 parallel 2CH 6:14–6:15; 1KI 13:21–13:22, 1KI 13:24–13:26, 1KI 14:12–14:13, 1KI 14:17–14:18; 2KI 1:6, 2KI 1:17, 2KI 7:1–7:2, 2KI 7:16–7:18, 2KI 22:15–22:20, 2KI 23:30

Fulfilment of prophecy concerning the nation of Israel

1KI 12:15 See also 1KI 11:29–11:39

Fulfilment of prophecy concerning the royal house

1KI 15:29 See also 1KI 14:7–14:11, 1KI 16:1–16:7, 1KI 16:12, 1KI 21:20–21:29; 2KI 9:30–10:11, 2KI 10:30, 2KI 15:12

Fulfilment of prophecy concerning battles

1KI 20:13–20:21 See also 1KI 22:17, 1KI 22:35–22:38; 2KI 19:20–19:37

Fulfilment of prophecy concerning the Babylonian exile

The rise of the Babylonians

HAB 1:6–1:11 See also 2CH 36:17

The fall of Jerusalem and exile of the population

2KI 20:17–20:18 See also 2KI 21:10–21:15, 2KI 24:2, 2KI 24:10–24:16

The fate of King Zedekiah

JER 21:3–21:7 See also JER 32:3–32:5; EZK 12:12–12:14; 2KI 25:1–25:7; JER 39:1–39:7

The length of captivity**JER 29:10** See also 2CH 36:21; DAN 9:2**Fulfilment of prophecy concerning Jesus Christ****LUK 24:44** See also LUK 18:31; ACT 3:18**Fulfilment of other prophecy****ACT 2:14–2:21** See also JOL 2:28–2:32; JOS 6:26; 1KI 16:34, 1KI 13:1–13:3; 2KI 23:16–23:18; 1KI 17:14, 1KI 17:16; MAT 2:17–2:18; JER 31:15; MAT 3:1–3:3 parallels MRK 1:2–1:4, LUK 3:1–3:6; ISA 40:3**Prophecies modified before fulfilment****1KI 21:20–21:26, 1KI 21:27–21:29; ISA 38:1** parallel 2KI 20:1 **ISA 38:4–38:5** parallel 2KI 20:4–20:6**1430: prophecy, concerning Jesus Christ**See [2366: Jesus Christ, prophecies concerning](#)**1431: prophecy, methods of OT**

Prophets relayed their messages from God in a variety of ways, choosing methods that would make the meaning clear, attract attention or convince the people of the truth of their words.

God speaks through the prophets**HEB 1:1****Prophecy directly proclaimed****JON 3:1–3:4** See also 1KI 13:1–13:3, 1KI 14:6–14:16, 1KI 20:22; ISA 7:13–7:17; JER 26:18; ACT 11:27–11:28; 1CO 14:29**Messages presented as coming from God****2KI 7:1** Prophets often used the phrases “hear the word of the LORD” and “says the LORD” to ensure that their audience understood the divine origin of their proclamation. See also 2KI 20:16–20:18; JER 7:2, JER 30:3, JER 44:26; EZK 34:7–34:10; HOS 4:1; AMO 1:5, AMO 7:16–7:17; ZEP 3:20; HAG 2:9; ZEC 1:3; MAL 1:6**Prophecy enacted****1KI 11:29–11:39** See also 1KI 22:11; JER 19:1–19:13, JER 27:1–27:7, JER 28:10–28:11, JER 43:8–43:13; EZK 4:1–4:17, EZK 5:1–5:3, EZK 12:3–12:11; ZEC 6:9–6:15; ACT 21:10–21:11**Prophecy expressed as an allegory or parable****2SA 12:1–12:12** See also EZK 15:1–15:8, EZK 17:1–17:4, EZK 19:2–19:14, EZK 23:1–23:4, EZK 24:3–24:5; MAT 24:32–24:35 parallels MRK 13:28–13:31, LUK 21:29–21:33**Prophecy given by vision or dream****EZK 11:24–11:25** See also 1KI 22:17; JER 1:11–1:16; EZK 40:1–40:4; AMO 8:1–8:2; ZEC 4:1–4:14**Prophecy recorded in writing****JER 36:1–36:4** See also ISA 30:8; JER 25:13, JER 30:2, JER 36:32, JER 45:1, JER 51:60; EZK 43:10–43:11; DAN 12:4; HAB 2:2; REV 1:3, REV 22:19; 2CH 21:12–21:15; JER 29:1**Prophecy associated with music****1CH 25:1–25:3** See also 1SA 10:5, 1SA 18:10; 2KI 3:15–3:19**1432: prophecy, in NT**

The NT describes the prophetic aspect of the ministry of Jesus Christ, and also recognises that prophetic gifts are given to believers through the Holy Spirit. It provides guidance on how such prophetic gifts are to be used.

Jesus Christ recognised as a prophet

MAT 21:11; ; MRK 6:4, MRK 8:27–8:28; ; LUK 7:16, LUK 24:17–24:19; ; JHN 4:19

Prophecy in the church**Prophecy is one among many spiritual gifts****1CO 12:28–12:29** See also ROM 12:6; 1CO 12:10; EPH 4:11**Not all are called to be prophets**

1CO 12:29; ; EPH 4:11

Prophecy is valueless without love**1CO 13:1–13:2****Prophecy is for the building up of the church****1CO 14:26** See also ROM 12:3–12:6; 1CO 14:3–14:5; 1PE 4:10**Prophecy superior to speaking in tongues****1CO 14:5****Prophecy in the early church**

See also ACT 2:17, ACT 11:27–11:28, ACT 15:32, ACT 21:9

1436: reality

Scripture provides an accurate and reliable guide to the realities of the spiritual and material worlds. It affirms the reality of human sin, of the power and purpose of God to deal with sin through Jesus Christ and of the guidance of the Holy Spirit.

The reality of God**The reality of the existence of God****JOB 42:4–42:5** See also 2SA 7:22–7:23; 1KI 8:23; JER 10:10**The reality of the love of God****1JN 4:7–4:9** See also JHN 3:16; ROM 5:8; GAL 2:20–2:21**The reality of God's salvation****PSA 68:20** See also PSA 65:5, PSA 79:9; MIC 7:7; LUK 1:47; TIT 2:11

The reality of the revelation of God

PSA 19:1–19:4; ; JHN 1:1–1:9; ; ACT 14:15–14:17; ; ROM 1:18–1:20

The reality of knowing God

JHN 17:3; ; ROM 1:19; ; GAL 4:8–4:9; ; 1JN 5:20

The reality of the word of God

PSA 119:160 See also PSA 18:30; 2TI 3:16; HEB 4:12; 1PE 1:23

The reality of sin

1JN 1:8–1:10 See also PSA 58:3; ISA 59:1–59:2; JER 17:9; ROM 5:12

The reality of Jesus Christ**The reality of his existence**

1JN 1:1–1:3

His reality foreshadowed in the past

COL 2:17; ; HEB 8:5; HEB 10:1–10:5

The reality of his divinity

JHN 1:1–1:2; ; ROM 1:3–1:4; ; COL 1:15; COL 2:9

The reality of his humanity

MAT 4:2; ; MRK 6:3; ; JHN 8:40; JHN 19:28; ; ACT 2:22

The reality of his resurrection

MAT 28:1–28:10 parallels MRK 16:1–16:8, LUK 24:1–24:18; ; ACT 1:1–1:3, ACT 10:39–10:43; ; 1CO 15:3–15:8

The reality of the guidance of the Holy Spirit

JHN 14:16–14:17, JHN 14:26, JHN 15:26, JHN 16:7–16:11

1439: revelation

The making known of God's person, nature and deeds, in Scripture, history and supremely the person of Jesus Christ. God is also made known, to a limited yet important extent, through his creation.

1440: revelation, through creation

The creation bears witness to the wisdom and power of its creator. This natural knowledge of God is limited in its extent, but is sufficient to convince human beings of the existence of God and the need to respond to him.

The creation bears witness to its creator

PSA 19:1–19:6 See also JOB 36:22–37:18; AMO 4:13; ACT 14:15–14:17

All human beings have a natural awareness of God

ROM 2:14–2:15 See also ACT 17:22–17:31

The limitations of a natural knowledge of God

ROM 1:18–1:21 See also ROM 1:32; 1CO 1:20–1:21

1441: revelation, necessity of

Finiteness and sin make it impossible to gain adequate knowledge of God through human effort alone. God in mercy makes himself known through the incarnation of the Son and the illumination of human minds to understand him.

The impossibility of fully knowing God without revelation**God is beyond unaided human knowing**

JHN 1:18 See also EXO 33:20; ISA 55:8–55:9; JHN 6:46; 1JN 4:12

The human mind is limited

JOB 11:7 See also JOB 9:4, JOB 9:10, JOB 23:3–23:9, JOB 26:14, JOB 36:26, JOB 37:5, JOB 37:23; PSA 139:6, PSA 145:3; ECC 3:11; ISA 40:13–40:14, ISA 40:28; ROM 11:33

The human mind cannot discern God of its own accord

2CO 4:4 See also JHN 1:5; ROM 1:18–1:32; 1CO 1:21, 1CO 2:14; 2CO 3:14; EPH 4:17–4:18

God is known fully only through Jesus Christ

HEB 1:1–1:2; 1JN 5:20 See also JHN 1:14–1:18, JHN 17:3; COL 1:15–1:20

1442: revelation, of God

See [1403: God, revelation of](#)

1443: revelation, in OT

The OT bears witness to God's revelation in the history of Israel and in the inspired testimony of the prophets and other writers of the period. This knowledge of God prepares the way for the full disclosure of God in Jesus Christ in the NT.

Revelation in Eden and before the flood

GEN 1:3, GEN 2:16–2:18 See also GEN 1:29–1:30, GEN 3:9–3:19, GEN 4:6–4:7, GEN 4:9–4:15, GEN 6:13–6:22

The covenant framework of OT revelation after the flood**God's covenant with Noah**

GEN 9:8–9:11 This covenant covers all living creatures. See also GEN 6:18, GEN 9:12–9:17

God's covenant with Abraham

GEN 17:7 See also GEN 15:9–15:21, GEN 17:2, GEN 17:4, GEN 17:10–17:14, GEN 22:16–22:18; EXO 6:2–6:6; 1CH 16:14–16:18; PSA 105:8–105:9

God's covenant with Moses at Sinai

EXO 34:27 See also EXO 24:3–24:8, EXO 34:10–34:14; DEU 5:2–5:4 Mount Sinai was also known as Mount Horeb; JER 11:2–11:5

God's covenant with David

PSA 89:3–89:4 See also 2SA 7:8–7:16; PSA 132:11–132:12

The promise of a new covenant

JER 31:31–31:34 See also ISA 42:6; MAT 26:27–26:28 parallels MRK 14:24, LUK 22:20, 1CO 11:25; HEB 8:8–8:12, HEB 9:15, HEB 10:15–10:18

The recipients of OT revelation

The people of Israel

AMO 3:2 See also EXO 19:3–19:6; DEU 7:6; ISA 65:1; EZK 20:5

On occasions God spoke to people outside the covenant community

DAN 2:27–2:28 See also GEN 41:25, GEN 41:28–41:32; DAN 4:1–4:37, DAN 5:17–5:28

Methods of OT revelation

Direct communication

DEU 18:18 See also EXO 4:12; NUM 12:8, NUM 23:5; ISA 50:4, ISA 51:16; JER 1:9

Visions and dreams

NUM 12:6 See also GEN 15:1, GEN 28:12, GEN 37:5–37:7, GEN 37:9, GEN 46:2; NUM 24:4; DEU 13:1; JDG 7:13–7:14; JOB 33:14–33:15; EZK 1:1, EZK 1:26–1:28

Visible manifestations (theophanies)

GEN 18:1 See also GEN 32:24–32:30; EXO 3:1–3:6, EXO 34:4–34:7; NUM 11:25, NUM 12:5, NUM 14:10–14:12; JOS 5:13–5:15

Scripture

DEU 31:9 See also EXO 17:14; NUM 33:2; ISA 30:8; JER 36:2, JER 51:60

The content of OT revelation

Revelation of God's will and purposes

GEN 17:1–17:2 See also GEN 12:1–12:3, GEN 15:1–15:5; EXO 19:5–19:6, EXO 20:1–20:17 parallel DEU 5:6–5:21; EXO 22:31; LEV 11:44–11:45, LEV 19:1–19:2, LEV 20:7–20:8

Revelation of God's plan

GEN 3:15 See also ISA 9:6–9:7, ISA 11:1–11:10, ISA 42:1; MIC 5:1–5:5; ZEC 9:9–9:13

Revelation of God's character and being

EXO 3:11–3:15 EXO 40:34; ; 1KI 8:11; ; EZK 1:28; NUM 14:17–14:19; ; PSA 143:1; DEU 7:7–7:8; ; LAM 3:22; PSA 72:2, PSA 103:6; ; ISA 59:17; PSA 115:3, PSA 135:5–135:6

The incompleteness of OT revelation

HEB 11:39–11:40 The fulness of God's redemption could only become apparent with the fulness of his revelation in Jesus Christ. See also HEB 1:1–1:2; 1PE 1:10–1:12

1444: revelation, in NT

The NT fulfils and completes the revelation of God which began in the OT. Jesus Christ is the central focus of this self-revelation of God.

The unity and progress of revelation

The unity of OT and NT

MAT 5:17–5:18 See also ROM 3:21–3:22; 2TI 3:14–3:15; 2PE 3:15–3:16 The writings of Paul are presented as having equal status with the OT Scriptures; REV 22:18–22:19 These sanctions have the same force as those of Dt 4:2; 12:32.

The progress of NT revelation

HEB 1:1–1:2 See also HEB 2:1–2:4, HEB 12:22–12:27

The NT fulfils and completes God's revelation of himself

Jesus Christ is the supreme revelation of God

COL 1:25–1:27 See also JHN 1:9–1:18, JHN 14:6; ACT 4:12; GAL 4:4; PHP 2:6–2:8; HEB 2:14

Jesus Christ is the image of God

2CO 4:4; COL 1:15

Jesus Christ has the nature of God

PHP 2:6

Jesus Christ is the exact representation of God

HEB 1:3

Jesus Christ is the incarnate Word of God

JHN 1:14

The role of the Holy Spirit in revelation

He is the divine agent of revelation

JHN 16:12–16:15 See also JHN 14:16–14:17, JHN 15:26; 1JN 4:6, 1JN 5:6; REV 2:7, REV 2:11, REV 2:17, REV 2:29, REV 3:6, REV 3:13, REV 3:22

He is the source of revelatory manifestations

1CO 12:7–12:11 See also ACT 2:1–2:12; ROM 12:6; 1CO 12:28–12:30, 1CO 13:8–13:12, 1CO 14:1–14:33; EPH 4:11

God's purposes in revelation

To reveal himself in Jesus Christ

COL 1:15–1:20 See also JHN 1:14, JHN 12:44–12:45, JHN 14:9; 2CO 4:4; HEB 1:3

To reveal his plan through Jesus Christ

EPH 1:9–1:10 See also ROM 16:25–16:27; 1CO 2:7–2:10; EPH 3:3–3:11; COL 1:19–1:20

1445: revelation, responses to

God requires and imparts a frame of mind that receives and responds to what he has made known.

God commands that his word be heeded

MRK 4:3 See also ISA 1:10; MRK 4:9; REV 2:7

People do not naturally understand what God has revealed**They fail to recognise God's revelation in Jesus Christ**

MAT 11:25–11:27 parallel LUK 10:21–10:22 See also JHN 5:37–5:40, JHN 6:44–6:45, JHN 10:24–10:26, JHN 12:37–12:41, JHN 14:9; ROM 9:31–10:4; 1CO 1:18–1:25, 1CO 2:8; 2CO 4:4

They fail to understand God's revelation in general

1CO 2:14 See also MRK 4:11–4:12 parallels MAT 13:13–13:15, LUK 8:10; ISA 6:9–6:10; JHN 8:43–8:47; 2CO 3:14–3:16; 2TH 2:11–2:13

God has given his Spirit to illuminate the human mind**He reveals and teaches truth**

1CO 2:12–2:13 See also JER 31:31–31:34; MAT 16:17; JHN 3:3–3:10, JHN 14:16–14:17, JHN 14:25–14:26, JHN 16:12–16:15; PHP 3:15

He reveals through prayer for understanding

PSA 119:18 See also PSA 119:12, PSA 119:27; EPH 1:17–1:18

Understanding God's revelation carries special responsibility

LUK 12:47–12:48 See also MAT 13:11–13:12, MAT 25:14–25:30 parallel LUK 19:12–19:27

God's revelation of himself will only be fully understood at the second coming of Jesus Christ

1CO 13:12 See also 1PE 1:13; 1JN 3:2

The consequences of responding to revelation**Repentance**

ACT 2:38 See also MAT 4:17; ACT 3:19, ACT 26:20; 2CO 7:10

Faith

ROM 10:17 See also ROM 10:8–10:10, ROM 10:14–10:15; 1CO 2:4–2:5

Obedience

ROM 1:5 See also JDG 2:17; PHM 1:21; 1PE 1:2

1448: signs

Miraculous or supernatural confirmations of the existence and power of God or the miraculous demonstration of spiritual authority on the part of an individual.

1449: signs, purposes of

Signs are given to confirm God's word. They may warn the rebellious or encourage the faithful. People may seek signs as a result of a genuine desire to serve God.

Signs are given to demonstrate God's power

DEU 34:10–34:12 See also DEU 4:34, DEU 6:21–6:22, DEU 7:19, DEU 26:8; 1CH 16:11–16:12 parallel PSA 105:4–105:5; JER 32:21

Signs demonstrate the authority of God's servants**Moses and Aaron**

EXO 4:1–4:9 See also EXO 4:30–4:31, EXO 7:8–7:12; NUM 17:1–17:9; ACT 7:36

Elijah

1KI 18:36–18:38

Elisha

2KI 2:13–2:14

Jesus Christ

ACT 2:22 See also JHN 2:23, JHN 3:2, JHN 7:21, JHN 20:30

The apostles

2CO 12:12 See also ACT 2:43, ACT 5:12, ACT 15:12

Signs may accompany the preaching of the gospel

HEB 2:3–2:4 See also MRK 16:20; ACT 8:6, ACT 14:3

Signs may warn the ungodly of impending judgment

EXO 8:22–8:23 ISA 20:1–20:4; ; EZK 4:1–4:3, EZK 12:3–12:6, EZK 12:11, EZK 24:15–24:24; JER 44:29–44:30; ; LUK 2:34; ; PHP 1:28

Signs may warn God's people against rebellion

NUM 17:10 See also NUM 16:38, NUM 26:10; DEU 28:45–28:46; 1SA 2:34, 1SA 12:16–12:18

Signs may encourage faith**By giving guidance**

1SA 14:8–14:10 See also GEN 24:10–24:14; EXO 13:21–13:22; 2SA 5:23–5:24 parallel 1CH 14:14–14:15; MAT 2:9–2:10

By giving assurance of God's presence

JDG 6:17–6:22 See also GEN 28:10–28:17; EXO 3:1–3:5

By encouraging the fearful and doubting

ISA 38:7–38:8 parallels 2KI 20:8–20:11, 2CH 32:24 See also DEU 7:17–7:19; JDG 6:36–6:40; 2KI 6:15–6:17

Signs need hold no terror for the godly

JER 10:2 See also MAT 24:6 parallels MRK 13:7, LUK 21:9

Seeking signs**When seeking signs is acceptable to God**

ISA 7:11 See also JDG 6:17; ISA 38:22

When seeking signs is condemned by God

MAT 16:1–16:4 parallel MRK 8:11–8:12 See also MAT 12:38–12:39 parallel LUK 11:29; LUK 11:16, LUK 12:54–12:56, LUK 23:8; JHN 2:18, JHN 4:48, JHN 6:30; 1CO 1:22

1450: signs, kinds of

Signs are miraculous events, supernatural phenomena or everyday things that are given a special significance. The term is used in John's Gospel to describe the miracles of Jesus Christ.

Miraculous signs

2CO 12:12 See also EXO 10:1; PSA 78:43, PSA 105:27; MAT 24:24 parallel MRK 13:22; MRK 16:17; ACT 2:43; ROM 15:19

The signs of Jesus Christ in John's Gospel

JHN 2:11 John refers to the miracles of Jesus Christ as "signs" in order to bring out the significance of these deeds. See also JHN 6:26 Jesus Christ, the bread of life; JHN 9:16 Jesus Christ, the light of the world; JHN 11:47 Jesus Christ, the resurrection and the life

Jesus Christ refers to Jonah as a sign

MAT 12:39–12:41 parallel LUK 11:29–11:32

Prophetic signs

EXO 3:12 See also ISA 10:7–10:9; 1KI 13:1–13:5; 2KI 19:29 parallel ISA 37:30; ISA 7:14–7:17, ISA 8:18, ISA 19:19–19:20; LUK 2:12

Signs of protection

EXO 12:13, EXO 12:23; ; JOS 2:12–2:13, JOS 2:17–2:21

Signs given to guarantee promises**The rainbow**

GEN 9:12 See also GEN 9:13–9:17

Circumcision

GEN 17:10–17:11 See also GEN 17:12–17:14; ROM 4:11

Signs serve as reminders of past blessings**Monuments**

JOS 4:4–4:7

Religious observances

Passover: EXO 13:9, EXO 13:16; EXO 31:12–31:17; ; EZK 20:12, EZK 20:20

Signs associated with the birth of Jesus Christ**The virgin birth**

ISA 7:14 See also MAT 1:22–1:23; LUK 1:34–1:36

The birthplace

LUK 2:12 See also LUK 2:7, LUK 2:16

The star

MAT 2:1–2:2 See also MAT 2:9–2:10

Signs associated with the death of Jesus Christ**Darkness at midday**

MAT 27:45 parallels MRK 15:33, LUK 23:44–23:45 See also AMO 8:9

The curtain of the temple torn in two

MAT 27:51 parallels MRK 15:38, LUK 23:45

The dead came back to life

MAT 27:51–27:53

Signs associated with the coming of the Holy Spirit**The sound like a violent wind**

ACT 2:2

Tongues of fire

ACT 2:3

Speaking in other languages

ACT 2:4 See also ACT 2:5–2:11

Signs associated with the second coming of Jesus Christ**General signs**

MAT 24:3–24:8 parallels MRK 13:4–13:8, LUK 21:7–21:11

Signs preceding the second coming

See also MAT 24:9–24:24 parallels MRK 13:9–13:22, LUK 21:12–21:24

Signs simultaneous with the second coming

MAT 24:27–24:31 parallels MRK 13:24–13:27, LUK 21:25–21:27; ; LUK 17:24; ; ACT 2:19–2:20; ; JOL 2:30–2:31; ; 2PE 3:12–3:13

False signs

DEU 13:1–13:3 See also ISA 44:25; MAT 24:24 parallel MRK 13:22; 2TH 2:9; REV 13:11–13:14, REV 16:14, REV 19:20

1454: theophany

A temporary visible manifestation of the presence and glory of God. This may be in natural phenomena

such as cloud or fire, in human form or in prophetic visionary experience.

God is manifested in nature

God's presence in storms, thunder and lightning

PSA 18:7–18:15; EXO 19:16 See also EXO 20:18; JOB 37:5; PSA 29:3–29:9, PSA 77:18, PSA 97:4; ISA 30:27–30:33; AMO 1:2; HAB 3:11; ZEC 9:14; REV 11:19

God's presence in volcanic phenomena

EXO 19:18 See also ISA 30:33

God's presence in earthquakes

ISA 29:5–29:6 See also JDG 5:4–5:5; PSA 77:18; HAB 3:6

Specific phenomena associated with the presence of God

Fire signifies God's presence

EXO 3:2 Fire in particular represents the purity, holiness and unapproachability of God. See also EXO 13:21, EXO 19:18, EXO 24:17; LEV 9:24; NUM 14:14; DEU 4:11–4:12, DEU 5:4, DEU 5:22–5:26; JDG 13:20–13:22; PSA 97:3; JOL 2:30

Smoke signifies God's presence

EXO 19:18 See also EXO 20:18; PSA 144:5; ISA 6:4, ISA 30:27; JOL 2:30; REV 15:8

Cloud signifies God's presence

EXO 16:10 Cloud and smoke convey the mystery and transcendence of God. See also EXO 13:21, EXO 19:9, EXO 24:15–24:16, EXO 33:9, EXO 34:5; DEU 31:15, LEV 16:2; NUM 9:15–9:22, NUM 14:14; 1KI 8:10–8:11; EZK 1:4, EZK 10:3–10:4, MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:34–9:35, REV 14:14–14:16

God is manifested in human or angelic form

GEN 16:7–16:13 See also GEN 18:1–18:22, GEN 32:24–32:30; JOS 5:13–5:15

God appears in prophetic visions

God appears on a throne

ISA 6:1 John interprets this verse to refer to Jesus Christ (Jn 12:41). See also EZK 1:26, EZK 10:1; DAN 7:9; REV 4:2, REV 20:11

God appears attended by angels and other heavenly beings

ISA 6:2; ; EZK 1:5–1:18, EZK 10:9–10:13; ; REV 4:6–4:11

God appears like, or with, precious stones

EXO 24:10; ; EZK 1:26; ; REV 4:3

Functions and effects of theophanies

Theophanies reveal God's glory

EZK 10:4 See also EXO 16:10, EXO 24:16, EXO 40:34–40:35; LEV 9:23–9:24; NUM 14:10; 1KI 8:11; 2CH 7:1–7:3; PSA 29:3, PSA 29:9, PSA 97:2–97:6; EZK 11:22–11:23

Theophanies bring judgment

ISA 30:27 See also NUM 12:9–12:10; PSA 18:13–18:15

Theophanies arouse the fear of God

EXO 19:16, EXO 20:18–20:20; ; ISA 6:5

Theophanies commission God's servants

ISA 6:8; ; EZK 1:28–2:1

Theophanies authenticate God's servants

NUM 12:5–12:8

1457: trance

An ecstatic state in which people may be aware of God communicating with them; it may cause them to lose control of their actions or to have abnormal strength.

God communicating with people through a trance

Ezekiel

EZK 8:1–8:3

Peter

ACT 10:9–10:23, ACT 11:4–11:18

Paul

ACT 22:17–22:21

John

REV 1:10–1:13, REV 4:2, REV 17:3, REV 21:10

Examples of the Holy Spirit's domination of individuals in a trance-like manner

Balaam

NUM 24:2–24:3, NUM 24:12–24:13

King Saul and his men pursuing David

1SA 19:19–19:24

Under the influence of the Holy Spirit people may act with abnormal strength

Samson

JDG 14:6, JDG 14:19, JDG 15:14

Elijah

1KI 18:46

1460: truth

Truth in Scripture is more than mere veracity. In the OT it is a moral concept, grounded in the being of

God himself, which embodies the ideas of faithfulness and reliability, while in the NT the concept widens to embrace the ideas of reality and completeness.

1461: truth, nature of

God is the essence of truth and this quality should be reflected in the character of his children. Falsehood is condemned in Scripture, particularly in legal contexts, but truth is praised and advocated. God takes pleasure in truth and honesty, which are marks of an upright person.

Truth originates with God

PSA 43:3 See also PSA 25:5, PSA 26:3, PSA 86:11; ISA 65:16; DAN 9:13

Truth is an aspect of God's character

It is demonstrated in his faithfulness and reliability

NUM 23:19; PSA 33:4 See also ISA 15:29; PSA 31:5, PSA 40:10–40:11, PSA 119:160; ISA 45:19; JER 10:10, JER 42:5; DAN 10:21; MIC 7:20

It is demonstrated in his justice and mercy

PSA 96:13 The Hebraic concept of truth embraces the ideas of faithfulness, reliability and justice. See also PSA 119:30, PSA 119:43–119:44, PSA 119:142, PSA 119:151

Truth should be reflected in the character of God's people

ZEC 8:16 See also 1KI 17:22–17:24; PSA 15:1–15:5, PSA 51:6, PSA 145:18; PRO 23:23; JER 4:2, JER 5:1; ZEC 7:9, ZEC 8:3, ZEC 8:19; MAL 2:6

Absence of truth in the human character displeases God

ISA 59:14–59:15 See also ISA 48:1; JER 5:3, JER 7:28, JER 9:3

Truth as an abstract quality

PSA 45:4 See also PRO 23:23; DAN 8:12

Truth is the opposite of falsehood

PRO 16:13 See also 1KI 17:24, 1KI 22:16 parallel 2CH 18:15; NEH 6:6; PRO 8:7, PRO 12:17; ISA 45:19; ZEC 8:16

Truth is subject to proof

GEN 42:14–42:16 See also DEU 13:12–13:15, DEU 17:2–17:5, DEU 19:16–19:19, DEU 22:20–22:21; 1KI 10:6–10:7 parallel 2CH 9:5–9:6; JOB 5:27

Truth is commended in Scripture

PRO 12:22 See also EXO 20:16 parallel DEU 5:20; EXO 23:1, EXO 23:7; PRO 12:19, PRO 13:5, PRO 14:25, PRO 19:5, PRO 19:9; EPH 4:25; REV 22:14–22:15

Lack of truth is a characteristic of apostasy

JER 7:28 See also PSA 52:1–52:4; ISA 59:12–59:15; JER 9:5–9:6; AMO 5:10

Truth as an expression of affirmation

DAN 11:2 See also JOS 7:20; RUT 3:12; 2KI 19:17; JER 26:15; MAT 5:18, MAT 8:10, MAT 21:21; MRK 8:12, MRK 14:30; LUK 4:24, LUK 21:32; JHN 3:3, JHN 8:51, JHN 21:18

Amen as a liturgical affirmation of truth

Of oaths and curses

NUM 5:22 The word “amen” is closely related to the word for “truth” in Hebrew. It constitutes an affirmation of the truth of what has been said and an acceptance of its consequences. See also DEU 27:15–27:26; NEH 5:13; JER 11:5

Of benedictions and doxologies

1CH 16:36 See also NEH 8:6; PSA 41:13, PSA 72:19, PSA 89:52, PSA 106:48

In general use

JER 28:6 See also 1KI 1:32–1:37

In the NT

ROM 1:25 By NT times, the word “Amen” had become a common liturgical phrase of affirmation, used after prayers, benedictions and doxologies. See also MAT 6:13; ROM 9:5, ROM 11:36; 1CO 14:16; 2CO 1:20; GAL 6:18; PHP 4:20; 1TI 1:17; HEB 13:20–13:21; 2PE 3:18; JUD 1:25; REV 1:6–1:7, REV 7:12, REV 22:20

1462: truth, in NT

The NT encompasses the Greek idea of truth as reality, as well as the Hebraic concepts of faithfulness and reliability. Jesus Christ is shown as “the Truth” and the apostles present the gospel as “truth”.

Truth as opposed to falsehood and lies

EPH 4:25 See also JHN 3:33, JHN 4:37, JHN 18:23, JHN 19:35; ACT 7:1, ACT 21:24, ACT 24:8, ACT 26:25; ROM 1:18, ROM 9:1; 1CO 15:54; 2CO 7:14; GAL 4:16; TIT 1:13; 2PE 2:22; 1JN 2:4; 2JN 1:1–1:2

Truth as reality

HEB 9:24 See also JHN 1:9, JHN 4:23, JHN 17:3; EPH 4:24; 1TH 1:9; 1TI 1:2, 1TI 6:19; TIT 1:2, TIT 3:2; HEB 8:2, HEB 12:8; 1PE 5:12; 1JN 2:5, 1JN 2:8, 1JN 5:20; REV 19:9

Truth as trustworthy affirmations

JHN 6:47 See also MAT 6:2, MAT 10:23, MAT 16:28, MAT 19:23, MAT 23:36, MAT 26:13; MRK 9:41, MRK 11:23; LUK 12:44, LUK 21:3; JHN 1:51, JHN 5:24–5:25, JHN 8:34, JHN 10:7, JHN 16:7; PHP 1:15; 1TI 3:9

Truth as faithfulness and reliability

The quality of truth

PHP 4:8 See also JHN 1:17, JHN 3:21, JHN 4:24, JHN 17:17; ROM 2:20; 1CO 5:8, 1CO 13:6; 2CO 13:8; EPH 5:9, EPH 6:14; 3JN 1:12

Truth as an aspect of the character of God

ROM 3:3–3:4 See also PSA 51:4; ROM 3:7, ROM 15:8; 1JN 5:20; REV 3:7, REV 3:14, REV 6:10, REV 15:3, REV 16:7, REV 19:2, REV 19:11

Truth as a human quality

ACT 11:23; 1JN 1:8 See also JHN 3:21, JHN 7:18; ACT 14:22; EPH 4:15; PHP 1:18; REV 2:13

Jesus Christ as truth

JHN 14:6 See also JHN 1:14, JHN 15:1, JHN 18:37–18:38; 1JN 5:20

The Spirit of God as truth

JHN 16:13 See also JHN 14:16–14:17, JHN 15:26; 1JN 4:6, 1JN 5:6

The gospel and the Christian faith as truth

EPH 1:13 See also JHN 8:31–8:32; ACT 20:30; 2CO 4:2; GAL 2:5; COL 1:5; 1TI 2:3–2:4, 1TI 4:6; 2TI 2:18, 2TI 4:4; TIT 1:1; JAS 5:19; 2PE 2:2; 1JN 3:19

1463: truth, of God

See [1150: God, truth of](#)

1466: vision

Scripture uses the term to refer to both the physical act of seeing, and also the gift of spiritual insight. All things, physical and spiritual, are seen by God.

God's vision

God views all life on earth

2CH 16:9; PSA 11:4 See also GEN 6:11; EXO 3:9; PSA 31:22, PSA 34:15, PSA 139:16; ZEC 4:10

God sees the hearts and thoughts of people

GEN 6:5 See also 1SA 2:3; PSA 139:1–139:4, PSA 139:23–139:24; PRO 15:11; JER 20:12; MAT 6:8, MAT 6:18; LUK 16:15; HEB 4:13; 1JN 3:20

The physical vision of human beings

It is given and can be taken by God

EXO 4:11; PSA 146:8 See also LEV 26:16; PRO 29:13; ACT 9:8–9:9 parallel ACT 22:11

Jesus Christ restores the sight of the blind

LUK 4:18 See also MAT 9:30; JHN 9:7; ACT 9:17–9:18 parallel ACT 22:13

Physical sight diminishes with age

GEN 27:1, GEN 48:10; ; 1SA 3:2, 1SA 4:15; ; 1KI 14:4; ; ECC 12:3 Ecc 12:2–5 is an allegory on ageing. It gives a graphic description of a person's progressive deterioration.

Physical vision has its dangers

It can create fear

JOB 41:9; ; JOL 2:6; ; MAT 28:3–28:4 parallels MRK 16:5, LUK 24:4–24:5; ; REV 1:17

It gives rise to temptation

1JN 2:16 See also GEN 3:6; JOS 7:21; 2SA 11:2–11:4; JOB 31:1; PSA 119:37; MAT 5:28–5:29

Christians are to live by faith rather than by sight

HEB 11:1 See also ROM 8:24; 2CO 4:18, 2CO 5:7; HEB 11:27

Visions of God

Examples of those who saw God

GEN 32:30; ; EXO 33:18–33:23; ; JOB 42:5; ; ISA 6:1, ISA 6:5; ; REV 1:12–1:18

God's people will see him

MAT 5:8; 1JN 3:2 See also PSA 17:15; JHN 17:24; 1CO 13:12; REV 22:4

Spiritual vision

Seeing used metaphorically for spiritual insight

2KI 6:17 See also PRO 29:18; ISA 22:1 Jerusalem was called “the Valley of Vision”, possibly ironically, for although God spoke through his prophets and dwelt there, its inhabitants lacked insight; ISA 29:10; MRK 8:17–8:21; LUK 24:31; JHN 9:39; ACT 26:17–26:18

Spiritual insight given in dreams or visions

ACT 2:17 See also JOL 2:28; GEN 15:1; NUM 12:6; DAN 1:17, DAN 2:19, DAN 4:5, DAN 7:1 Daniel's dream of four beasts; DAN 8:1, DAN 10:7–10:8 Daniel's vision of a man; ACT 9:12, ACT 10:9–10:17 parallel ACT 11:4–11:10 Peter's vision; ACT 16:9–16:10 Paul's vision of the man of Macedonia; ACT 26:19; 2CO 12:1

The OT prophets had visions from God

1SA 3:15; ; ISA 1:1; ; JER 24:1; ; EZK 1:1, EZK 8:3–8:4, EZK 11:24, EZK 40:2–40:3; ; HOS 12:10; ; OBA 1:1; ; NAM 1:1

False prophets in the OT lacked true vision

JER 14:14, JER 23:16; ; LAM 2:14; ; EZK 7:26, EZK 13:1–13:12

1469: visions

Mental pictures used by God to convey messages or reveal future events. They are normally received in private by individuals who are often prophets.

God speaks to individuals in visions

GEN 46:2–46:4 See also GEN 15:1; ISA 3:10–3:15; ACT 9:10–9:12, ACT 10:3–10:6, ACT 11:5–11:12, ACT 16:9–16:10, ACT 18:9–18:10, ACT 26:12–26:19

Visions may reveal future events

DAN 8:17–8:19 See also DAN 7:15–7:18, DAN 7:23–7:27; AMO 7:7–7:9; LUK 1:11–1:22; REV 22:6

Visions may contain unusual or startling images

ZEC 1:8 See also EZK 1:4–1:28; DAN 4:10–4:17, DAN 7:2–7:15, DAN 8:2–8:14; REV 1:12–1:16, REV 4:1–4:11, REV 9:17

Visions received by prophets

NUM 12:6 See also ISA 6:1–6:4; JER 1:11–1:16; EZK 1:1; HOS 12:10; AMO 7:1–7:9

Visions recorded by prophets

2CH 32:32 See also 2CH 9:29; ISA 1:1; DAN 7:1, DAN 8:1; OBA 1:1; MIC 1:1; NAM 1:1

False visions associated with lying prophets

EZK 13:6–13:9 See also 1KI 22:10–22:28 parallel 2CH 18:9–18:27; JER 14:14, JER 23:16; LAM 2:14; EZK 22:28; ZEC 10:2

God may withhold visions

ISA 3:1 See also LAM 2:9; EZK 7:26; MIC 3:6

Visions associated with the outpouring of the Holy Spirit

ACT 2:17 See also JOL 2:28

1500: God, the Trinity

- 1510: Trinity, the

1510: Trinity, the

The characteristically Christian doctrine about God. It declares that there is only one true God; that this God is three persons, the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit, each of whom is distinct from, yet interrelated with, the others; and that all three persons are fully, equally and eternally divine.

1511: Trinity, relationships between the persons

The actual term “the Trinity” is not found in Scripture, but the truths implied in a trinitarian understanding of God are clearly set out. The OT hints at a plurality of persons in the Godhead. The NT affirms that the Son and the Holy Spirit are divine.

There is only one God

DEU 6:4 See also ISA 43:10–43:11, ISA 44:8; 1TI 1:17, 1TI 2:5; JAS 2:19

OT indications of plurality in the Godhead**God refers to himself in the plural**

GEN 1:26 See also GEN 3:22, GEN 11:7; ISA 6:8

The angel of the LORD

GEN 16:11–16:13 The “angel of the LORD” is identified with, yet distinct from, God. See also GEN 18:1–18:33; EXO 3:2–3:6; JDG 13:3–13:22

The word of God

The word of the LORD“ or wisdom of God“ is personified and identified with, yet distinct from, God: PSA 33:4; ; PRO 8:22–8:31

The Spirit of God

The Spirit of God is God’s personal agent: GEN 1:2; ; NEH 9:20; ; JOB 33:4; ; ISA 40:13

The Messiah

The Messiah’s divine nature is emphasised: PSA 110:1; ; ISA 9:6; ; JER 23:5–23:6

Interchangeable expressions

Word, Spirit (or breath) and LORD are used interchangeably for God: PSA 33:6; ; ISA 48:16, ISA 61:1

NT trinitarian references

MAT 28:19 The unity of the three persons is reflected in the singular name. See also 2CO 13:14; EPH 4:4–4:6; REV 1:4–1:5

The unity of the three persons**The Son is fully united with the Father**

JHN 10:30 See also MRK 9:37 parallel LUK 9:48; LUK 10:16; JHN 10:38, JHN 12:44–12:45, JHN 13:20, JHN 14:7, JHN 14:9–14:11, JHN 15:23

The Spirit is identified with God

2SA 23:2–23:3 See also PSA 51:11; MAT 28:19; 1CO 3:16

The three persons are distinct from one another**Jesus Christ addresses the Father directly**

MAT 11:25–11:26 parallel LUK 10:21; ; MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42; ; MAT 26:42, MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34; ; LUK 23:46; ; JHN 11:41–11:42, JHN 17:1

The Father speaks to the Son from heaven

MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11, LUK 3:22; ; MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:35; ; JHN 12:27–12:28

The Spirit speaks to the Father on behalf of believers

ROM 8:26–8:27

Other examples of the difference between the persons

MAT 12:32, MAT 24:36; ; JHN 7:39, JHN 16:7; ; 1TI 2:5; ; 1JN 2:1

The relationship between the Father and the Son

Jesus Christ is God's unique Son

JHN 1:14 The Greek word for "One and Only", traditionally rendered "only begotten", is actually used to signify "the only one of its kind"; "unique". See also JHN 1:18, JHN 3:16, JHN 3:18; ACT 13:33; HEB 1:5; PSA 2:7; 1JN 4:9

The relationship of Father and Son is unique

MAT 11:27 parallel LUK 10:22 See also JHN 6:46, JHN 7:28-7:29, JHN 8:55, JHN 10:15, JHN 17:25

The Father loves the Son

JHN 3:35 See also JHN 5:20, JHN 10:17, JHN 15:9, JHN 17:24

The Father shares his divine life with the Son

COL 2:9 See also JHN 5:26, JHN 6:57; COL 1:19

The Father delegates his authority to the Son

JHN 5:27 See also MAT 28:18; JHN 3:35, JHN 5:21-5:22, JHN 16:15; REV 2:26-2:27

Father and Son indwell each other

JHN 14:10-14:11 See also JHN 10:38, JHN 14:20, JHN 17:21-17:23

The relationship between the Holy Spirit and the other two persons

The Spirit is the Spirit of God" and the Spirit of Christ"

ROM 8:9 PSA 106:33; ; 1CO 2:14; ; PHP 3:3; ; 1JN 4:2; ACT 16:7; ; GAL 4:6; ; PHP 1:19; ; 1PE 1:11

The Spirit's unique relationship with God

MAT 10:20 See also 1CO 2:10-2:11

The Spirit's unique relationship with the Son

JHN 1:33 See also ISA 61:1; JHN 14:16-14:17, JHN 14:26; ACT 10:38

1512: Trinity, equality of the persons

The Son and the Holy Spirit are equal to God the Father in eternity, nature and status. Within the Trinity the Father is head, first among equals; the Son and the Holy Spirit do the Father's will, glorifying him and making him known; and the Holy Spirit glorifies and makes known the Son.

The Son is equal with the Father

JHN 5:18 See also JHN 5:23, JHN 8:16, JHN 14:9, JHN 17:10; PHP 2:6; COL 2:9 **ROM 1:7** The equality of the Son

and the Father is often implied in the opening greetings of the NT letters. See also 1CO 1:3; GAL 1:3; EPH 1:2; 1TH 1:1; 1TI 1:2; PHM 1:3; 2PE 1:2 **REV 5:13** Doxologies are addressed to the Father and the Son equally or just to the Son. See also ROM 9:5; HEB 13:21; 2PE 3:18; REV 7:10

The Holy Spirit is equal with the Father and the Son

2CO 13:14 See also MAT 28:19; 1PE 1:2; REV 1:4-1:5

The obedience of the Son to the Father

The Son submits to the Father in his incarnation

PHP 2:6-2:7 See also MAT 24:36; JHN 4:34, JHN 6:38, JHN 14:28, JHN 14:31; ROM 5:19; HEB 5:8, HEB 10:5-10:7; PSA 40:6-40:8

The Father is Jesus Christ's "head"

1CO 11:3 See also 1CO 3:23, 1CO 8:6, 1CO 15:27-15:28

Equality and mutuality as the three persons glorify one another

The Son glorifies the Father

ROM 16:27 See also JHN 14:13; EPH 1:5-1:6, EPH 3:21; PHP 2:11; COL 3:17; 1PE 4:11; JUD 1:25

The Father and the Son glorify one another

JHN 17:1 In John's Gospel, the "glory" of Jesus Christ is seen above all in the cross. See also JHN 8:54, JHN 13:31-13:32, JHN 17:4-17:5, JHN 17:24; ACT 3:13

The Spirit glorifies the Father and the Son

JHN 16:13-16:15 See also JHN 14:26, JHN 15:26; EPH 1:13-1:14

1513: Trinity, mission of the persons

All three persons of the Trinity co-operate in God's work of salvation. For this purpose, the Father sends the Son and the Holy Spirit to redeem his people on earth and to live in and among them.

The Son and the Holy Spirit do God's work on earth

In the OT, the LORD alone is Saviour

ISA 43:11 See also PSA 19:14, PSA 78:35; ISA 43:3, ISA 49:26, ISA 60:16; JER 14:8; HOS 13:4

In the NT, the Son is the Saviour

MAT 1:21 See also LUK 2:11; JHN 4:42; GAL 3:13, GAL 4:5; TIT 2:13, TIT 3:6

In the OT, the LORD lives among his people

EXO 29:45 See also PSA 135:21; ISA 57:15; EZK 43:7; JOL 3:17; ZEC 2:10-2:11

In the NT, the Spirit lives in the church

1CO 3:16 See also JHN 14:17; ROM 8:9, ROM 8:11; 2TI 1:14

Father and Son in the mission of Jesus Christ

The Father sends the Son

GAL 4:4 See also MAT 10:40; MRK 12:6; JHN 3:16–3:17, JHN 7:28, JHN 8:42; 1JN 4:9

The Son reveals the Father

JHN 8:38 See also JHN 1:18, JHN 15:15, JHN 17:6, JHN 17:26; COL 1:15; HEB 1:3

The Son does the Father's work

JHN 5:19 See also JHN 4:34, JHN 5:17, JHN 9:3–9:4, JHN 10:37, JHN 14:10

The Son speaks the Father's words

JHN 12:49–12:50 See also JHN 3:34, JHN 8:28, JHN 14:24, JHN 17:8

The Father testifies to the Son

JHN 5:37 This refers to God's testimony to his Son in the OT Scriptures. See also JHN 5:32, JHN 8:18; 1JN 5:9

The sending of the Holy Spirit

The Father gives the Spirit

LUK 11:13 See also ACT 5:32; 2CO 5:5; GAL 3:5; EPH 1:17; 1JN 4:13

The Son gives the Spirit

JHN 16:7 See also MAT 3:11 parallels MRK 1:8, LUK 3:16; JHN 1:33, JHN 20:22

The Father sends the Spirit through Jesus Christ

JHN 14:16–14:17 The varied terminology about who sends the Spirit reflects the close co-operation between and the shared activity of the three persons. See also JHN 14:26, JHN 15:26; ACT 2:33

The three persons share the work of salvation

The incarnation

LUK 1:35

Jesus Christ's baptism

MAT 3:16–3:17 parallels MRK 1:10–1:11, LUK 3:21–3:22

Jesus Christ's ministry

ACT 10:38 See also LUK 10:21; JHN 3:34

The work of redemption

1PE 1:2 See also 2CO 1:21–1:22; GAL 4:4–4:6; EPH 1:3–1:14, EPH 2:18; 2TH 2:13–2:14; TIT 3:4–3:6

Commissioning the disciples

JHN 20:21–20:22 See also ACT 1:7–1:8

Jesus Christ's exaltation

ACT 7:55 See also ACT 5:31–5:32

Proclaiming the gospel

ACT 2:38–2:39

Building the church

EPH 2:22 See also 1CO 12:4–12:6

1600: Scripture as the word of God

- 1610: Scripture
- 1620: beatitudes, the
- 1630: Book of the Covenant
- 1640: Book of the Law
- 1650: numbers, significance of
- 1660: Sermon on the Mount
- 1670: symbols
- 1680: types
- 1690: word of God

1610: Scripture

The biblical writings, inspired by the Holy Spirit, have been entrusted to the church to remind it of the central teachings of the gospel, to guard it from error and to enable it to grow into holiness. The church is required to be obedient to Scripture and revere it as the Word of God.

1611: Scripture, inspiration and authority of

Those writings that are acknowledged to be the word of God to be revered as issuing from him and as having his authority.

Recognition of a body of sacred writings

In the OT

NEH 8:1 See also EXO 24:7; JOS 8:34; 2KI 22:8 parallel 2CH 34:14; 2KI 23:2 parallel 2CH 34:30; 2CH 35:12; EZR 6:18; NEH 8:8, NEH 9:3, NEH 13:1

By Jesus Christ

MAT 22:29 See also LUK 4:21, LUK 24:27, LUK 24:45 **MAT 21:13** parallel LUK 19:46 Jesus Christ frequently appealed to the OT as a recognised sacred corpus, with the expression “it is written”. See also ISA 56:7; JER 7:11; MAT 4:4 parallel LUK 4:4; DEU 8:3; MAT 4:7 parallel LUK 4:12; DEU 6:16; MAT 4:10 parallel LUK 4:8; DEU 6:13; MAT 21:42 parallel MRK 12:10; PSA 118:22–118:23; MAT 26:31 parallel MRK 14:27; ZEC 13:7; MRK 7:6–7:7; ISA 29:13; LUK 7:27; MAL 3:1; JHN 7:38

By the apostles

2TI 3:14–3:15 See also ACT 1:15–1:17; ROM 1:1–1:2, ROM 15:4; 1CO 15:3–15:4; 2TI 3:16–3:17

By the early church

ACT 17:11

The inspiration of Scripture

2TI 3:16 See also 2KI 17:13–17:14; NEH 9:30; MAT 22:43–22:44 parallel MRK 12:36; 1CO 2:13; HEB 1:1–1:2; 1PE 1:10–1:11; 2PE 1:20–1:21

The authority of Scripture recognised in the OT

PSA 119:89; JOS 23:6 See also JOS 1:8; 2KI 22:11; EZR 10:1–10:4, EZR 10:9–10:12; NEH 13:1–13:3; ISA 40:8

The authority of Scripture recognised in the NT

JHN 10:34–10:36 See also MAT 5:17–5:19; LUK 21:21–21:23, LUK 16:17; 1TH 2:13

Jesus Christ claims scriptural authority for his own words

MAT 24:34–24:35 parallel MRK 13:30–13:31 See also JHN 12:47–12:50, JHN 14:10, JHN 14:23–14:24

1612: Scripture, and Holy Spirit

See [3236: Holy Spirit, and Scripture](#)

1613: Scripture, purpose of

Scripture has been given by God to lead people to faith and salvation. Through Scripture believers are nurtured in faith and led to spiritual maturity.

Scripture is intended to lead people to salvation

2TI 3:14–3:15 See also PSA 19:7–19:11; JHN 20:30–20:31; ROM 10:8

Scripture is intended to lead believers to maturity in faith**By its teaching**

2TI 3:16 See also DEU 6:6–6:9; PSA 19:7–19:8, PSA 119:9, PSA 119:130; COL 3:16

By its rebuke and correction

2TI 3:16 See also PSA 19:11–19:13; 1CO 10:11–10:12; HEB 4:12–4:13

By training in righteousness

2TI 3:16 See also DEU 29:29

By its illumination

PSA 119:105, PSA 119:130 See also 2PE 1:19; 1JN 2:8

By its encouragement and reassurance

ROM 15:4; 1JN 5:13 See also PSA 19:8–19:9, PSA 119:50–119:51, PSA 119:76; HEB 12:5–12:6

By its record of God's promises

1KI 8:56; PSA 119:140 See also EZK 12:25; LUK 24:44; 2CO 1:19–1:22

By its trustworthiness

1KI 17:24; PSA 19:7–19:11, PSA 33:4 See also PSA 119:151, PSA 119:160; JHN 21:24; REV 21:5

Scripture is essential for spiritual growth and maturity

PSA 1:1–1:3 See also MAT 4:4; JHN 15:5–15:8, JHN 17:17; EPH 6:10–6:17; 2TI 3:14–3:17

1614: Scripture, understanding

God intends his word to be understood and has provided the directions and means for understanding it.

Scripture is intended to be clearly understood**It is accessible to ordinary people**

PSA 119:130 See also PSA 19:7

Some sections are difficult to understand

2PE 3:15–3:16 See also HEB 5:11

God has prescribed the way to understand Scripture**Through public reading**

1TI 4:13 See also NEH 8:2–8:8, NEH 13:1–13:3

Through diligent study

2TI 2:15 See also DEU 17:18–17:20; ACT 17:11

Through thoughtful meditation

PSA 1:1–1:3 See also JOS 1:8; JOB 23:12; PSA 119:15, PSA 119:27, PSA 119:48, PSA 119:97, PSA 119:148

Assistance in understanding through the Holy Spirit

1CO 2:9–2:12 See also ISA 64:4; LUK 24:45; JHN 14:26, JHN 16:13; 1JN 2:27

Assistance in understanding through ministers of the word

NEH 8:2–8:8 See also EPH 4:11–4:14; 1TI 4:11–4:16; 2TI 4:1–4:5

1615: Scripture, sufficiency of

Scripture is presented as being of itself sufficient for faith and for life.

God's written revelation is sufficient

DEU 4:1–4:2 See also DEU 12:32; JOS 1:7–1:8; PRO 30:5–30:6; JER 26:2

The NT records the completion and fulfilment of the OT

HEB 1:1–1:2 See also JHN 12:47–12:50; EPH 2:20

Warnings against turning from, or adding to, the apostolic gospel, as set forth in Scripture

REV 22:18–22:19 See also GAL 1:6–1:9; COL 1:25–2:8, COL 2:18, COL 2:20–2:23; 2TH 2:1–2:2

Descriptions of Scripture point to its sufficiency

Scripture is good

ROM 7:12 See also 1TI 1:8

Scripture is perfect

PSA 19:7 See also PSA 119:142; JAS 1:25

Scripture is eternal

PSA 119:89 See also MAT 5:18, MAT 24:35; 1PE 1:24–1:25; ISA 40:6–40:8

1620: beatitudes, the

The blessings pronounced by Jesus Christ in the Sermon on the Mount on those whose lives exhibit particular characteristics or qualities. These contrast sharply with popular values and outlooks.

The poor in spirit

MAT 5:3 parallel LUK 6:20 See also PSA 69:32–69:33; ISA 61:1; MAT 23:12; LUK 18:9–18:14

Those who mourn

MAT 5:4 parallel LUK 6:21 See also PSA 51:17; ISA 57:18–57:21, ISA 61:1–61:3; JER 31:13; REV 7:17, REV 21:4

The meek

MAT 5:5 See also PSA 37:11; ZEP 3:11–3:12; MAT 11:29

Those who hunger after righteousness

MAT 5:6 parallel LUK 6:21 See also ISA 55:1–55:2; MAT 6:33; 2TI 2:22; 1PE 3:12

The merciful

MAT 5:7 See also EXO 34:6–34:7; DAN 9:9; MAT 6:12 parallel LUK 11:4; MAT 6:14–6:15, MAT 18:21–18:35; LUK 6:36; JAS 2:13

The pure in heart

MAT 5:8 See also PSA 24:3–24:5, PSA 51:10, PSA 73:1; 1JN 3:2–3:3

The peacemakers

MAT 5:9 See also PSA 34:14; MAT 5:44–5:45; ROM 12:18, ROM 14:19; 2TI 2:22; JAS 3:17–3:18

The righteous who suffer persecution

MAT 5:10–5:12 parallel LUK 6:22 See also JHN 15:18–15:21; 2TI 3:10–3:12; JAS 1:12; 1PE 3:14, 1PE 3:17, 1PE 4:12–4:16

1630: Book of the Covenant

The customary designation given to the code of law in Ex 20:22–23:33, but it may also have included the Ten Commandments (Ex 20:2–17).

Moses reads the Book of the Covenant to the Israelites

EXO 24:7 See also EXO 20:22–23:33 The Book of the Covenant is the oldest, extant codification of Israelite law, where human values are constantly elevated over material ones. It can be argued that each section of the code is a further exposition of one of the Ten Commandments, giving specific case laws.

Josiah reads the rediscovered Book of the Covenant to the people of Judah

2KI 23:2–23:3 parallel 2CH 34:30–34:31 See also 2KI 23:21 This reference to the Book of the Covenant applies either to all or part of the book of Deuteronomy, or to the entire Mosaic Law.

1640: Book of the Law

A documentary form of the Law placed beside the ark of the covenant as a reminder to Israel of her covenant obligation. It was rediscovered and applied during the reign of King Josiah of Judah and read publicly by Ezra after the rebuilding of the walls of Jerusalem.

The Book of the Law was written by Moses

DEU 31:24–31:26 The book in question could be the material now included as chapters 1–30, although some scholars suggest it might refer to the material now included as chapters 12–26. See also DEU 28:58–28:61, DEU 29:18–29:21, DEU 30:10

The Book of the Law was passed from Moses to Joshua

JOS 1:7–1:8 See also JOS 8:30–8:31, JOS 8:34–8:35, JOS 23:6, JOS 24:26

The Book of the Law during the monarchy

2KI 14:6 parallel 2CH 25:4; ; 2CH 17:9

The Book of the Law was rediscovered and applied in Josiah's reign

2KI 22:8–22:16 parallel 2CH 34:15–34:24 A reference to part or all of Deuteronomy or possibly the entire Pentateuch (Genesis to Deuteronomy).

The Book of the Law was read publicly by Ezra

NEH 8:1–8:18 See also NEH 9:3

Paul refers to the Book of the Law

GAL 3:10 Paul is teaching that justification is by faith. See also DEU 27:26

1650: numbers, significance of

Numbers appear frequently in Scripture and in a variety of contexts. Occasionally they have a special theological significance.

1651: numbers, 1–2

The number one is often associated with the uniqueness of God and also with the unity between God and his people. The number two is used in a variety of contexts.

One

One God

MRK 12:32 See also DEU 6:4; ISA 44:8, ISA 45:21; JHN 1:18; ROM 3:30; 1CO 8:4–8:6

One Father

MAL 2:10; ; MAT 23:9; ; EPH 4:6

One Son Jesus Christ

JHN 1:14, JHN 3:16, JHN 3:18; ; 1CO 8:6; ; 2CO 11:2; ; EPH 4:5; ; HEB 11:17; ; 1JN 4:9

One Holy Spirit

1CO 12:9, 1CO 12:11, 1CO 12:13; ; EPH 2:18, EPH 4:4

One Saviour

ISA 43:10–43:11; ; ACT 4:12; ; 1TI 2:5

One Shepherd

ECC 12:11; ; EZK 34:23, EZK 37:22, EZK 37:24; ; JHN 10:16

One faith

JUD 1:3 See also GAL 1:8–1:9; EPH 4:5

One sacrifice for sin

HEB 7:27 See also ROM 6:10; HEB 9:12, HEB 9:28, HEB 10:10; 1PE 3:18

One who acts on behalf of others

JHN 11:50 See also 1SA 17:8–17:10; JHN 18:14; ROM 5:15–5:19; 1TI 2:5

One people of God

EZK 37:22; ; ROM 12:4–12:5; ; 1CO 10:17, 1CO 12:12–12:13; ; EPH 2:16, EPH 3:6, EPH 4:4; ; COL 3:15

Christians are to be one in Jesus Christ Jesus Christ

JHN 17:21 See also GAL 3:28

Christians are to be one in spirit

PHP 2:2 See also ROM 15:6; 2CO 13:11; PHP 1:27

Married couples become one flesh

GEN 2:24 See also MAT 19:5 parallel MRK 10:8; 1CO 6:16; EPH 5:31

One priority for all people

MRK 12:28–12:30 parallel MAT 22:36–22:37 See also DEU 6:4–6:5; MAT 6:33; LUK 10:42

Two

Two of every kind in the ark

GEN 6:19–6:20, GEN 7:2

Two brothers

Isaac and Ishmael: GEN 17:17–17:19, GEN 21:10, GEN 25:9; GEN 25:23; ; ROM 9:10–9:13; GEN 48:1–48:20 Ephraim and Manasseh; MAT 4:18–4:22 parallel MRK 1:16–1:20; ; LUK 5:10; ; JHN 1:40–1:42; LUK 15:11 the prodigal son and his brother

Two wives

GEN 16:3; ; DEU 21:15; ; 1SA 1:2–1:7; 1SA 27:3, 1SA 30:5, 1SA 30:18; ; 2SA 2:2; 2CH 24:3

Teams of two: Jesus Christ's disciples

LUK 10:1 See also MAT 21:1 parallels MRK 11:1, LUK 19:29; MRK 14:13

Teams of two: Paul and his colleagues

ACT 13:42–13:50, ACT 14:1–14:3, ACT 15:12, ACT 15:22, ACT 16:19–16:40, ACT 17:10; ; 1CO 1:1; ; 2CO 1:1; ; PHP 1:1; ; COL 1:1

Two tablets of the Ten Commandments

EXO 31:18, EXO 34:29; ; DEU 9:15, DEU 9:17, DEU 10:3; ; 2CH 5:10

Two cherubim

EXO 25:18, EXO 25:22, EXO 37:7; ; NUM 7:89; ; 1KI 6:25

1652: numbers, 3–5

The number three, primarily associated with the doctrine of the Trinity, is also associated with periods of specially significant divine activity (e.g., “on the third day”). Four and five have a variety of associations.

Three

The Trinity

MAT 28:19 See also JHN 14:26, JHN 15:26; 1CO 12:4–12:6; 1PE 1:2

The triad of faith, hope and love

1CO 13:13 See also 1TH 1:3

Three days

GEN 30:36 Three days is a common period, often indicating the length of a journey or a period leading to a critical point. See also GEN 40:12–40:22; EXO 3:18, EXO 10:22; NUM 10:33; JDG 14:14; 1KI 12:5 parallel 2CH 10:5

Jesus Christ was raised after three days

LUK 24:46 See also MAT 16:21 parallels MRK 8:31, LUK 9:22; MAT 17:23 parallel MRK 9:31; MAT 20:19 parallels MRK 10:34, LUK 18:33; MAT 27:63–27:64; LUK 24:7, LUK 24:21; ACT 10:40; 1CO 15:3–15:4 JON 1:17; MAT 12:39–12:40 parallel LUK 11:29–11:30; MAT 16:4

Three brothers

Shem, Ham and Japheth: GEN 6:10, GEN 7:13, GEN 9:19; 1SA 2:21, 1SA 31:6 parallel 1CH 10:6; ; 2SA 2:18

Groups of three men

Job's friends: JOB 2:11, JOB 32:3, JOB 32:5; MAT 17:1 parallels MRK 9:2, LUK 9:28; ; MAT 26:37 parallel MRK 14:33; ; GEN 18:2; ; EZK 14:14–14:18; ; DAN 3:23–3:24; ; ZEC 11:8; ; 2SA 23:8–23:12 the Three in David's army; ; 2SA 23:13–23:23 parallel 1CH 11:15–11:25 the three mighty men among David's chiefs

Three annual festivals

EXO 23:14, EXO 23:17, EXO 34:23–34:24; ; DEU 16:16; ; 1KI 9:25; ; 2CH 8:13

Three and a half

DAN 7:25 NIV footnote. See also DAN 12:7; REV 11:2, REV 12:6, REV 13:5

Four

Four representing the complete created order

REV 7:1 This symbol is probably based on the four points of the compass. See also JER 49:36; EZK 37:9; DAN 7:2; MAT 24:31 parallel MRK 13:27

Four living creatures

The four living creatures in Ezekiel and Revelation represent the whole animate creation glorifying God: EZK 1:5–1:10; ; REV 4:6–4:7, REV 5:6, REV 5:8, REV 14:3

Four kingdoms

Human history before the coming of God's kingdom is spanned by four great human kingdoms, often understood to refer to the empires of Babylon, Persia, Greece and Rome: DAN 2:39–2:40, DAN 7:17

Five

Fives in Jesus Christ's teaching

MAT 25:2, MAT 25:15–25:20; ; LUK 12:6, LUK 12:52, LUK 14:19, LUK 16:28, LUK 19:18–19:19; ; JHN 4:18

Five loaves

1SA 21:3; ; MAT 14:17–14:19 parallels MRK 6:38–6:41, LUK 9:13–9:16, JHN 6:8–6:13; ; MAT 16:9 parallel MRK 8:19

1653: numbers, 6–10

The number seven is especially associated with completeness and perfection. The number ten is occasionally used as a symbol of completeness. Other numbers have a variety of associations.

Six

The world was created in six days

EXO 20:11 See also GEN 1:1–1:31; EXO 31:17

Human work is to be limited to six days a week

EXO 16:26, EXO 20:9 parallel DEU 5:13; ; EXO 23:12, EXO 31:15, EXO 34:21, EXO 35:2; ; LEV 23:3; ; LUK 13:14

Other important six-day periods

DEU 16:8; ; JOS 6:3–6:14; ; MAT 17:1 parallel MRK 9:2; ; JHN 12:1

Human work restricted to six-year periods

EXO 21:2, EXO 23:10; ; LEV 25:3; ; DEU 15:12, DEU 15:18; ; JER 34:14

Seven

The seventh day is a day of rest

GEN 2:2–2:3 See also EXO 20:10 parallel DEU 5:14; EXO 31:15–31:17, EXO 35:2–35:3; HEB 4:4

The seventh year symbolises rest and freedom

LEV 25:4 See also EXO 23:10–23:11; LEV 25:2–25:6; DEU 15:1, DEU 15:12; NEH 10:31

Major festivals lasted seven days

Unleavened Bread: EXO 12:15, EXO 23:15; ; LEV 23:6; ; NUM 28:17; ; DEU 16:8; ; 2CH 30:21, 2CH 35:17; ; EZK 45:21; LEV 23:34; ; NUM 29:12; ; DEU 16:13; EXO 29:30, EXO 29:35; ; LEV 8:33

The Feast of Weeks, or Pentecost, comes seven weeks after the firstfruits of the harvest

LEV 23:15–23:16; ; DEU 16:9

Festivals in the seventh month

LEV 16:29, LEV 23:24, LEV 23:39; ; NUM 29:7, NUM 29:12

Important rituals associated with sevens

LEV 4:6–4:17, LEV 14:7, LEV 14:51, LEV 16:14; ; NUM 28:11; ; 1CH 15:26; ; JOB 42:8

Ritual uncleanness for seven days

LEV 12:2, LEV 13:4, LEV 13:21, LEV 13:26, LEV 15:24

Seven times indicates a completed action

LEV 26:18; ; JOS 6:4; ; 1KI 18:43; ; 2KI 5:10; ; PSA 119:164

Seven times indicates total intensification

GEN 4:15; ; LEV 26:21; ; PSA 12:6, PSA 79:12; ; ISA 30:26; ; DAN 3:19

The seven spirits of God

REV 5:6 See also ZEC 4:10; REV 1:4, REV 3:1, REV 4:5

Seven associated with final judgment

REV 21:9 See also REV 8:2, REV 8:6, REV 10:3–10:4, REV 12:3, REV 15:1, REV 15:7, REV 17:3

Eight

Eighth day as the day of circumcision

LUK 2:21 See also GEN 17:12, GEN 21:4; LEV 12:3; LUK 1:59; ACT 7:8; PHP 3:5

Eighth day as the end of major festivals

LEV 23:36, LEV 23:39; ; NUM 29:35; ; 2CH 7:9; ; NEH 8:18

Rituals of the eighth day

LEV 14:10, LEV 14:23, LEV 15:14

Nine**Jesus Christ died at the ninth hour****MAT 27:45–27:46** parallels MRK 15:33–15:34, LUK 23:44**Ten****Ten as a symbol of completeness**

See also RUT 4:2; 2CH 4:6–4:8; DAN 1:12–1:15, DAN 7:24; REV 2:10, REV 12:3

Ten as an approximate number

GEN 31:7; ; RUT 1:4; ; 1SA 1:8; ; JOB 19:3; ; ZEC 8:23

Ten days as an approximate period

GEN 24:55; ; 1SA 25:38; ; ACT 25:6

Ten plagues on Egypt

EXO 7:20, EXO 8:6, EXO 8:16, EXO 8:24, EXO 9:6, EXO 9:10, EXO 9:22, EXO 10:12, EXO 10:21, EXO 11:5

The Ten Commandments**EXO 34:28** See also DEU 4:13, DEU 10:4**Tens in Jesus Christ's parables**

MAT 25:1, MAT 25:28; ; LUK 15:8, LUK 19:13, LUK 19:17

1654: numbers, 11–99

Significant numbers include twelve, often associated with the full number of God's people, and multiples of ten, especially forty and seventy.

Eleven**Eleven sons of Jacob**

GEN 32:22, GEN 37:9

Jesus Christ's eleven disciples

MAT 28:16; ; MRK 16:14; ; LUK 24:9, LUK 24:33; ; ACT 1:26, ACT 2:14

Twelve**Twelve tribes of Israel****GEN 49:28** See also GEN 35:22–35:26; EXO 24:4, EXO 28:21, EXO 39:14; JDG 19:29; EZR 8:35; ACT 26:7**Representatives of the twelve tribes**

DEU 1:23; ; JOS 3:12, JOS 4:2–4:3

The church symbolised as twelve tribes

JAS 1:1; ; REV 7:4–7:8, REV 21:12

Twelve apostles**MRK 3:14** See also MAT 10:1–10:4, MAT 19:28; LUK 9:1, LUK 22:30; JHN 6:70–6:71; ACT 6:2; 1CO 15:5 The term “the

Twelve” is used here even though only eleven disciples remained at the time referred to.

Fourteen**Passover on the fourteenth day of the first month****NUM 28:16** See also EXO 12:6; LEV 23:5; NUM 9:2–9:5; JOS 5:10; 2CH 35:1; EZR 6:19; EZK 45:21**Passover on the fourteenth day of the second month**

NUM 9:10–9:11; ; 2CH 30:2–30:3, 2CH 30:15

Periods of fourteen years

GEN 31:41; ; 2CO 12:2; ; GAL 2:1

Genealogy of Jesus Christ in spans of fourteen generations

MAT 1:17

Fifteen**Festivals on the fifteenth day**

LEV 23:6, LEV 23:34, LEV 23:39; ; NUM 28:17, NUM 29:12; ; 1KI 12:32–12:33; ; EZK 45:25

Twenty**Twenty as the minimum age in a census**

EXO 30:14, EXO 38:26; ; NUM 1:3, NUM 1:18, NUM 14:29, NUM 26:2; ; 1CH 27:23

Twenty as the minimum age for Levitical service

1CH 23:24, 1CH 23:27; ; 2CH 31:17; ; EZR 3:8

Thirty**Thirty as the age for beginning a life's work****LUK 3:23** See also GEN 41:46; 1SA 13:1; 2SA 5:4; EZK 1:1 The “thirtieth year” may refer to Ezekiel's age.**Thirty as the minimum age for Levitical service**

NUM 4:3, NUM 4:23, NUM 4:30, NUM 4:47; ; 1CH 23:3

The Thirty in David's army

2SA 23:23 parallel 1CH 11:25; ; 2SA 23:24; ; 1CH 11:15–11:42, 1CH 12:4, 1CH 12:18, 1CH 27:6

Thirty pieces of silver**MAT 26:15** See also ZEC 11:12–11:13; MAT 27:3, MAT 27:9**Forty****Forty days****JON 3:4** Forty days is a standard period, sometimes viewed as a time of preparation or testing before a major event. GEN 7:4, GEN 7:12, GEN 7:17, GEN 8:6; EXO 24:18, EXO 34:28; ; DEU 9:9, DEU 9:18; MAT 4:1–4:2 parallels MRK 1:13, LUK 4:1–4:2 Jesus Christ fasted for forty days in the wilderness; ; NUM 13:25; ; 1SA 17:16; ; 1KI 19:8; ; ACT 1:3

Forty years as a general term for a generation

God's anger against Israel in the wilderness: NUM 14:34, NUM 32:13; ; JOS 5:6; ; PSA 95:10; ; HEB 3:9, HEB 3:17; EXO 16:35; ; DEU 2:7, DEU 8:2–8:4, DEU 29:5; ; NEH 9:21; ; AMO 2:10; ; ACT 7:36, ACT 13:18

Other significant forty-year periods

Forty-year periods in Moses' life: EXO 7:7; ; DEU 34:7; ; ACT 7:23, ACT 7:30, ACT 7:36; JDG 3:11, JDG 5:31, JDG 8:28; 1SA 4:18; ; 2SA 5:4; ; 1KI 2:11 parallel 1CH 29:27; ; 1KI 11:42 parallel 2CH 9:30; ; 2KI 12:1 parallel 2CH 24:1; ; ACT 13:21

Fifty

The fiftieth year as the Year of Jubilee

LEV 25:10–25:11 The word “jubilee” refers to the liberation of slaves, rather than to a fixed period of time. The number 50 represents the year following seven periods of seven years, i.e., 49 years + 1.

Seventy

Seventy people went down to Egypt

See also GEN 46:27; EXO 1:5

Seventy years of God's judgment

JER 25:11–25:12 See also 2CH 36:21; ISA 23:15–23:17; JER 29:10; DAN 9:2; ZEC 1:12

Seventy years as the human lifespan

PSA 90:10

Groups of seventy

EXO 24:1; ; NUM 11:16, NUM 11:24–11:25; ; JDG 9:2; ; LUK 10:1, LUK 10:17

Seventy as a large number

MAT 18:22 See also DAN 9:24

1655: numbers, hundreds and thousands

The words “hundreds” and, especially, “thousands”, often refer to large quantities in general; they are also used simply in a superlative sense.

Hundreds

A hundred in Jesus Christ's teaching

MAT 13:23 parallel MRK 4:20 See also MAT 13:8 parallels MRK 4:8, LUK 8:8; MAT 18:12 parallel LUK 15:4; MAT 18:28; MRK 10:30

Abraham becomes a father at 100

GEN 17:17, GEN 21:5; ; ROM 4:19

People who lived to over 100

GEN 5:3–5:32, GEN 9:29, GEN 11:10–11:32, GEN 25:7, GEN 25:17, GEN 50:22; ; DEU 34:7; ; JDG 2:8; ; 2CH 24:15; ; JOB 42:16; ; ISA 65:20

Hundreds and thousands

Hundreds and thousands as military units

EXO 18:21; ; NUM 31:14; ; 1SA 22:7; ; 2SA 18:1; ; 1CH 13:1, 1CH 27:1, 1CH 28:1; ; 2CH 25:5

Hundreds and thousands in blessings

DEU 1:11 See also GEN 24:60; 2SA 24:3 parallel 1CH 21:3; PSA 144:13

Thousands

Jesus Christ feeds thousands

MAT 14:21 parallels MRK 6:44, LUK 9:14, JHN 6:10; ; MAT 15:38 parallel MRK 8:9; ; MAT 16:9–16:10 parallel MRK 8:19–8:20

Believers numbered in thousands

ACT 21:20 See also ACT 2:41, ACT 4:4; ROM 11:4; 1KI 19:18

God shows his love to thousands

EXO 34:6–34:7 See also EXO 20:6 parallel DEU 5:10; DEU 7:9

God has thousands of attendants

REV 5:11 See also PSA 68:17; DAN 7:10; HEB 12:22; JUD 1:14

God protects one believer amidst thousands of people

PSA 91:7

God helps one believer against a thousand

See also JOS 23:10; JDG 15:15–15:16

God allows thousands to be defeated

DEU 32:30; ; ISA 30:17

A thousand years

As a day to the Lord: PSA 90:4; ; 2PE 3:8; REV 20:2–20:7 the reign of Jesus Christ with believers for 1,000 years while Satan is restrained

Special numbers

REV 13:18 666 is a symbol of total incompleteness; ; REV 7:4 144,000 symbolises the perfect number of God's people.

God's people are without number

GEN 16:10 See also NUM 10:36; REV 7:9

God's people are compared to stars and sand

GEN 22:17 See also GEN 15:5; EXO 32:13; DEU 10:22; 1CH 27:23; NEH 9:23; JER 33:22; HEB 11:12

1656: numbers, combinations

Numbers may be combined for making a comparison. When they are combined in such a pattern as “two or three” the emphasis usually falls on the second figure.

Two and three

Two or three witnesses

DEU 19:15 See also NUM 35:30; DEU 17:6; MAT 18:16; 2CO 13:1; 1TI 5:19; HEB 10:28

Two or three as a small approximate number

MAT 18:20 See also 2KI 9:32; ISA 17:6; HOS 6:2; 1CO 14:27, 1CO 14:29

Two and three in a climactic pattern

ECC 4:12 See also PRO 30:15

Three and four

Three or four as a small approximate number

JER 36:23

Three and four in a climactic pattern

PRO 30:18–30:19 See also PRO 30:15–30:16, PRO 30:21–30:23, PRO 30:29–30:31; AMO 1:3, AMO 1:6, AMO 1:9, AMO 1:11, AMO 1:13, AMO 2:1, AMO 2:4, AMO 2:6

Other examples of the climactic pattern

JOB 5:19; ; PRO 6:16–6:19; ; GEN 4:24; ; ECC 11:2; ; MIC 5:5

Comparative use of multiples of ten

AMO 5:3 See also LEV 26:8; DEU 33:17; JDG 20:10; MIC 6:7; LUK 16:7

Numerical contrast between Saul and David

ISA 18:7–18:8 See also ISA 21:11, ISA 29:5

1657: numbers, fractions

Mainly associated with divisions of the people and of property, and also with sacrificial offerings.

One half

Half the people

JOS 8:33 See also DEU 27:12–27:13; 1KI 16:21; NEH 4:16, NEH 12:31–12:32, NEH 12:38, NEH 13:24

The half-tribes of Manasseh

DEU 3:13 See also NUM 32:33, NUM 34:13–34:14; DEU 29:8; JOS 13:29–13:31, JOS 22:10; 1CH 5:23

Halves in offering sacrifices

GEN 15:10 See also EXO 24:6, EXO 30:13; LEV 6:20

Significant examples of halves

2SA 10:4 parallel 1CH 19:4 David's men and the Ammonites; ; 1KI 3:25 Solomon; ; 1KI 10:7 parallel 2CH 9:6 the Queen of Sheba; EST 5:3, EST 7:2; ; MRK 6:23; ISA 44:16–44:20 Idolatry

One third

Thirds of a group

2SA 18:2; ; 2KI 11:5–11:6 parallel 2CH 23:4–23:5

Thirds in the processes of judgment

REV 9:18 See also EZK 5:2, EZK 5:12; REV 8:7–8:12, REV 9:15, REV 12:4

One fifth

A fifth of the harvest

GEN 41:34, GEN 47:24, GEN 47:26

A fifth in cases of restitution

LEV 5:14–5:16 See also LEV 6:5, LEV 22:14; NUM 5:7

Redeeming what is promised to God

LEV 27:13 See also LEV 27:15, LEV 27:19, LEV 27:27, LEV 27:31

One tenth

Instructions about God's tithe

LEV 27:30–27:32 The term “tithe” is the Old English word for “one tenth”. See also NUM 18:21, NUM 18:26; DEU 12:6, DEU 12:11, DEU 14:22; NEH 10:38; AMO 4:4; MAL 3:8–3:10

The royal tithe

1SA 8:15, 1SA 8:17

Examples of the tithe

Abraham: GEN 14:20; ; HEB 7:1–7:10; GEN 28:22 Jacob; 2CH 31:5–31:6, 2CH 31:12; ; NEH 10:37; MAT 23:23 teachers of the law and Pharisees

1660: Sermon on the Mount

A collection of Jesus Christ's teaching on the theme of discipleship. It deals with the righteousness required of disciples, the way they are to perform their religious duties, and the blessing and persecution they will know as followers of Christ. It can be seen as a manifesto setting out the nature of life in the kingdom of God.

The setting of the Sermon on the Mount

MAT 5:1; LUK 6:17 Either Jesus Christ taught similar material in two different locations, as is common in preaching, or else Luke more specifically identifies that he taught on a level place or plateau on the mountainside.

The teaching of the Sermon on the Mount

The blessings of being in the kingdom

See also MAT 5:3–5:12 parallel LUK 6:20–6:23

Jesus Christ's disciples are to have a positive influence on the world

MAT 5:13–5:16

The relationship between Jesus Christ's message and the law

MAT 5:17–5:21

Jesus Christ's disciples are to exhibit a new depth of righteousness

MAT 5:20 See also MAT 5:48

The righteousness required of Jesus Christ disciples

Not only murder but also anger and broken relationships are wrong: MAT 5:21–5:24; ; EXO 20:13; ; MAT 5:25–5:26 parallel LUK 12:58–12:59; MAT 5:27–5:30; ; EXO 20:14; MAT 5:31–5:32 faithfulness in marriage is called for; ; MAT 5:33–5:37 faithfulness in speech is called for; ; MAT 5:38–5:48 Retaliation must be abandoned, and enemies as well as neighbours must be loved.

Jesus Christ's disciples are to seek only God's approval in their religious duties

MAT 6:1

How religious duties are to be performed

See also MAT 6:2–6:4 Giving to the poor is to be done secretly; MAT 6:5–6:8 Prayer is not to become a public display; MAT 6:16–6:18 Fasting is to be done without show.

The kingdom is to be valued above material possessions

MAT 6:19–6:21 See also MAT 6:24–6:34 parallel LUK 12:22–12:31

Jesus Christ's disciples are to avoid being judgmental

MAT 7:1–7:2 See also MAT 7:3–7:5 parallel LUK 6:41–6:42

Jesus Christ's disciples should pray, confident of an answer

MAT 7:7–7:8 parallel LUK 11:9–11:10 See also MAT 7:9–7:12 parallel LUK 11:11–11:13

A pattern for prayer

MAT 6:9–6:15 parallel LUK 11:2–11:4

True disciples will obey Jesus Christ teaching

MAT 7:21 See also MAT 7:15–7:20, MAT 7:24–7:27 parallel LUK 6:47–6:49

Characteristics of Jesus Christ's teaching in the Sermon on the Mount

MAT 7:28–7:29

1670: symbols

Objects, actions or creatures that have a deeper significance and are so understood by those who see them or use them.

Symbolic objects

The rainbow: a symbol of God's covenant

See also GEN 9:13; EZK 1:28; REV 4:3

A stairway: a symbol of the way to God

GEN 28:11–28:13; ; JHN 1:51

Thunder, lightning, cloud and smoke: symbols of God's majesty

EXO 19:16–19:18, EXO 24:17; ; PSA 97:2, PSA 97:4; ; REV 4:5, REV 8:5, REV 11:19

Thunder: a symbol of God's voice

PSA 29:3, PSA 68:33

Trumpets: a symbol of God speaking

EXO 19:19; ; REV 8:6

The pillar of cloud and fire: a symbol of guidance

EXO 13:21

A throne: a symbol of God's glory

ISA 6:1; ; EZK 1:26; ; REV 4:2, REV 22:3

Dry bones: a symbol of spiritual death

EZK 37:1–37:2, EZK 37:11

White hair: a symbol of wisdom

DAN 7:9; ; REV 1:14

The wind: a symbol of the Holy Spirit

JHN 3:8; ; ACT 2:2

Fire: a symbol of the Holy Spirit

ACT 2:3

Stars and lampstands: symbols of God's ministers

REV 1:20

A signet ring: a symbol of authority

EST 8:10; ; HAG 2:23

Arrows: symbols of God's judgments

PSA 38:2, PSA 120:4

A sceptre: a symbol of God's rule

PSA 2:9; ; REV 2:27, REV 19:15

The capstone: a symbol of pre-eminence

MAT 21:42 parallels MRK 12:10–12:11, LUK 20:17; ; PSA 118:22

A rock: a symbol of stability

PSA 18:2, PSA 40:2

The human body: a symbol of interdependence

1CO 12:27

Grass: a symbol of human frailty

PSA 90:5–90:6; ; 1PE 1:24

Symbolic creatures

The serpent: a symbol of Satan's subtlety
GEN 3:1; ; REV 12:9, REV 20:1-20:3

Locusts: a symbol of God's judgment
EXO 10:12; ; JOL 1:4; ; REV 9:3

Beasts: symbols of earthly kingdoms
DAN 7:2-7:7, DAN 7:17, DAN 8:20-8:22

A dove: a symbol of the Holy Spirit
MAT 3:16 parallels MRK 1:10, LUK 3:22

A lamb: a symbol of Jesus Christ's sacrifice
REV 5:6

Symbolic actions

Breaking a jar: a symbol of the destruction of Jerusalem
JER 19:10-19:11

The cursing of a fig-tree: a symbol of judgment
MAT 21:18-21:19 parallel MRK 11:12-11:14

Washing hands: a symbol of innocence
MAT 27:24

Being thirsty: a symbol of spiritual need
PSA 63:1; ; JHN 7:37

Baptism: a symbol of salvation in Jesus Christ
ACT 22:16; ; ROM 6:3-6:4; ; 1PE 3:21

The Lord's Supper: a symbol of union with Christ
MAT 26:26-26:29 parallels MRK 14:22-14:24, LUK 22:19-22:20, 1CO 11:23-11:26

Anointing: a symbol of empowering by God's Spirit
ISA 61:1; ; LUK 4:18; ; ISA 61:1

Harvesting: a symbol of judgment day
JOL 3:12-3:13; ; MAT 13:29-13:30; ; REV 14:15

Tearing garments: a symbol of anger and sorrow
GEN 37:29, GEN 37:34; ; JOS 7:6

Spitting: a symbol of contempt
ISA 50:6; ; MAT 26:67 parallel MRK 14:65

Shaking off dust: a symbol of rejection
MAT 10:14 parallel LUK 9:5; ; ACT 13:51

Sitting in sackcloth and ashes: a symbol of repentance
PSA 69:11; ; ISA 22:12; ; JON 3:5-3:6; ; MAT 11:21

Lifting of hands: a symbol of prayer
PSA 63:4; ; 1TI 2:8

Covering the head: a symbol of submission
1CO 11:3-11:10

Symbols expressing God's nature and character

God's face: a symbol of his presence
NUM 6:25-6:26; ; PSA 34:16

God's arm or hand: a symbol of his power
PSA 21:8, PSA 89:13

God's eyes: a symbol of his awareness
PRO 15:3; ; 1PE 3:12

God's ear: a symbol of God listening
PSA 31:2; ; ISA 59:1

1680: types

An OT institution, person, place or event regarded as anticipating the person of Jesus Christ or some aspect of the Christian faith or life.

OT foreshadowings of Jesus Christ

LUK 24:25-24:27 See also LUK 24:44; 1PE 1:10-1:12

OT institutions as types

The Sabbath: Jesus Christ's finished work
HEB 4:3-4:6 See also GEN 2:2-2:3; HEB 4:9-4:10

Marriage: Jesus Christ's union with his people
EPH 5:30-5:32 See also GEN 2:22-2:24 Adam may be viewed as a figure of Jesus Christ, and Eve, of the church, formed in Christ, loved and united with him; PSA 45:10-45:11; MAT 9:15, MAT 25:1; JHN 3:29; EPH 5:25-5:27; REV 19:7, REV 21:2

Circumcision: believers' union with Christ
COL 2:11 See also GEN 17:9-17:14; ROM 2:29; PHP 3:3

The tabernacle: Jesus Christ's coming among his people

JHN 1:14 The context shows that "The Word" is Jesus Christ; "made his dwelling" involves the idea of pitching a tent and reflects the tabernacle which was pitched among the Israelites and filled with God's glory; so Christ has pitched his tent among his people and revealed his glory. See also EXO 25:8, EXO 40:34-40:35

The tabernacle: the way to God
HEB 9:11-9:12 See also EXO 25:22, EXO 30:6, EXO 30:36; NUM 17:4; HEB 9:8, HEB 10:19-10:22

The high priesthood: Jesus Christ as intercessor
HEB 7:23-7:28 See also EXO 29:1-29:7; LEV 16:11-16:17; HEB 4:14-4:16, HEB 5:1-5:5 Jesus Christ, the great high priest, is both human and divine; HEB 9:11-9:12, HEB 10:11-10:12 Note the contrast between the many OT sacrifices and Jesus Christ's once-for-all offering of himself.

The priesthood: Christian worship and service

HEB 13:15–13:16 See also EXO 19:6, EXO 29:8–29:9; 1PE 2:5; REV 1:6

Sacrifices: Jesus Christ as substitute

ROM 3:25 See also LEV 4:13–4:15, LEV 4:25–4:35 Hands laid on the head of the sacrifice symbolised the transfer of guilt and its consequences to another. A perfect animal was required; ISA 53:4–53:12; MRK 15:25–15:37; 2CO 5:15; GAL 2:20; 1PE 3:18

Sacrifice: believers' consecration

ROM 12:1 See also LEV 1:1–1:9; NUM 15:1–15:12; PHP 2:17; 2TI 4:6

The day of atonement: Jesus Christ as sin-bearer

HEB 9:28 See also LEV 16:1–16:34; HEB 9:7

Passover: deliverance from judgment

1CO 5:7 See also EXO 12:1–12:16; MAT 26:17 parallels MRK 14:12, LUK 22:7; MAT 26:26–26:29 parallels MRK 14:22–14:25, LUK 22:14–22:20; JHN 1:29; 1PE 1:18–1:19

Redemption: release from sin

MAT 20:28 parallel MRK 10:45 “Redemption” and “ransom” both involve buying back that which has been lost. See also EXO 13:11–13:13, EXO 21:28–21:32; JOB 19:25; PSA 78:35; ISA 41:14; ROM 3:24; 1CO 6:20 GAL 3:13, GAL 4:5 EPH 1:7 Blood is the ransom price for the forgiveness of sin; 1TI 2:6; TIT 2:14; HEB 9:15

The temple: the church

2CO 6:16 See also 1KI 6:1, 1KI 8:10–8:13; 1CO 3:16; EPH 2:21–2:22; 1PE 2:5

OT places as types**The promised land: rest in Christ**

HEB 4:8–4:11 See also JOS 1:13, JOS 11:23, JOS 14:15

Jerusalem: the glorified church

REV 21:1–21:3 See also 2SA 5:4–5:5; PSA 122:1–122:9; ISA 62:6–62:7; ZEC 2:3–2:5; HEB 12:22–12:23; REV 3:12, REV 21:9–21:10

Babylon: enmity to Jesus Christ

REV 17:5 Some take Babylon to represent the world, some the apostate church, some a city. See also ISA 13:19–13:22; REV 18:2–18:3

OT people as types**Israel: the church**

1PE 2:9 See also GEN 12:1–12:3; EXO 19:6; ROM 9:6–9:8; GAL 6:16; EPH 2:19

Adam: Jesus Christ as the head of his people

1CO 15:21–15:22 See also GEN 3:17–3:19; ROM 5:12–5:20 Just as Adam was the representative of all humanity

in the fall, so Jesus Christ is the representative of all who inherit salvation.

Abraham: justifying faith in Jesus Christ

ROM 4:18–4:25 See also GEN 15:6; GAL 3:6–3:9

Melchizedek: Jesus Christ as priest-king

HEB 7:1–7:3 See also GEN 14:17–14:20; PSA 110:4; HEB 7:11–7:17

Sarah and Hagar: grace and law

GAL 4:22–4:26 See also GEN 16:1–16:6, GEN 21:10; GAL 4:27–4:31

David: Jesus Christ as king, shepherd and sufferer

LUK 1:31–1:33 See also 2SA 7:11–7:16; PSA 78:70–78:72, PSA 89:19–89:37; JHN 13:18; PSA 41:9; REV 22:16

Solomon: Jesus Christ as wise ruler

MAT 12:42 See also 1KI 3:5–3:12

OT events as types**Noah's ark: salvation**

1PE 3:20–3:21 See also GEN 7:7

Abraham offering Isaac: God giving his Son

ROM 8:32 See also GEN 22:9–22:14

Crossing the Red Sea: Christian commitment

1CO 10:1–10:2 See also EXO 14:15–14:22

Water from a rock: Jesus Christ's provision

1CO 10:4 See also EXO 17:5–17:6

The bronze snake: Jesus Christ, the object of faith

JHN 3:14–3:15 See also NUM 21:4–21:9

1690: word of God

The utterances of God, especially as revealed in Scripture. This may take the form of commands or promises. The term can also refer to Jesus Christ as the incarnate Word of God.

The word of God revealed as law**God has made his commands and requirements known**

PSA 147:19 See also EXO 20:1–20:17, EXO 24:3, EXO 34:27–34:28; DEU 5:5; ISA 2:3 parallel MIC 4:2; MAT 15:6 parallel MRK 7:13

God's law is to be obeyed

DEU 30:14 See also JOS 23:6; PSA 119:4; LUK 8:21, LUK 11:28; JAS 1:22–1:23

Examples of disobedience and its consequences

NUM 15:31; ; 1SA 15:23–15:26; ; 2SA 12:9; ; 1CH 10:13; ; 2CH 34:21; ; ISA 5:24; ; JER 8:9

The word of God as prophecy

The prophets spoke the words of God

JER 1:9; ISA 3:1; JER 25:3 God's prophetic word came to Israel with varying frequency. See also 1KI 17:24; 2KI 24:2; 2CH 36:12, 2CH 36:15; ISA 16:13, ISA 24:3; JER 7:1, JER 14:1; AMO 8:11–8:12; MAL 1:1

Prophetic introductory formulae

“The word of the LORD came to ...”: GEN 15:1; ; ISA 15:10; ; 2SA 24:11; ; 1KI 6:11; ; 2KI 20:4 parallel ISA 38:4; ; JER 16:1; ; EZK 6:1; ; JON 1:1; ; ZEC 1:1; 1KI 22:19; ; 2KI 20:16 parallel ISA 39:5; ; ISA 1:10; ; JER 2:4; ; HOS 4:1; 2SA 7:5 parallel 1CH 17:4; ; 2KI 1:6; ; ISA 37:6; ; JER 2:5; ; EZK 2:4; ; AMO 1:3; ; HAG 2:11

Prophetic predictions fulfilled

1KI 12:15 See also 1KI 15:29, 1KI 16:12, 1KI 16:34, 1KI 22:38; 2KI 1:17, 2KI 9:36, 2KI 10:17, 2KI 14:25, 2KI 15:12, 2KI 23:16; 2CH 36:21–36:22

The word “against” a people, indicating judgment
ISA 9:8, ISA 37:22; ; JER 25:30; ; AMO 3:1; ; ZEP 2:5; ; ZEC 9:1

True prophecy is inspired by God

2PE 1:20–1:21 See also NEH 9:30; JER 23:16, JER 23:25–23:26, JER 23:30; EZK 13:1–13:3; MIC 3:8

A true prophet hears from God

2KI 3:12; ; JER 5:13, JER 23:18, JER 27:18

The prophetic word is to be heeded

EXO 9:20–9:21; ; JER 6:10, JER 25:3; ; ZEC 7:12

The word of God as Scripture

Scripture is the written word of God

DAN 9:2 See also ROM 3:2, ROM 15:4

NT writings are classified as Scripture

1TI 5:18; ; 2PE 3:16

Scripture is inspired and true

JHN 10:35; ; 2TI 3:15

The foundational importance of Scripture

It must not be distorted or changed: DEU 4:2, DEU 12:32; ; PRO 30:6; ; 2CO 2:17, 2CO 4:2; ; 2TI 2:15; ; REV 22:19; NEH 8:1–8:8; ; 1TI 4:13; PSA 1:2, PSA 119:15, PSA 119:97; ISA 8:20; ; ACT 17:11; MAT 22:29 parallel MRK 12:24; ACT 17:2, ACT 18:28; 1CO 4:6 It sets the limit of authoritative doctrine.

Jesus Christ as the incarnate Word of God

Jesus Christ is God in the flesh

JHN 1:1 See also JHN 1:14, JHN 12:45; COL 1:15; HEB 1:2; 1JN 1:1; REV 19:13

Jesus Christ speaks the Father's words

JHN 8:40 See also MAT 22:16 parallels MRK 12:14, LUK 20:21; JHN 7:18

Jesus Christ's words have sovereign power

MAT 8:8 parallel LUK 7:7; ; MAT 8:16; ; HEB 1:3

The gospel as the word of God

It was preached by Jesus Christ

MRK 2:2 See also MAT 13:19–13:23 parallels MRK 4:14–4:20, LUK 8:11–8:15; MRK 4:33; LUK 4:43 parallel MRK 1:38; LUK 5:1

It was preached by the first Christians

1TH 2:13 See also MRK 16:20; ACT 6:2, ACT 8:4, ACT 11:1 to the Gentiles; ACT 13:5 to the Jews; ACT 15:35–15:36, ACT 17:13; 1CO 14:36; 2CO 2:17, 2CO 4:2; PHP 1:14; COL 1:25; 2TI 4:2

It leads to numerical and spiritual growth within the church

ACT 6:7, ACT 12:24, ACT 13:49, ACT 19:20; ; COL 1:5–1:6; ; 1TH 2:13 Paul stresses that the preached word is not merely a verbal message but a dynamic power which achieves things.

It must be preached

ROM 10:14; ; 2TI 4:2

Descriptions of God's word

It is true: PSA 33:4; ; JHN 17:17; 2SA 22:31 parallel PSA 18:30; ; PRO 30:5; 1KI 8:56; ; 2KI 10:10; PSA 103:20 It is obeyed by angels.; PSA 119:89, PSA 119:152; ; ISA 40:8; ; 1PE 1:25; PSA 119:103 It is sweet and delightful; ; PSA 138:2 It is exalted above all things; ; ISA 45:23 It is irrevocable; ; EPH 6:17 It is the sword of the Spirit; ; 2TI 2:9 It is not chained; ; HEB 4:12 It is living and active; ; 1PE 1:23 It is living and enduring.

Comparisons of the word of God with everyday things

Food: DEU 8:3; ; JOB 23:12; ; PSA 119:103; ; JER 15:16; ; EZK 2:8, EZK 3:1; ; 1PE 2:2; PSA 119:105 light; JER 5:14, JER 20:9, JER 23:29; JER 23:29 a hammer; ; HEB 4:12 a two-edged sword

The word of God has power

It is active

ISA 55:11 The Hebrew for “word” can also mean “action” or “deed”. This indicates that God's word is active.

It brings about creation

PSA 33:6 See also 2PE 3:5

It governs and maintains the created order

HEB 1:3 See also PSA 147:18

It gives life

DEU 8:3 See also ISA 55:2–55:3; MAT 4:4 parallel LUK 4:4

It consecrates secular things

1TI 4:5 “the word of God and prayer” probably means “scriptural prayer”; i.e., on the basis of scriptural teaching the believer offers thanksgiving and prayer.

It restrains from evil

PSA 17:4, PSA 119:11

It heals and rescues

PSA 107:20

It has power to save

JAS 1:21 See also 2TI 3:15; 1PE 1:23

It brings about the growth of the kingdom of God

MAT 13:23 parallels MRK 4:20, LUK 8:15

It builds up the saints

ACT 20:32